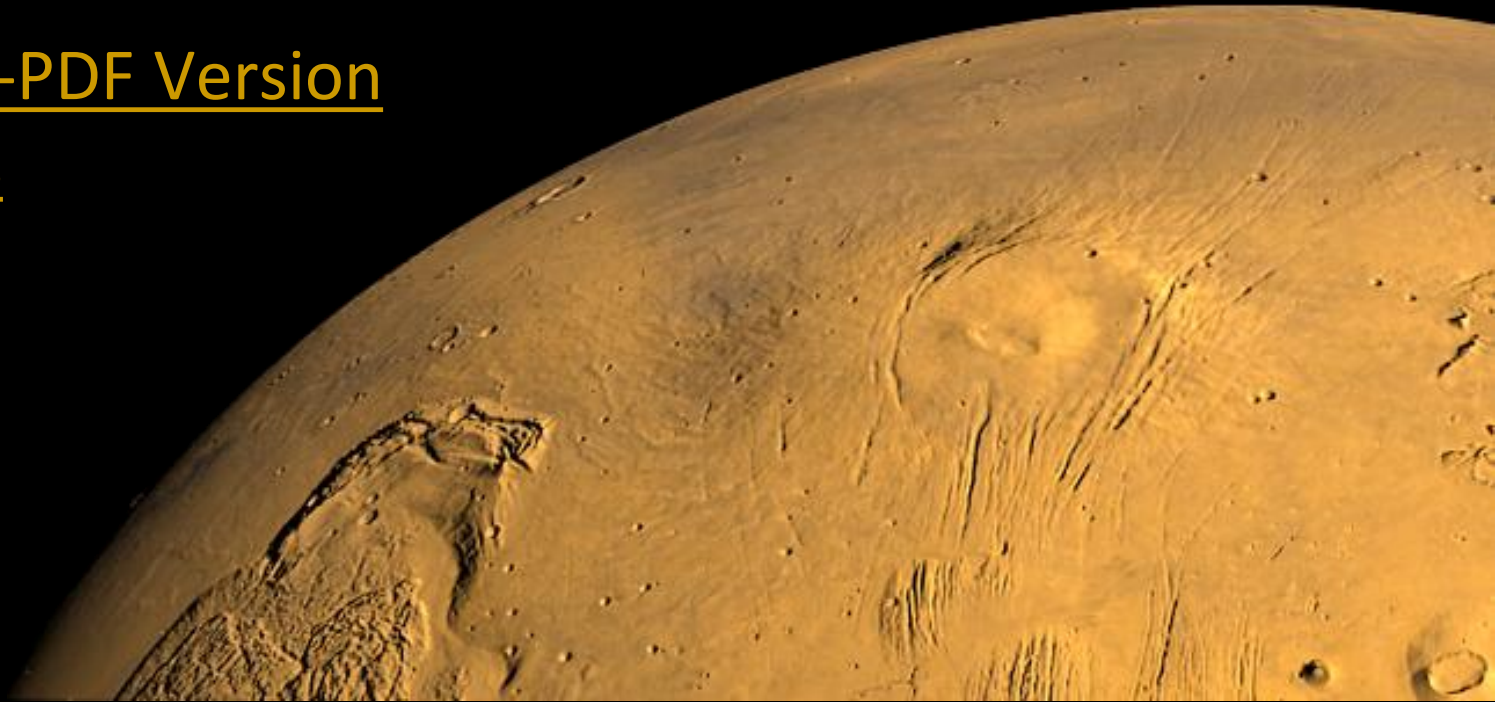


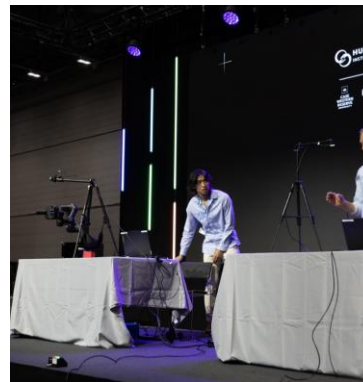
Stephen Mock Work Portfolio

[Link to Non-PDF Version
with Videos](#)



About Me

- Graduated with Bachelor's and Masters in Mechanical Engineering at Georgia Tech
 - Concentration in Robotics
- Worked at UCLA Biomechatronics Lab, Miso Robotics, NASA JPL, iRobot, SharkNinja
- Interested in space, research, consumer products, IoT
 - Enjoy systems engineering, robotics, mechatronics, coding, mechanical design
- Outside of work
 - Sports, Music, IoT Projects
- Contact Info
 - sjmock99@gmail.com
 - [Personal Website](#)



Skills

Hardware:

- CAD Design
 - OnShape, SolidWorks, Creo
 - EPDM
- Prototyping
 - 3D Printing, Laser Cutting
 - Mill, Lathe, etc
 - Soldering
- Controllers / Controls
 - Arduino, ESP32, Teensy
 - Raspberry Pi, Intel NUC
 - PID, Robot Kinematics, Robot Control
- Sensors
 - Tactile (visuo-optical), Force Torque, Thermocouples, IMU, Encoder, Infrared, Thermal, Ultrasonic, Hall, Humidity/Temperature, Laser Displacement
- Components
 - Haptics, Stepper Motors, Brushed Motors, Motor Drivers, 8020, Servos, Relays, Power Supplies, Thermal Controllers, various electronics

Software:

- Programming Languages / Frameworks / OS
 - Python, C/C++ [mainly for Microcontrollers], MATLAB, LabView
 - Basic HTML, CSS, JS, Java
 - ROS1, ROS2, MicroROS
 - Linux (Ubuntu)
- Networking / Protocols
 - Serial Protocols: I2C, SPI, UART
 - MODBUS TCP, TCP/IP, SSH, CAN, VISA, SCPI
 - MQTT
- Applications
 - MATLAB, Git, SciKit Learn (Machine Learning), OpenCV, Linux, Jupyter Notebook, Notion, LabView, PlatformIO, VSCode

Portfolio Table of Contents

- UCLA Biomechatronics Lab Work
 - Tactile Driven Bimanual Manipulation Project (2024-2025)
 - AI for Good Demo (2025)
- NASA JPL Work
 - End Effector Development Testbed (EDT) V&V (Summer 2023)
 - Laser Transform Module for End Effector Development (EDT) Testbed (Summer 2023)
 - Software Development Summary of Work (Fall 2023)
 - End Effector Initial Developmental Testbed (Spring 2020 - Summer 2021)
 - Mars Sample Return Handling Concept of Operations (Winter 2021)
 - Robotic Transfer Arm (RTA) Kinematics (Winter 2021)
- School and Personal Projects
 - Chat Controlled Twitch Robot (Winter 2024)
 - Flowers Invention Studio Hackathon Winning Submission: MedMate (Fall 2020)
 - Senior Capstone: EELS Robot Sampling System (Fall 2021)
 - TurtleBot ROS Demonstrations (Spring 2022)

UCLA Summary of Work

Research & Development Engineer II

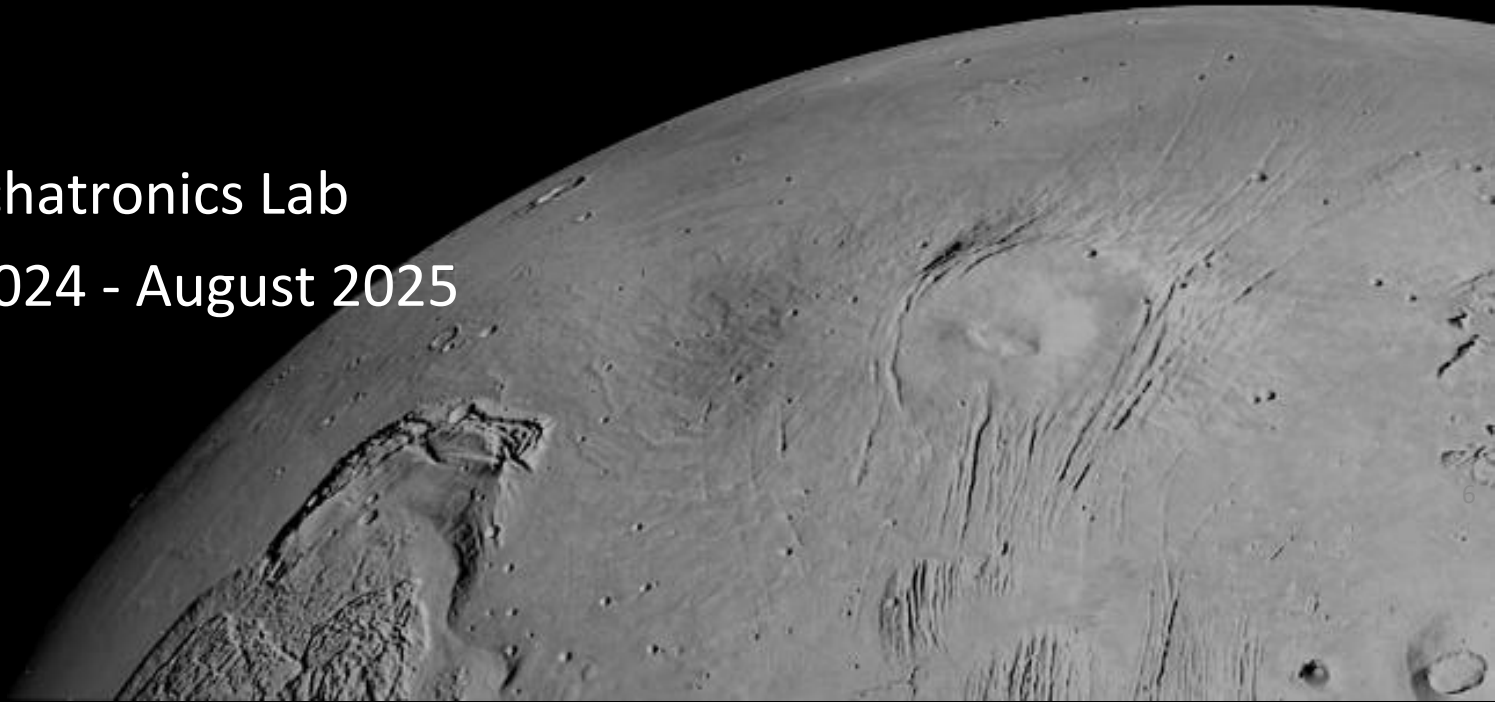
- September 2024 – September 2025

The decision to implement Mars Sample Return will not be finalized until NASA's completion of the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) process. This document is being made available for information purposes only.

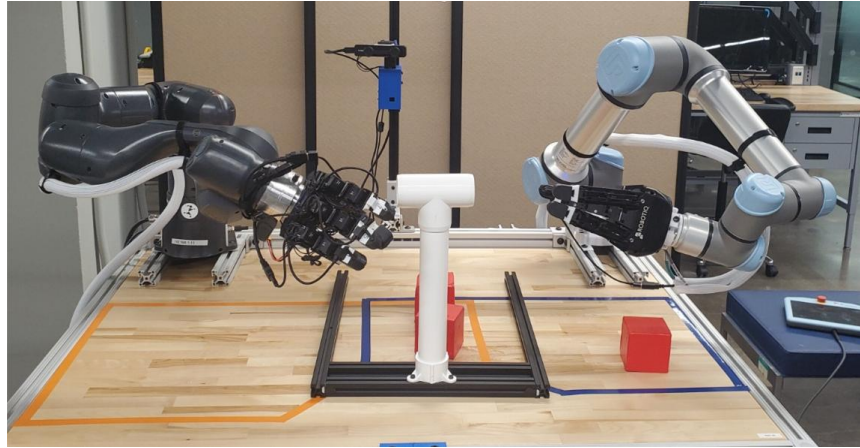
Tactile Driven Bimanual Manipulation Project

UCLA Biomechatronics Lab

September 2024 - August 2025



Project Overview



Current Team Members

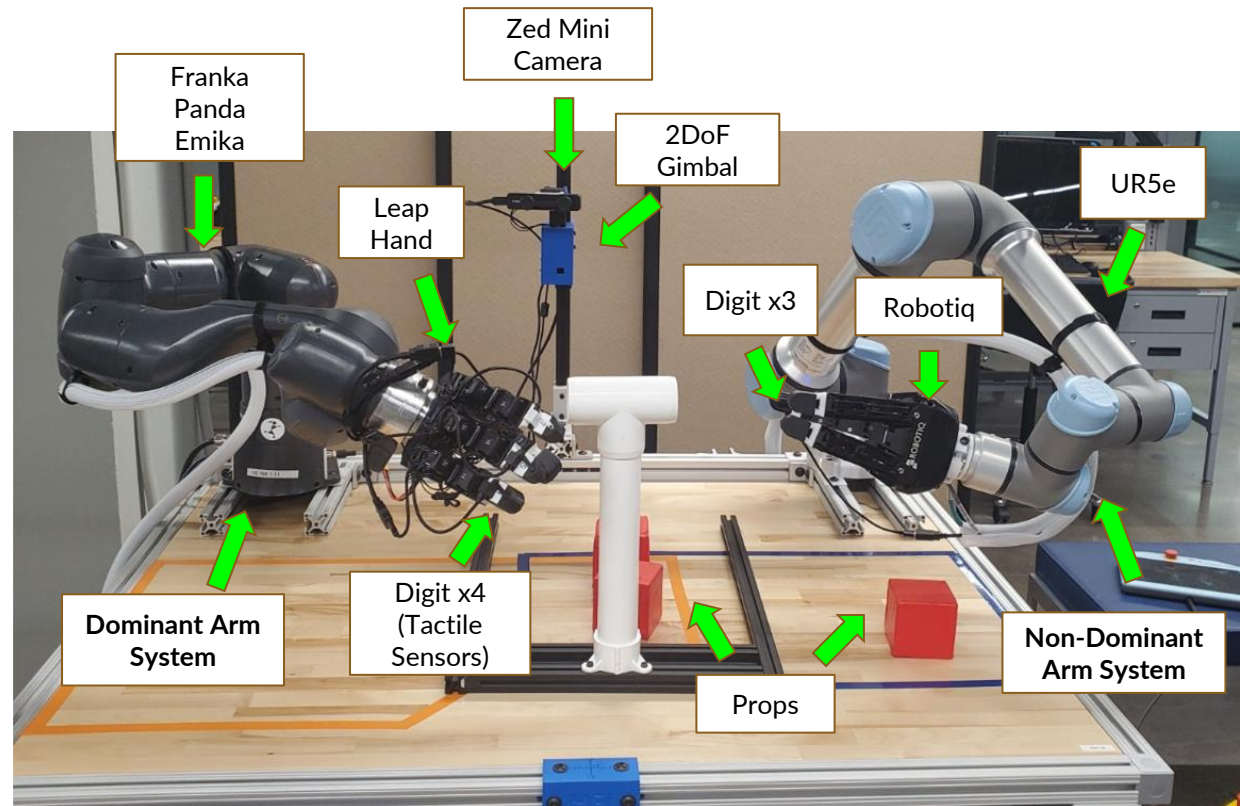
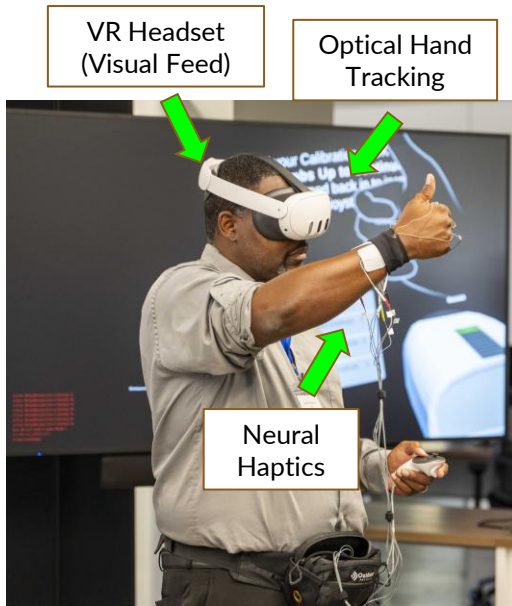
- **Stephen:** System
- **Mumbi:** Tactile Sensors
- **Ben:** Shared Autonomy
- **Cole:** Controller + Architecture

Collaboration with:

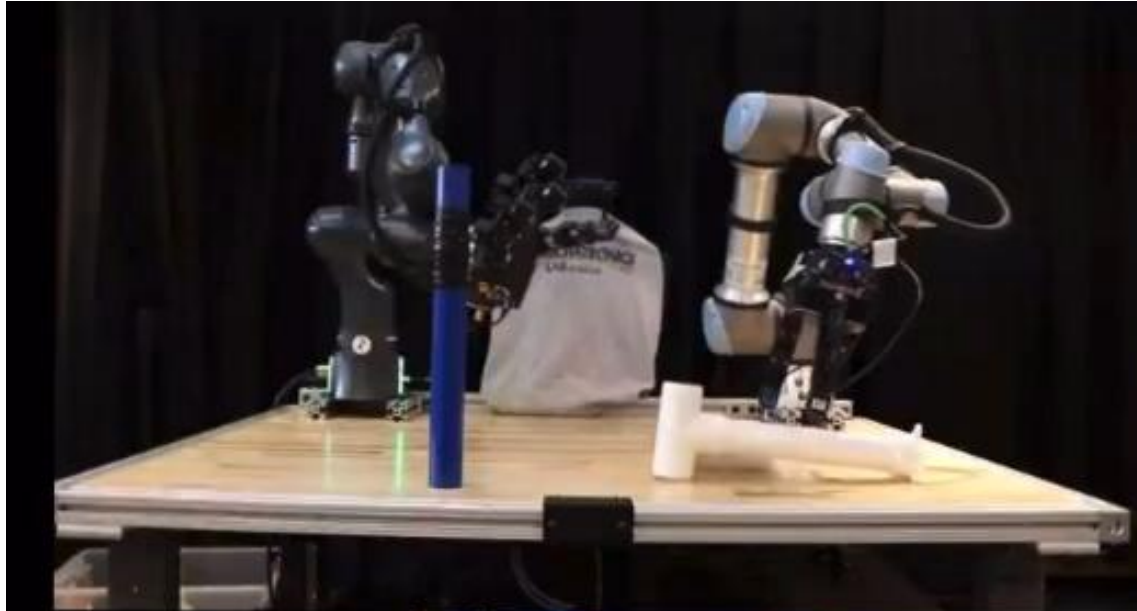
- CWRU: Haptics, Hand Tracking
- CS: Human Factors
- UW: Tactile Sensors

Objective: Create a teleoperated bimanual haptic robotic system in order to explore the applications and control for remote shared embodiment

Project Overview (cont.)



Bimanual Control with Operator



Pipe Task 2

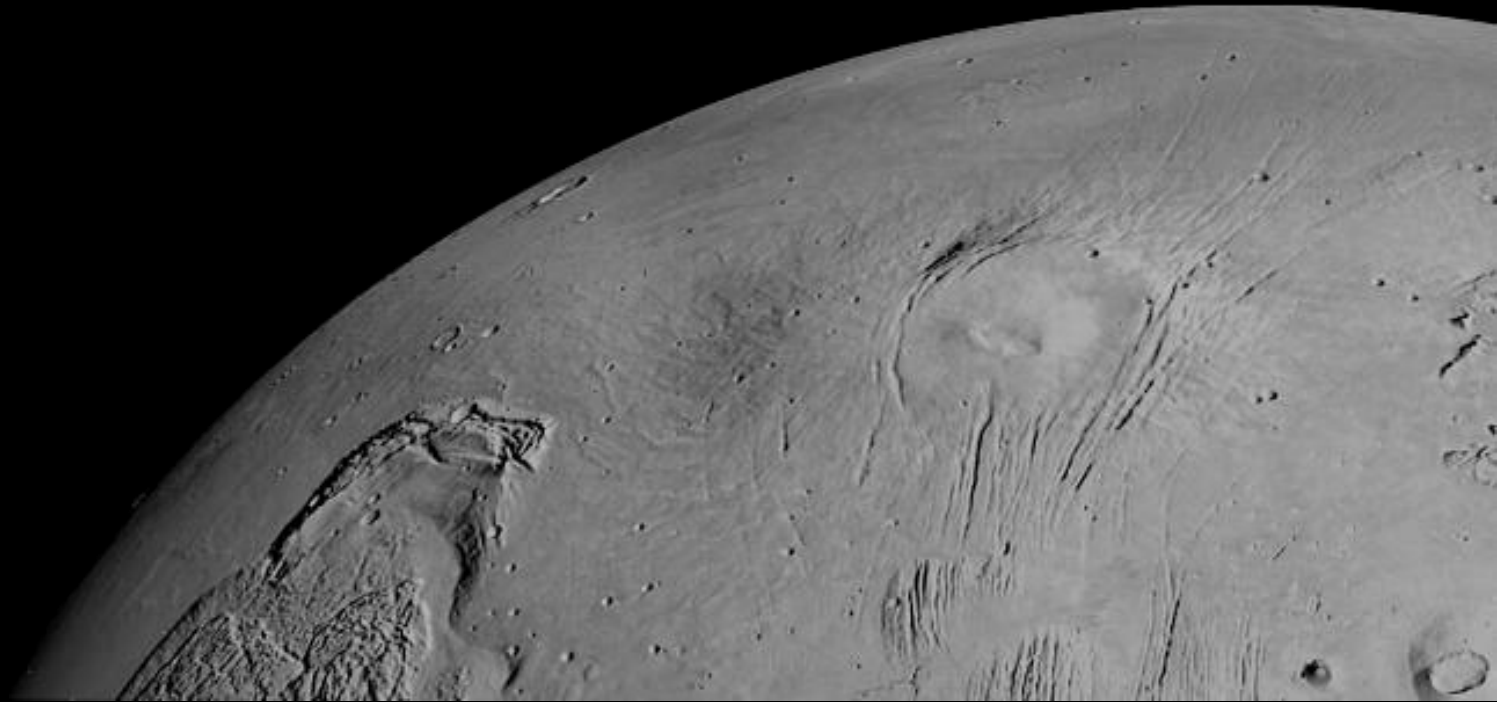


Project Summary

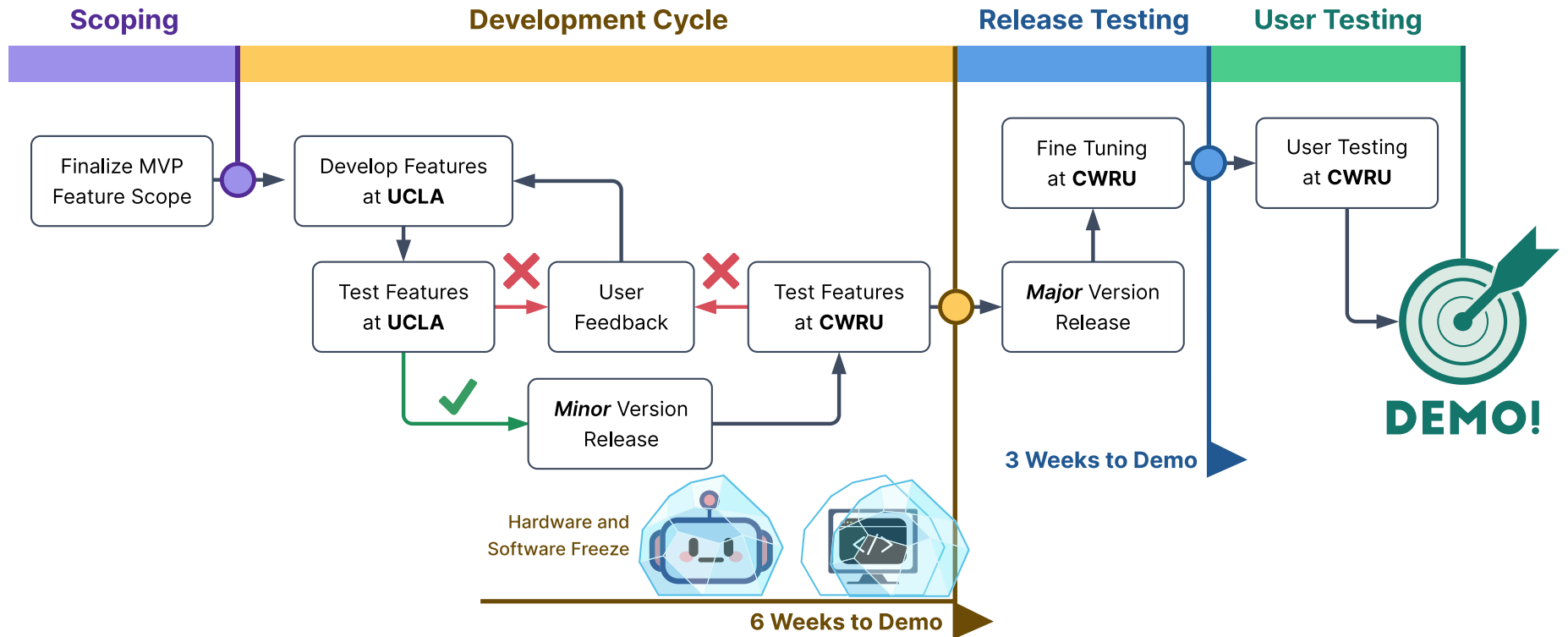
System Level Improvements since start in September

- October system implementation @ UCLA
- System requirements definition + scheduling
- System interface definitions
- Software design definition + software robustness to over 15+ repositories across entire robot system
 - Proper driver design + ROS2 design
 - GUI, launch system, visualization + telemetry
 - Digital Twin
- Robotic system Testing
 - Full end to end test definition
 - Over 200+ automated, hardware in the loop, ROS2 based unit tests
 - Robot controller validation w/ unit tests through simulation and hardware
 - Automatic test report generation
- Hardware design definition
 - Full system CAD
 - System coordinate frame definition
 - Hardware updates to cabling, grippers, gimbal, Digits
 - 4 Hardware releases for LEAP Hand
- Full system release(s) + documentation
 - Software release versioning + tagging
 - Hardware release via EPDM release system
 - Full system BoM with over 400 parts + links
 - Technical documents / assembly instructions

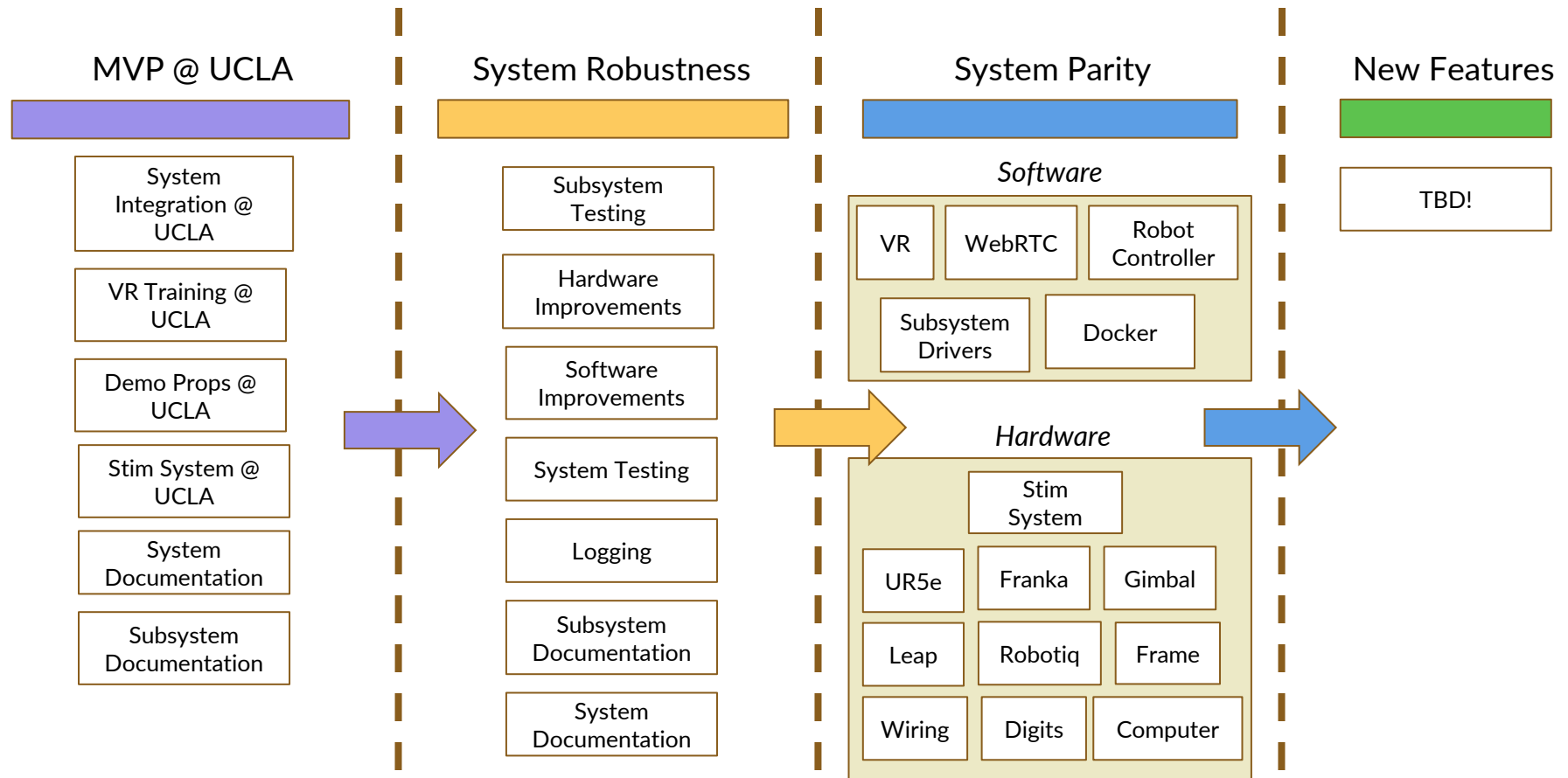
Systems / Project Management Updates



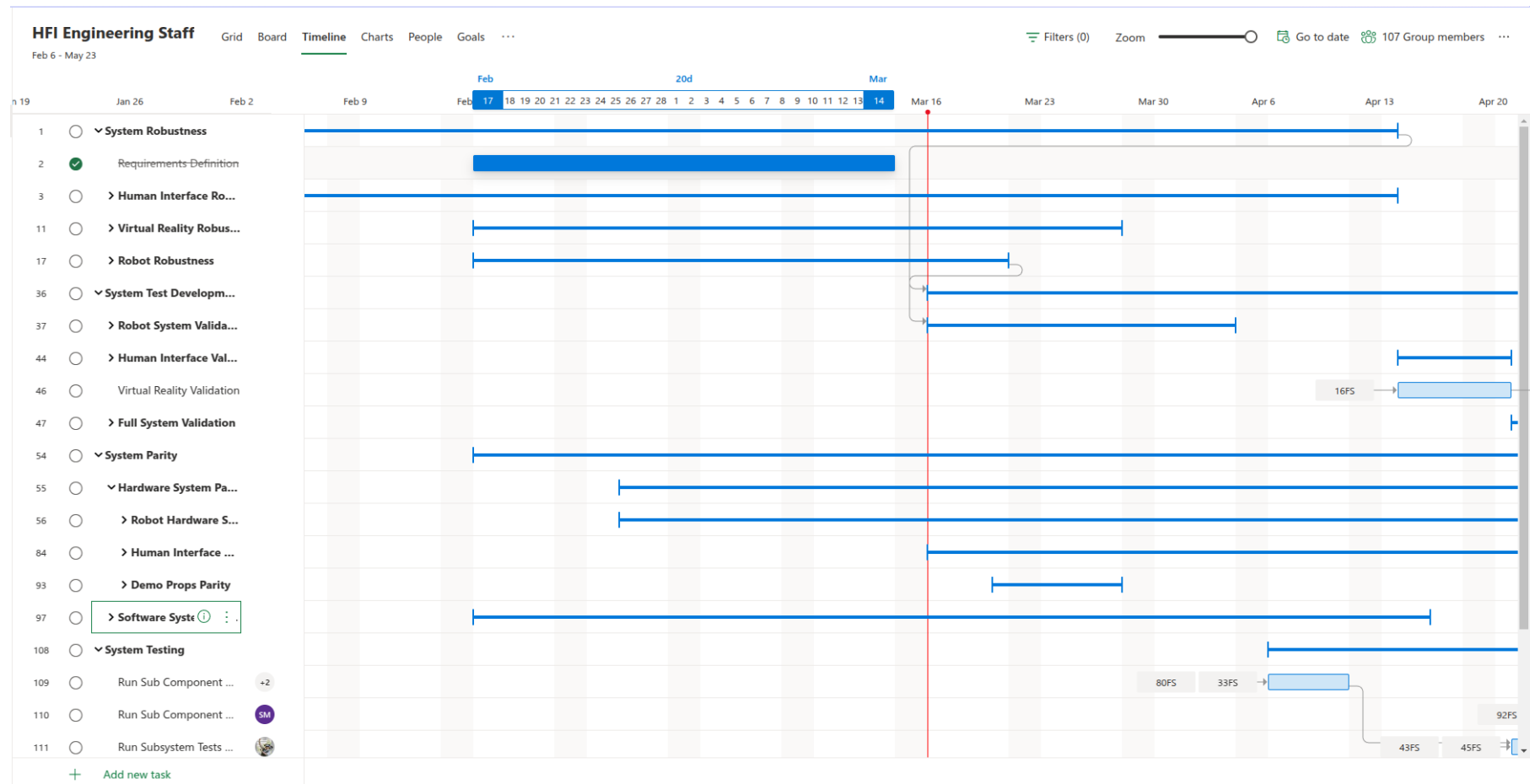
Defining Release Schedule



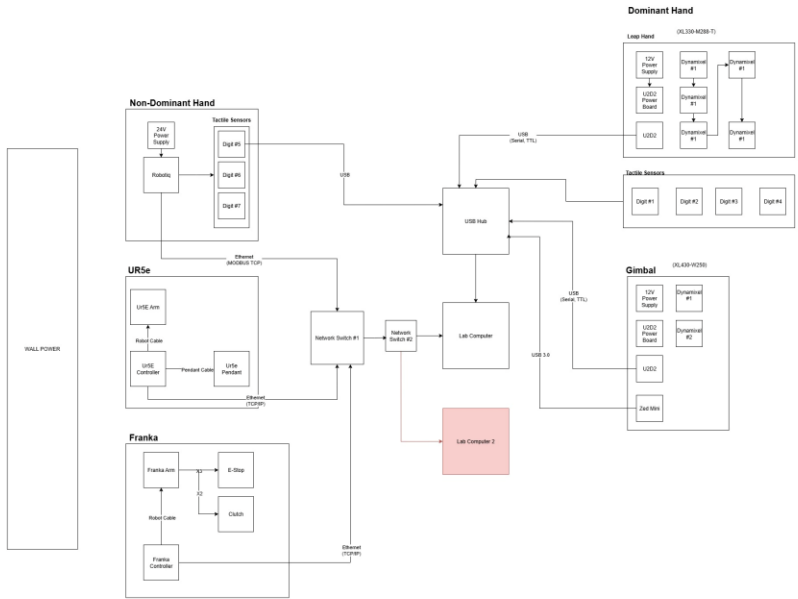
Technical Debt Progression



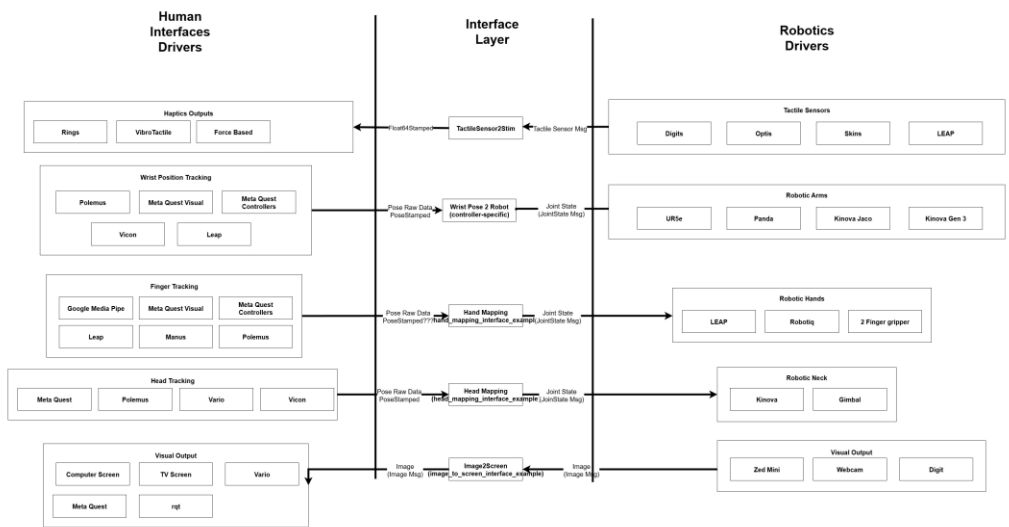
Schedule Coordination



System Diagrams

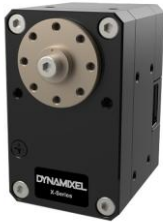


System Block Diagram

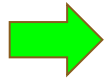


Interface Control Document

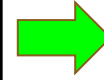
System Test Definitions



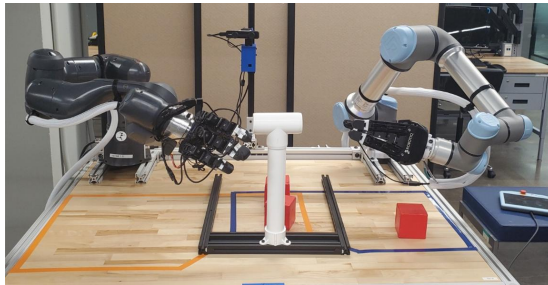
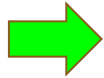
Subcomponent



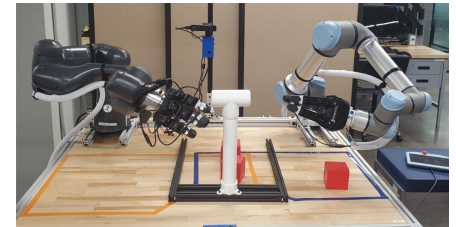
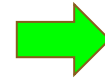
Component



Subsystem



Robotic System



Full System

System Test Definitions

Subcomponent

- **Lowest level of testing**, where the actual low level drivers (motors, sensors, etc) are being tested prior to be integrated into any component **(NO ROS2)**
- Using Pytest (Python) / Catch2 (C++)

Component

- Testing where **integrated subcomponents** are tested as an individual component that will interface to other components **(ROS2)**
- Using Pytest, colcon test, launch_pytest (ROS2)

Subsystem

- Testing where components are **specifically integrated with other components** as a subsystem

Robot System

- Testing where specific interactions of the system are tested when **integrated in an entire robotic system**

Full System

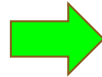
- Testing where specific interactions of the full system (**which includes external human interfacing systems**)

Test Examples



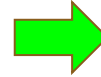
Subcomponent

Test dynamixel PID gains are set properly



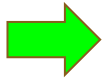
Component

Test ROS2 Leap Node publishes / subscribes correctly



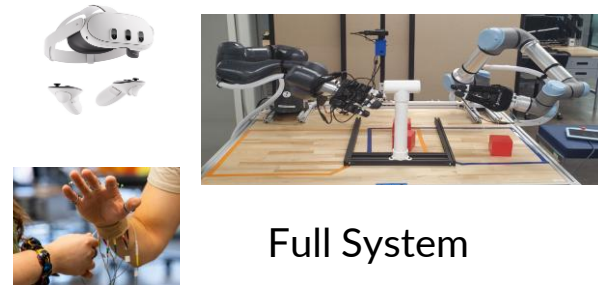
Subsystem

Test tactile sensor output when arm + hand is moving to pick up



Robotic System

Test handover task between robot arms with tactile feedback

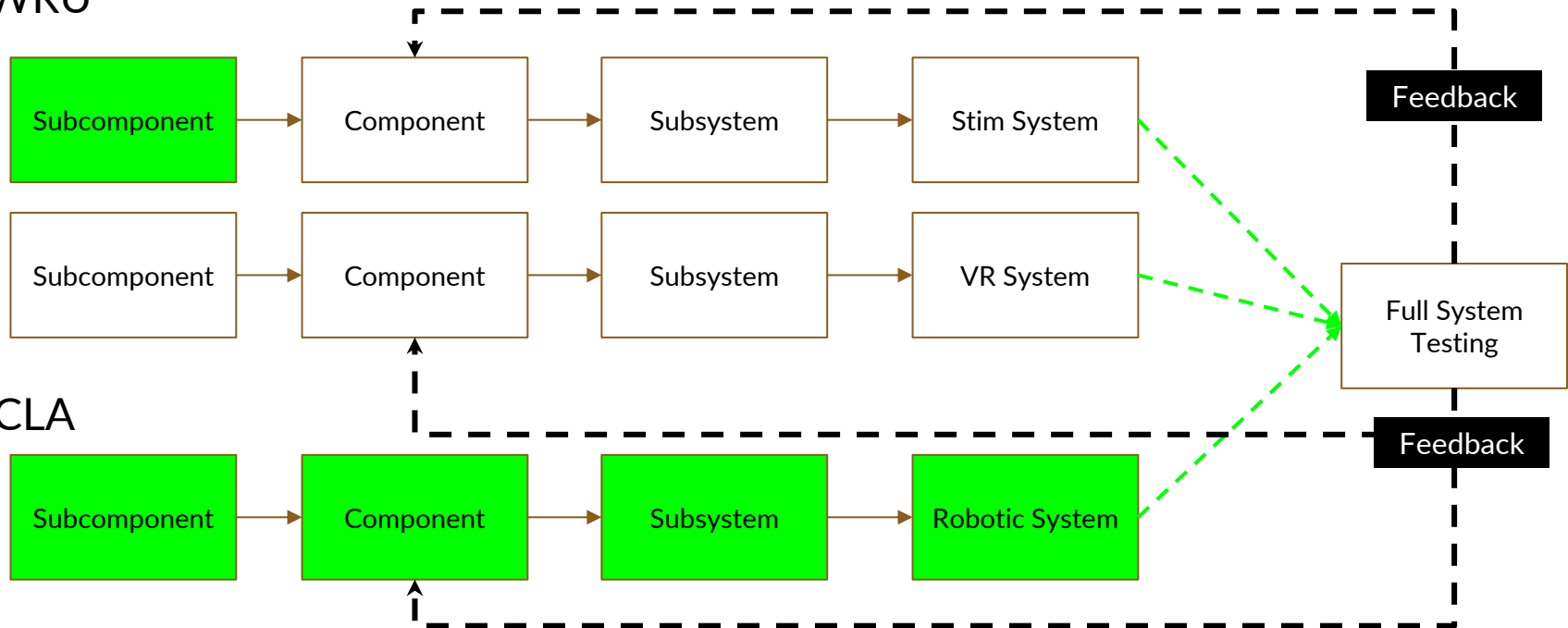


Full System

Test VR + haptic feedback while picking up blocks of different stiffnesses

Testing Progression

CWRU



UCLA

Unit Test Results

Unit Test Results

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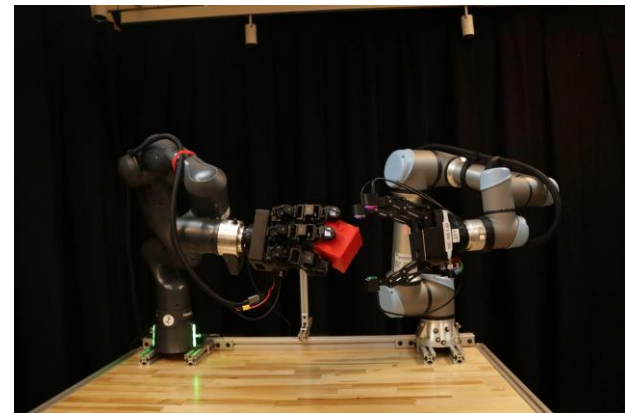
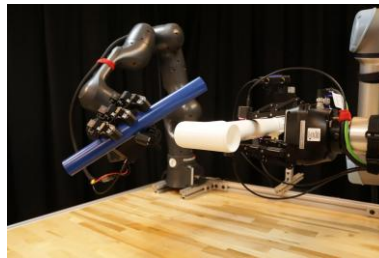
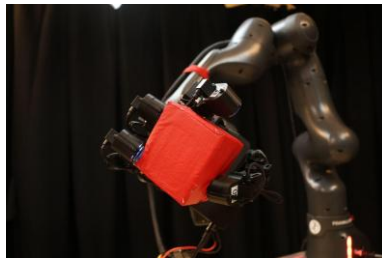
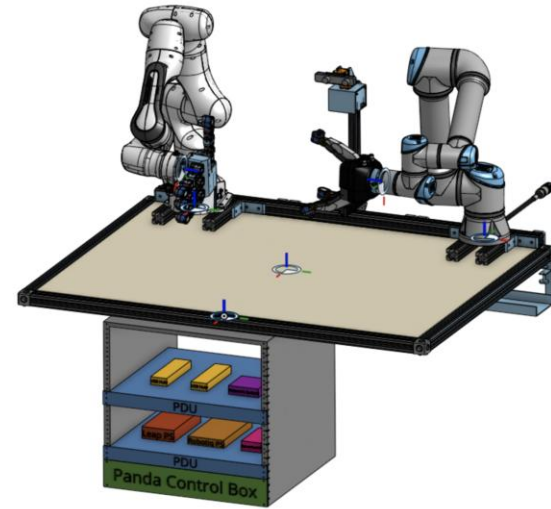
Unit Test Results

Unit Test Results

Unit Test Results

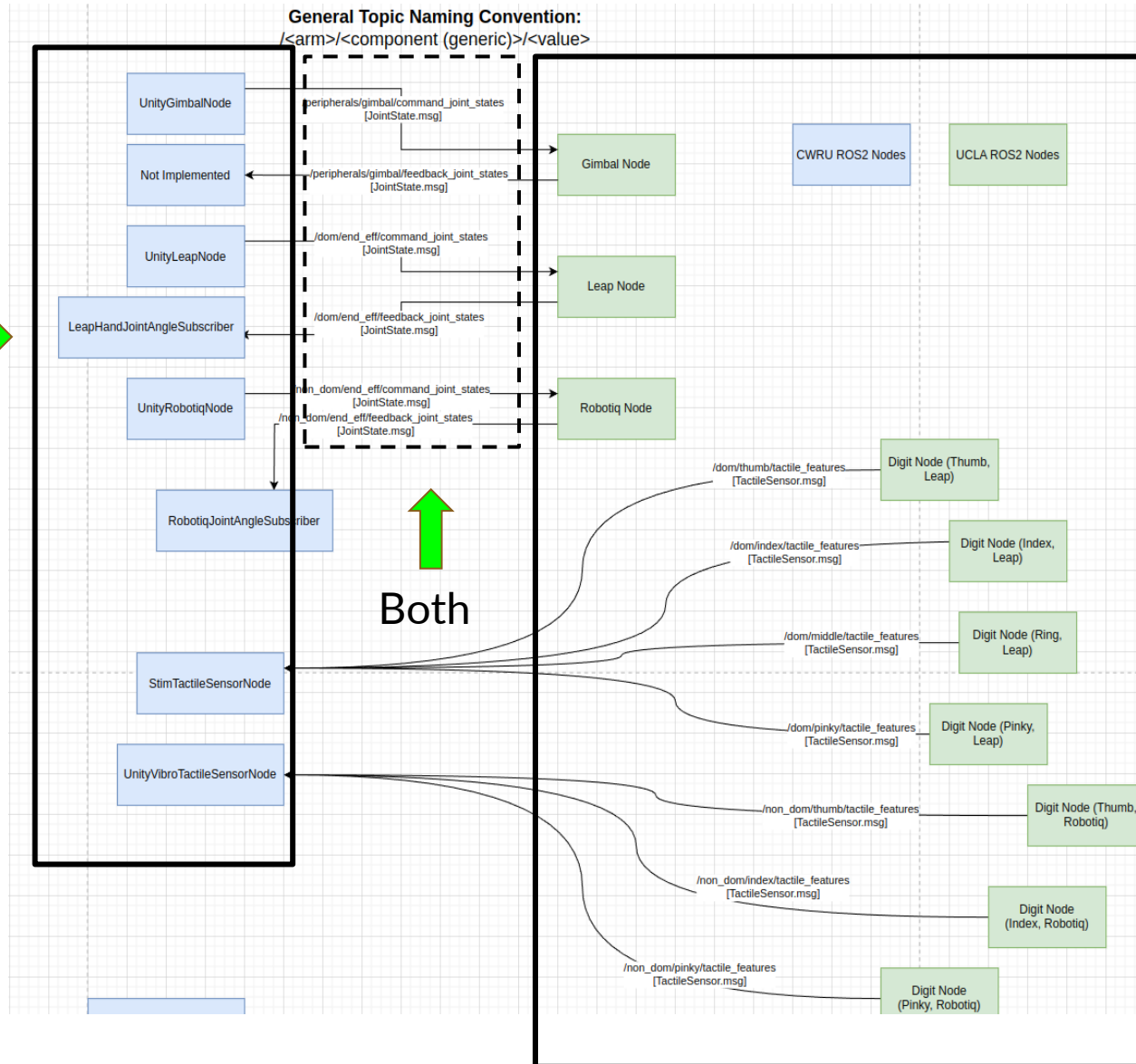
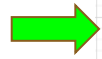
Unit Test

Photoshoot



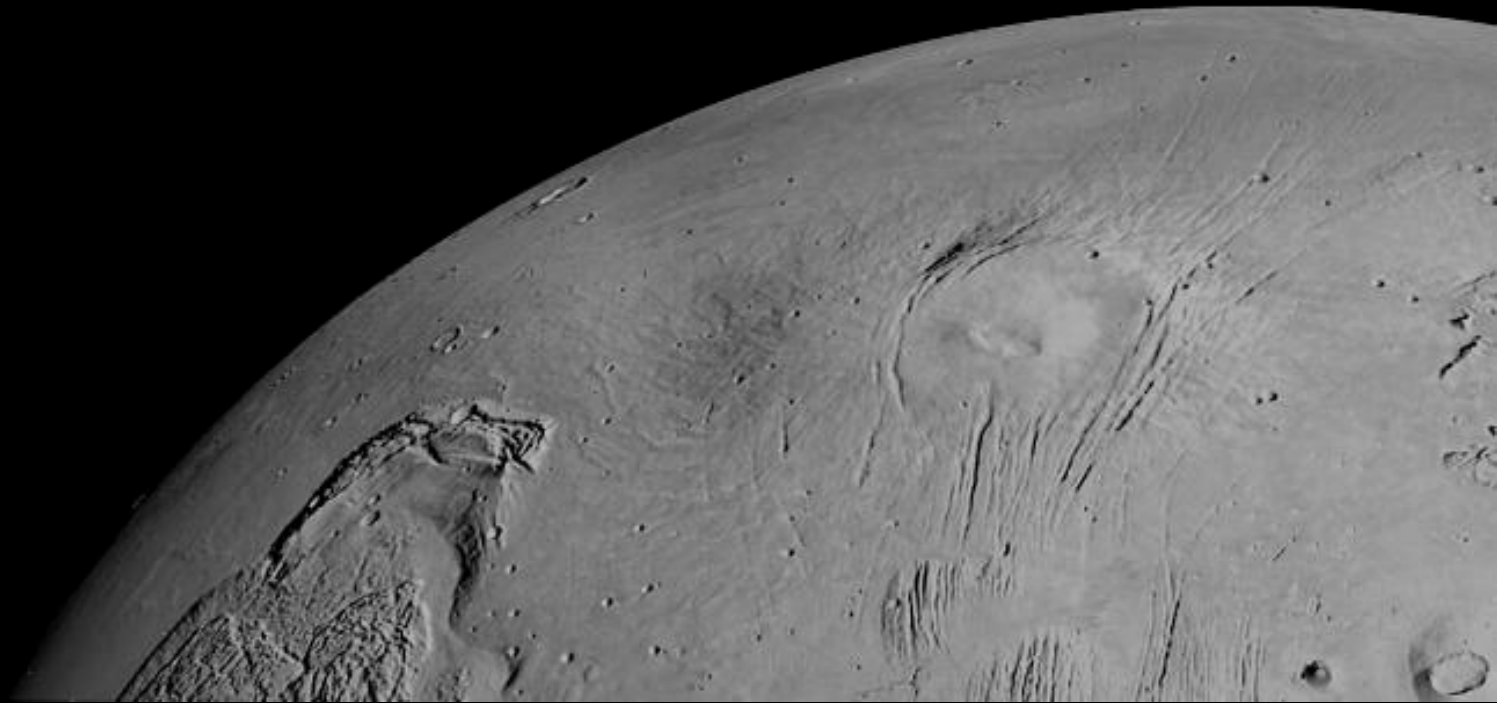
System Interface Control Document

Case Western



UCLA

Software Design

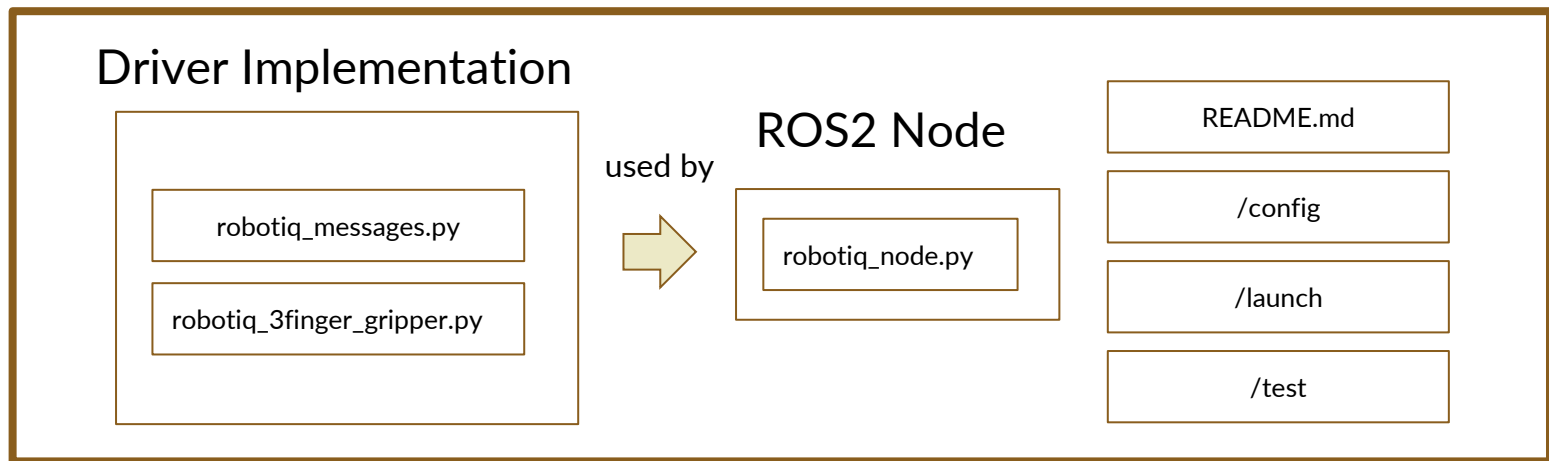


Software Robustness

- **Every** repository used uses proper git architecture (main, develop, feature) and pull request rules
 - Every repository must have a working README
 - **Each ROS2 package** has a driver and also a ROS node that uses the driver
 - **Drivers** should use correct encapsulation techniques for their respective language
- General code and file structure cleanup (CMake, package.xml, launch/config, naming, etc)
 - Refactoring
 - Bugs, Incorrect implementation
 - Feedback from Unit Testing
- All functions should have proper declarations and typing
- Docstrings / Doxygen Strings / Comments are required

High Level Software Architecture Example

robotiq_ros2



Unit Testing Objective

- **Unit testing** is a software development process that involves testing individual parts of a software application
 - Our application is a little different because we are also using hardware in the loop (HIL)
 - This means that both hardware and software changes can result in a unit test failing
- **Functionally checking out** and diagnosing components / subcomponents prior to full system integration
 - How do we know that our robotic system is going to the right positions, sensor readings, etc?
 - How do we know our implementation is even correct?
 - If changes occur to the hardware or software, do the components still meet their function?
 - Diagnostic tool when integrating with CWRU

Unit Testing Definition

Definitions:

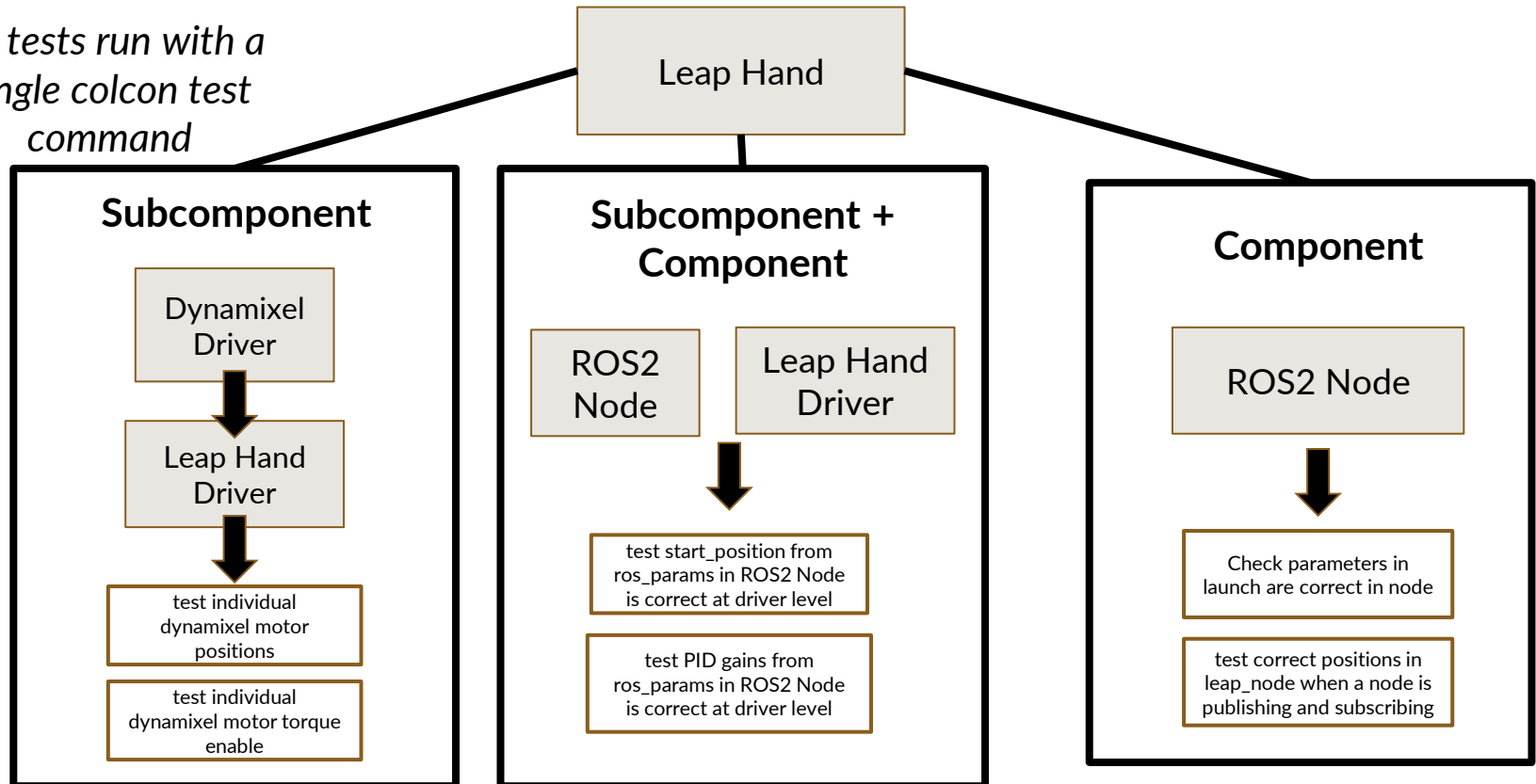
- **Subcomponent Level:** low level drivers (motors, sensors, etc) **[NO ROS2]**
 - **Ex:** a single dynamixel motor
- **Component Level:** integrated **subcomponents** tested as an individual **component [ROS2]**
 - **Ex:** a Leap Hand w/ ROS2 Node
- **Subsystem:** components are specifically integrated with other **components** as a **subsystem**
 - **Ex:** a Leap Hand on a UR5e Arm
- **System:** Integration of **all subsystems**

Framework:

- **Pytest** (Python), **Catch2** (C++), **ROS Integration** (pytest, launch_pytest)
- **Colcon Test** to run all tests at once

Leap Hand Unit Testing Example

*All tests run with a
single colcon test
command*

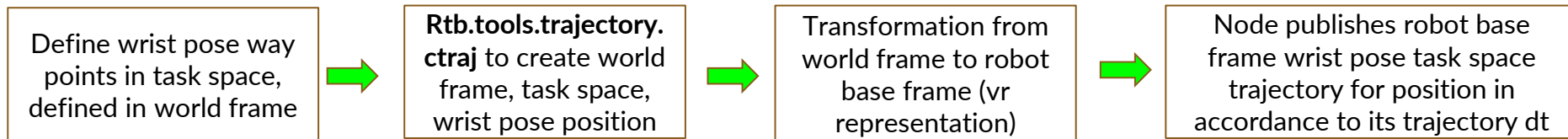


Colcon Test Process

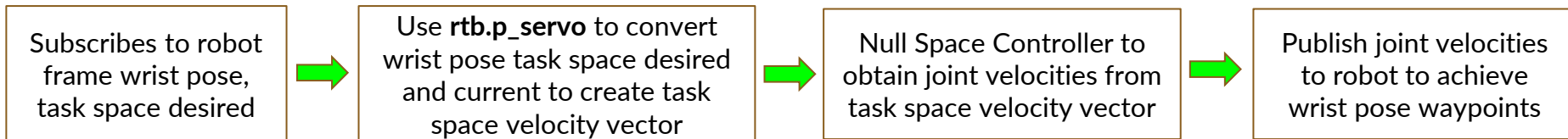
1. Remove build, install folders (since old test data can often go in here and conflict with test results)
 - `rm -rf /build /install`
2. Build workspace
 - `colcon build`
3. Run individual unit tests (if needed)
 - For launch based unit tests!
 - i. `launch_test /path/to/test.py`
 - For strictly unittest
 - i. `python-3 /path/to/test.py`
4. Run test suite
 - `colcon test --event-handlers console_direct+ --packages-select <package_name>`
5. Process Tests
 - `colcon test-result --all`
6. Review Results
 - `xunit-viewer -r build/<package_name>/test_results -c`

Null Space Controller Development

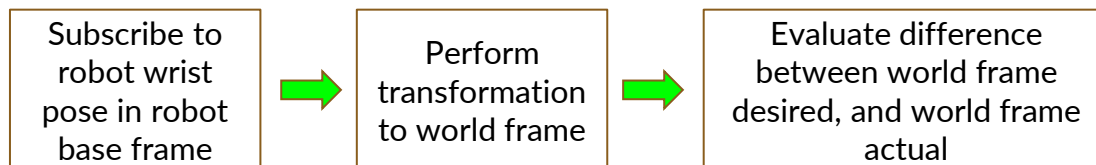
Trajectory Creation Node



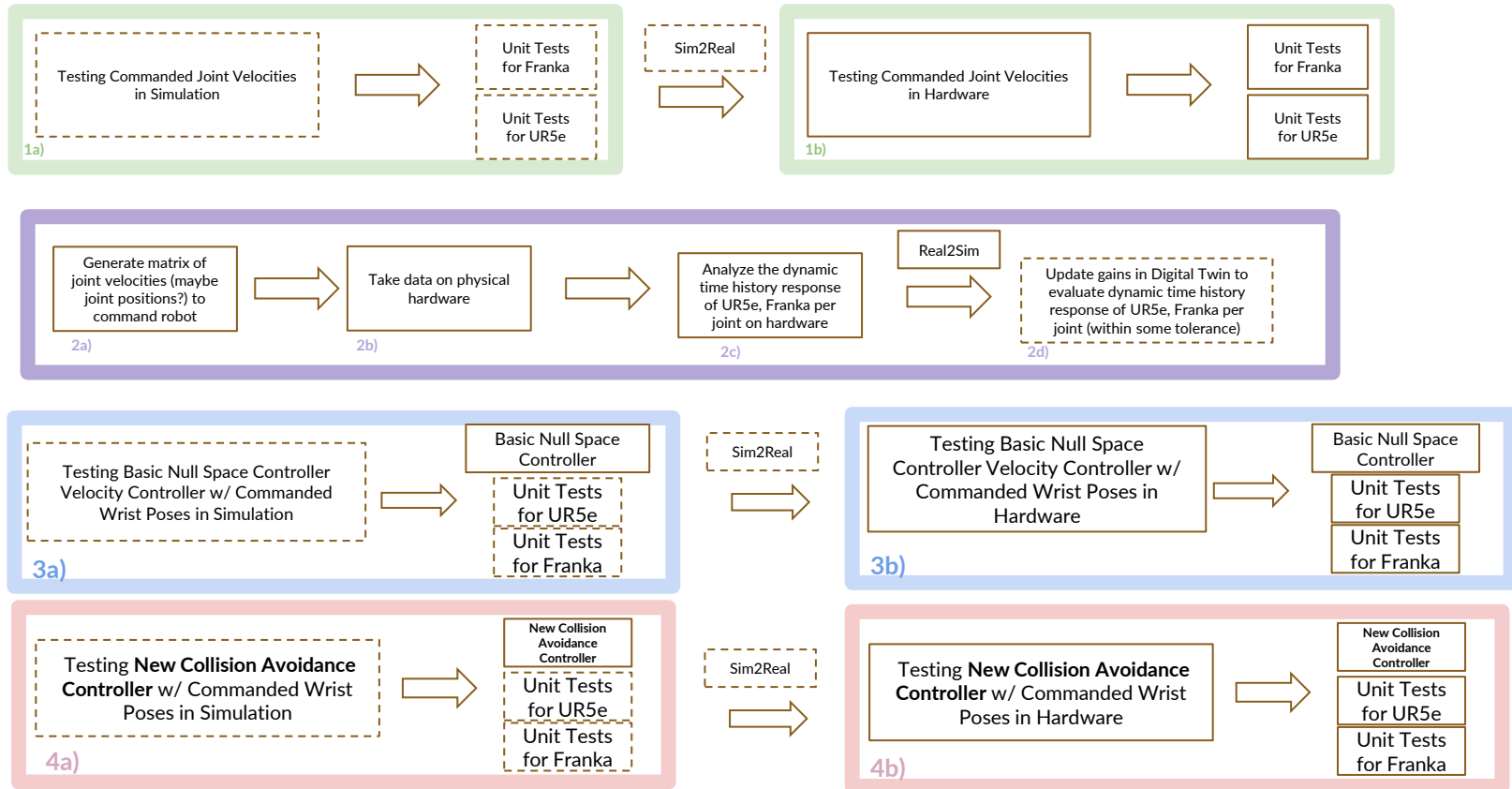
Controller



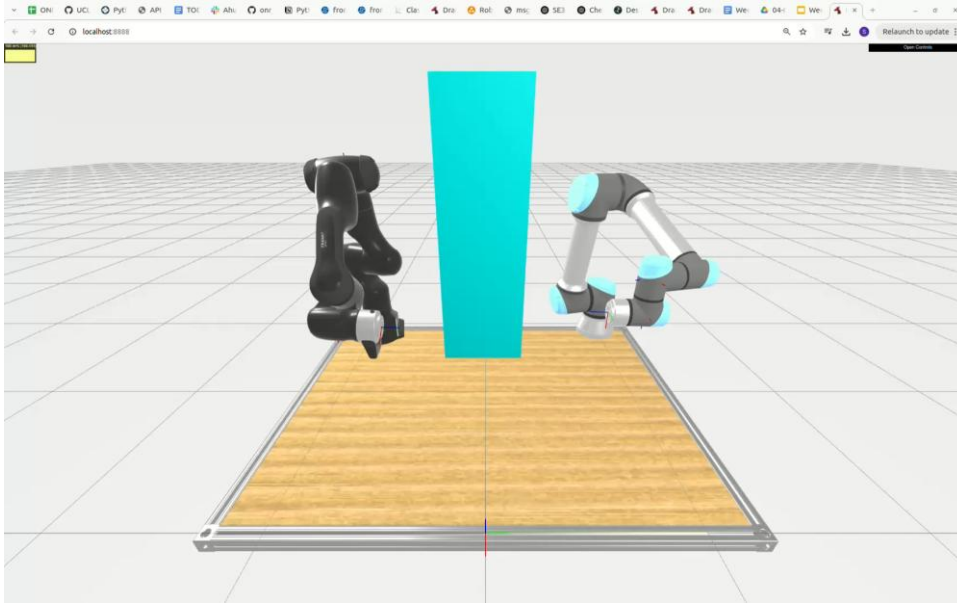
Trajectory Creation Node (Validation)



Digital Twin + Controller Verification Plan



Digital Twin + Controller Unit Tests / Validation



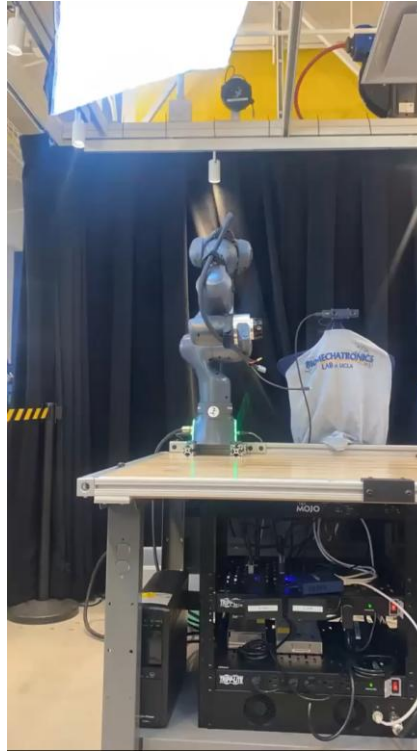
pytest time=12.077
v1

Properties	
Property	Value
timestamp	2025-01-16T15:21:37.313612
hostname	mqueen

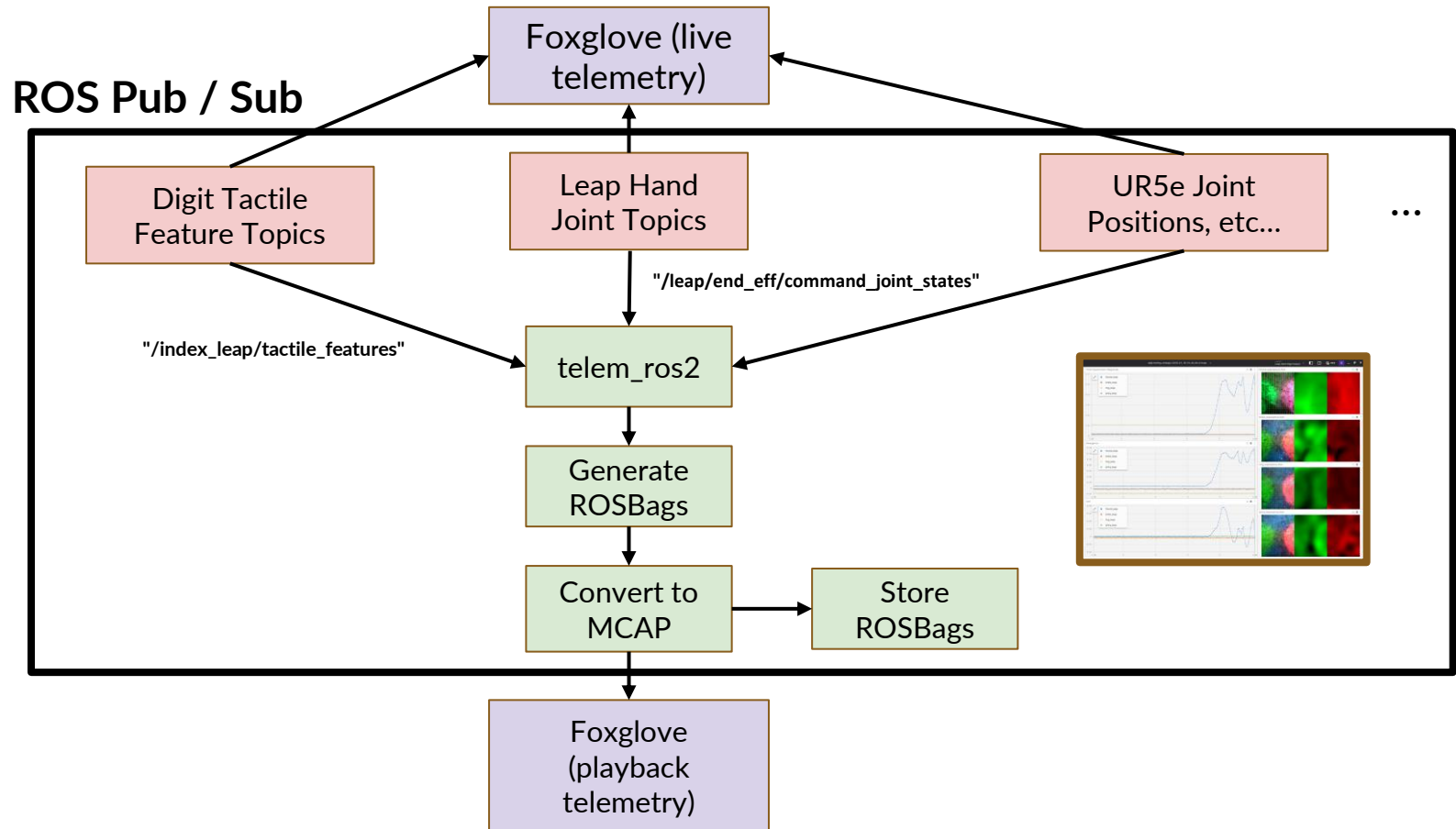
- ✓ test_digi_end_to_end - duration=849, end_to_end_digi_end_to_end_time=8.039
- ✓ test_digi_reset - duration=849, reset_digi_end_to_end_time=11.461
- ✓ test_get_digi_frame - duration=849, get_digi_frame_time=1.890
- ✓ test_optical_flow - duration=849, optical_flow_digi_flow_time=3.721
- ✓ test_params - duration=849, params_digi_params_time=1.736
- ✓ test_port_connection - duration=849, port_connection_digi_connection_time=1.026
- ✓ test_topo_end2end - duration=849, end2end_digi_connection_time=11.074
- ✓ test_update_and_copy_digi_frame - duration=849, update_and_copy_digi_frame_time=11.074

Automated test reporting, ROS2
Hardware in the Loop Unit Tests

Hardware in the Loop Unit Test Demonstration



Data Visualization + Telemetry



Bill of Materials

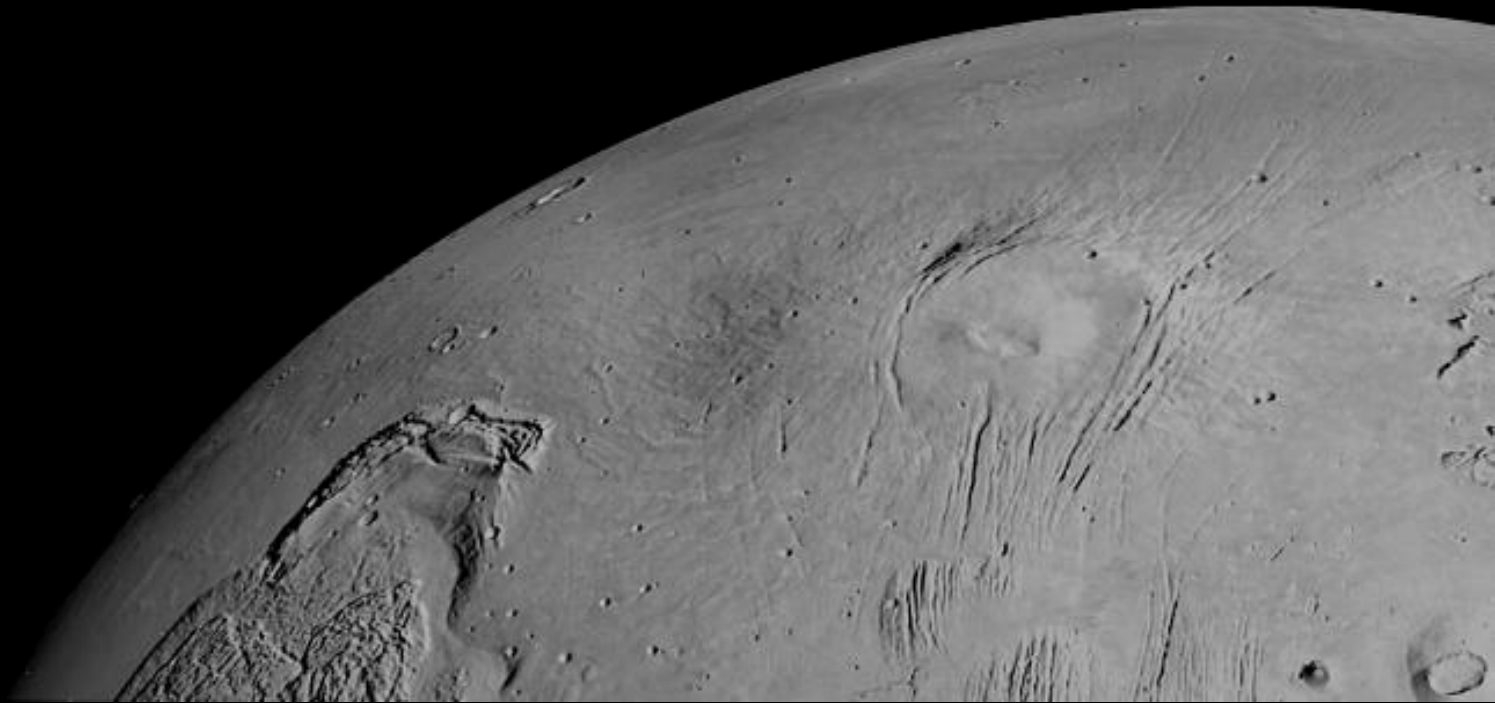
ONR Robotic System BoM

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
11	Leap Hand USB Hub	Cable Management		4 way splitter for USB 2.0	1	Link	
12	Network Switch	Server Rack		NETGEAR 5-Port Gigabit Ethernet Unmana	1	LINK	
13	Computer System	System	BoM Sent	ONR Computer Setup			Original Link - Changed the graphics card from a 3060 to 4060 because of cost availability
14	Franka Cable Management System	Franka	BoM Sent	Murrplastik FHS-C-Set Panda (			
15	Franka + Control Box	Franka	Assembled	Franka Arm + Control Box			
16	Universal Robot Adapter (FR3)	Franka		Release ?			
17	Gimbal	Gimbal		Release A			
18	Leap Hand	Leap		Release C			
19	USB A Cable	Cable Management		USB A, 3.0 used for Leap hand splitter			
20	UPS	System	BoM Sent	CyberPower CP1500PFCLCD P			
21	Robotiq	Robotiq		Release A (CAD TBD)			
22	UR5e + Control Box	UR5e	Assembled	UR5e Arm + Control Box			
23	UR5e Cable Management System	UR5e	BoM Sent	Murrplastik FHS-C-SET UR5			
24	Universal Robotic Adapter (UR5e)	UR5e		Release A (CAD TBD)			
25	Server Rack and stuff...	Server Rack	UCLA to specify	Release A (CAD TBD)			
26	Table Mounting Hardware		UCLA to specify				

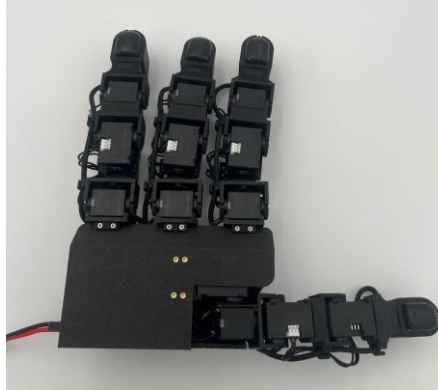
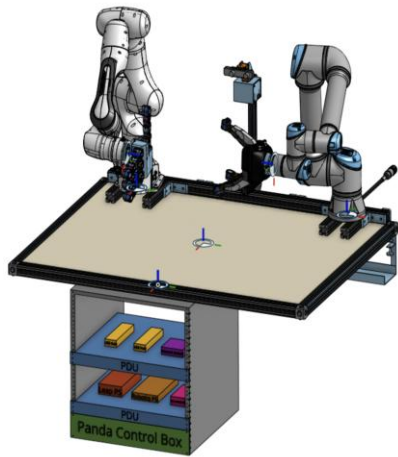
Leap BoM

	A	B	C	D	E
1	Part	Description	Quantity	Link	Notes
2	Leap to Arm Adapter Screw	M6x25 (1mm pitch)	4		
3	5V Power Supply	Leap Power Supply, S-150-5	1	LINK	
4	Dynamixel Motor	XL330-M288-T	16	LINK	Lite
5	M3 Heat Set Insert	4.7mm (D) x 4.3mm (L) M30X170C	many	LINK	for palm, palm back
6	Dynamixel Motor	XC330-M288-T	16	LINK	Pro
7	M2 x 4mm Screws (plastic threading)	Screw used to attach to the dynamixel horns (plastic ta	112	LINK	
8	M2 x 4mm Screws	attach to palm	~12	LINK	
9	M2 x 8mm Screws (plastic threading)	attach to base of dynamixel	~50	LINK	
10	M3 x 6mm Screws	attachment to back of palm	~10	LINK	
11	M3 x 8mm Screws	attach palm	~10	LINK	

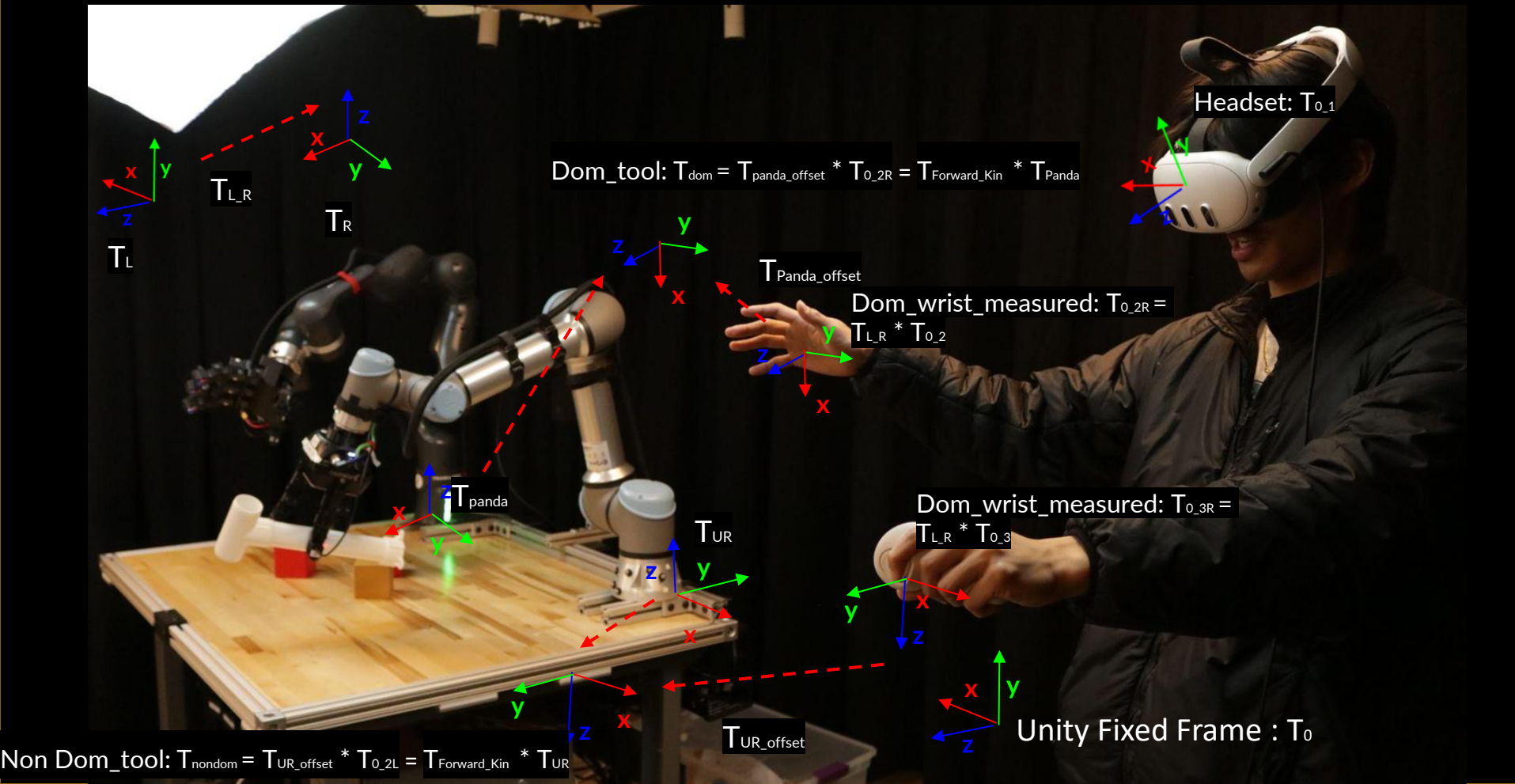
Hardware Design



Robotic System CAD



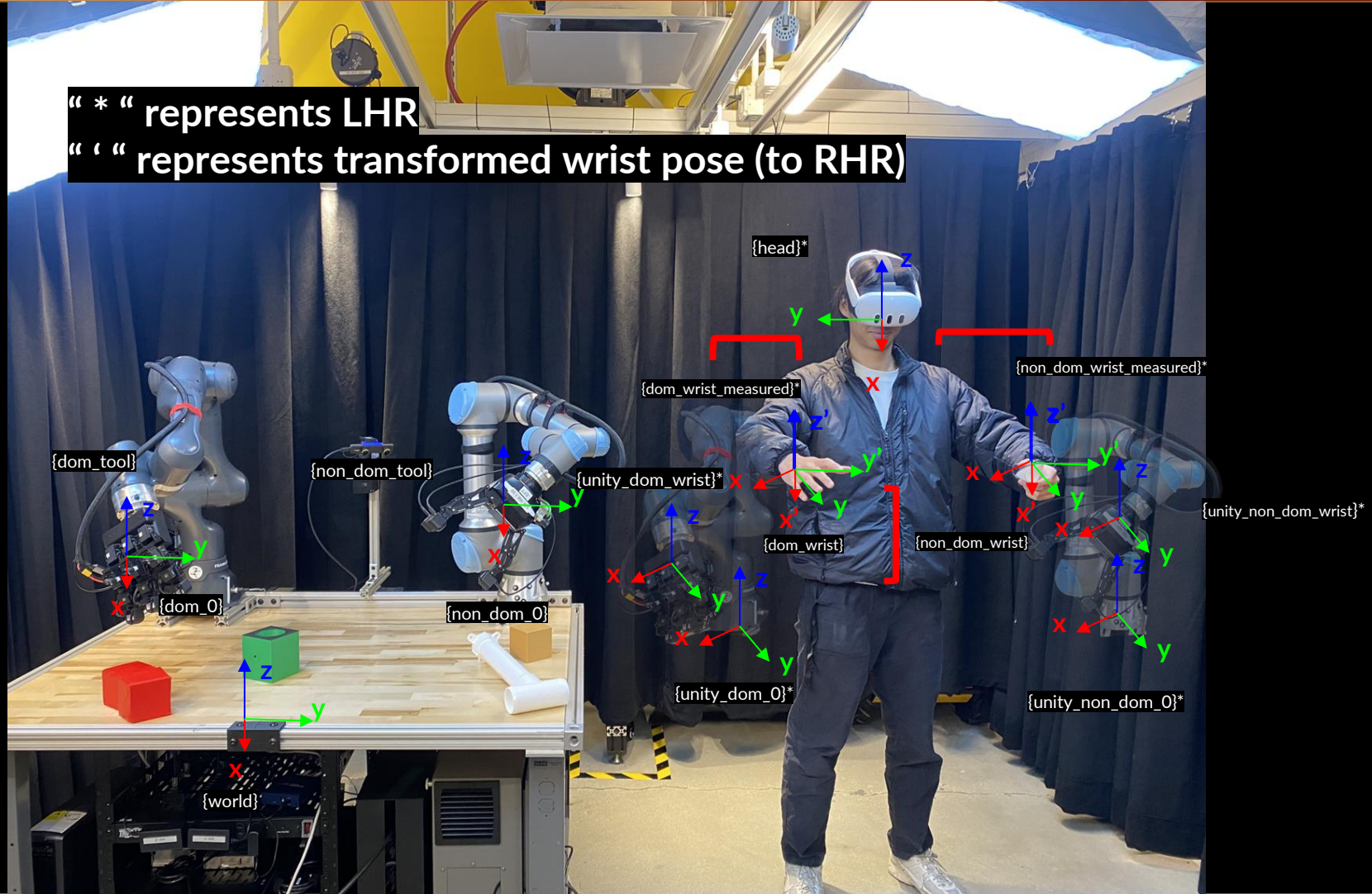
Robot Coordinate Frames



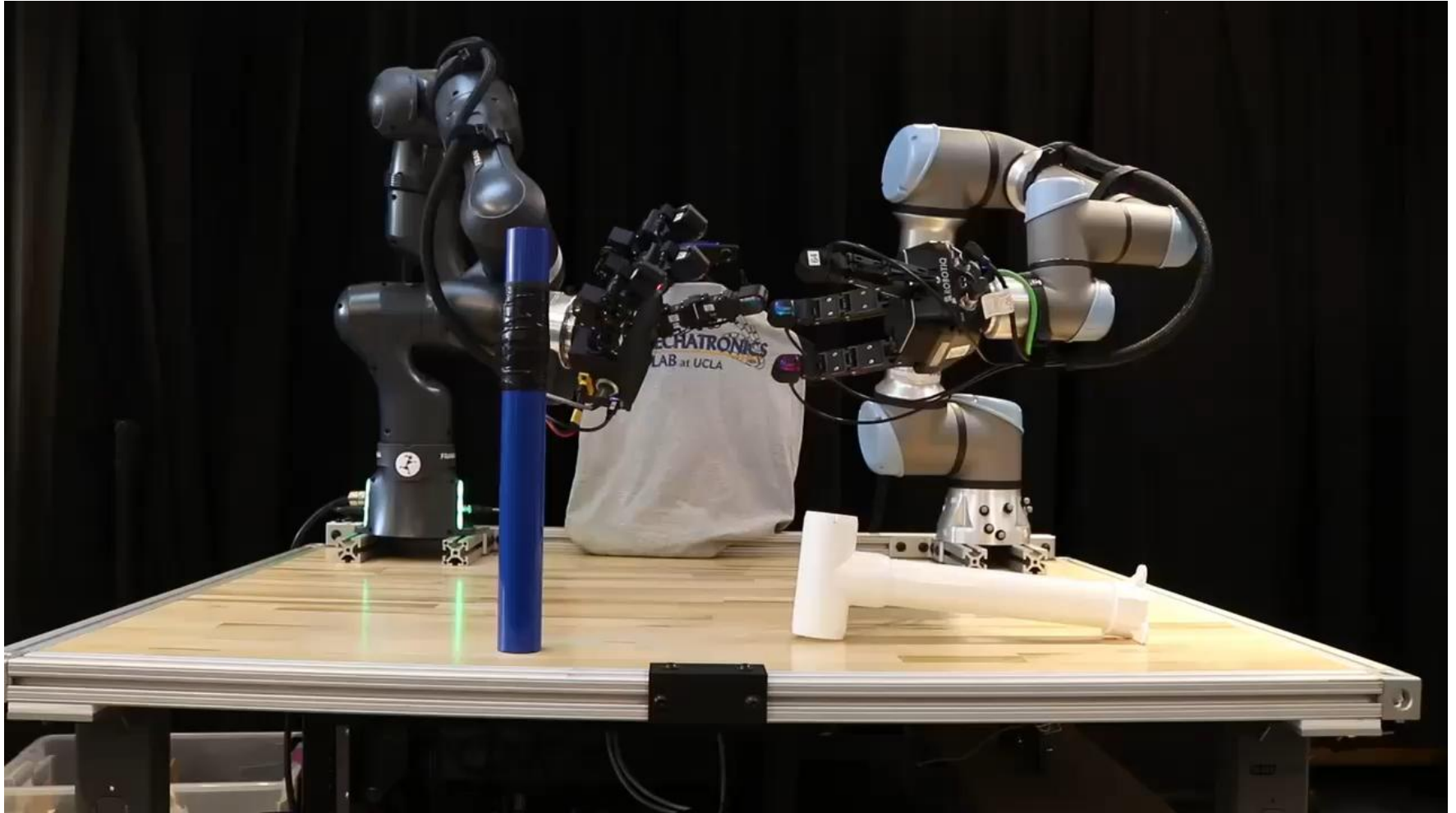
Robot Coordinate Frames

" * " represents LHR

" ' " represents transformed wrist pose (to RHR)



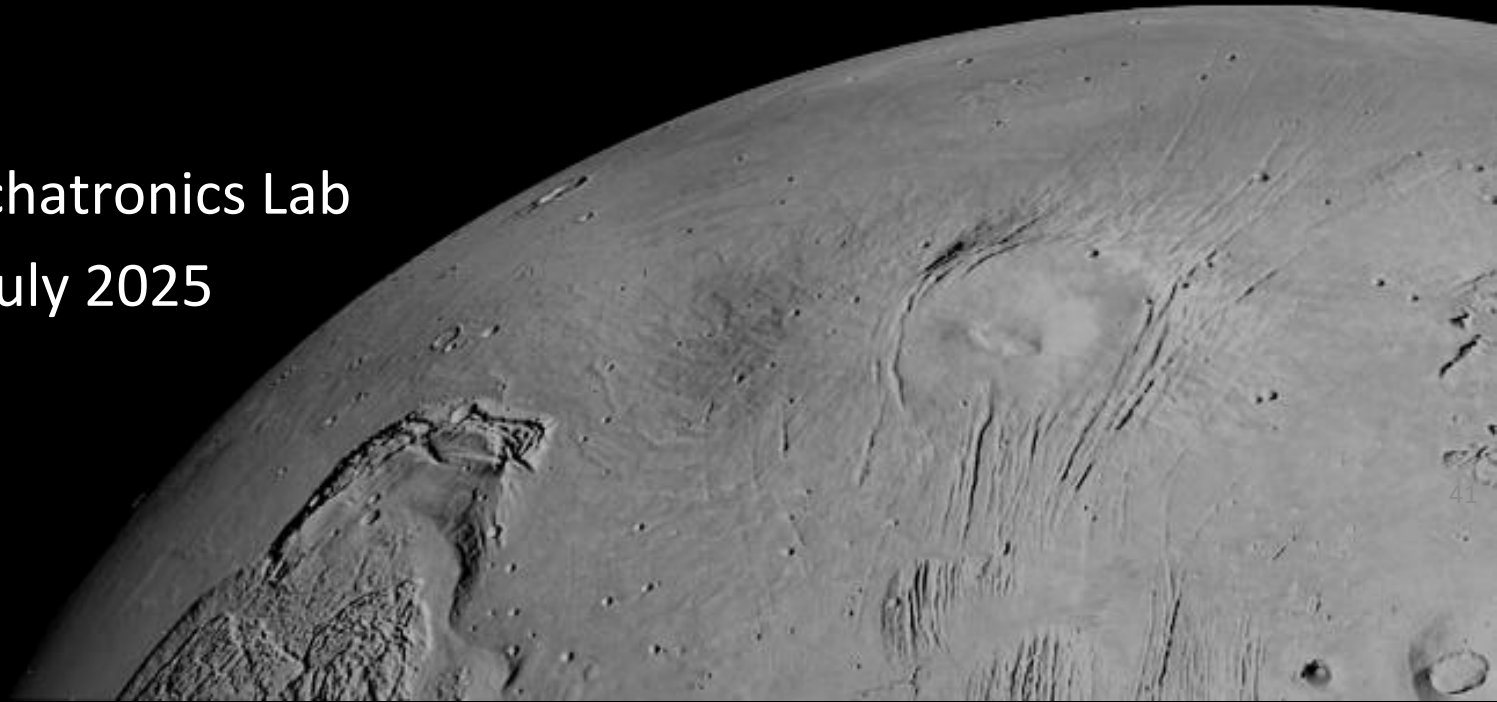
Other Videos / Media



AI for Good Portable Demo

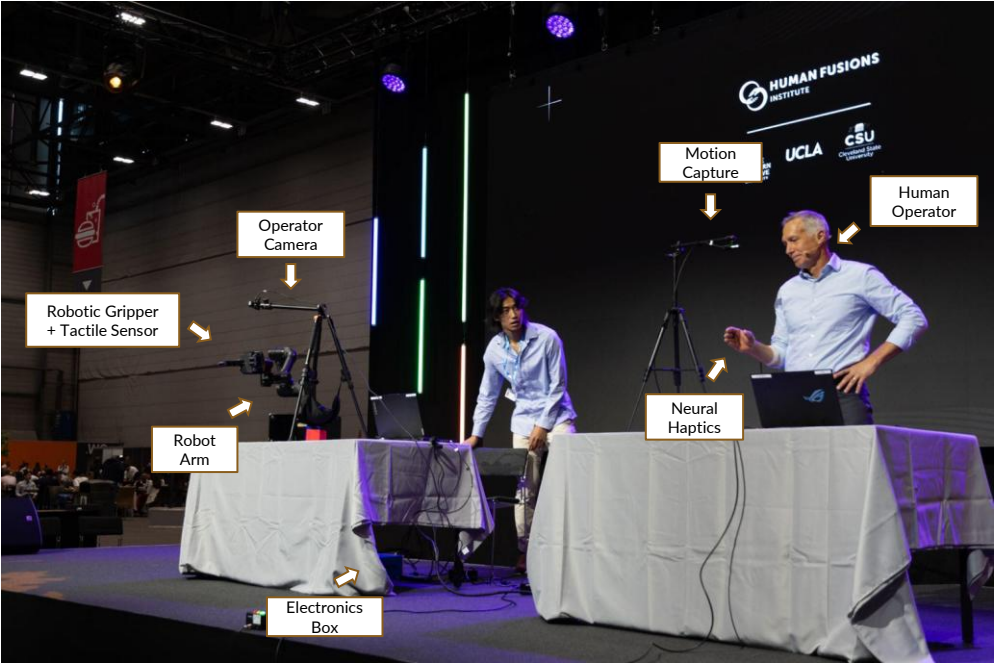
UCLA Biomechatronics Lab

April 2025 - July 2025

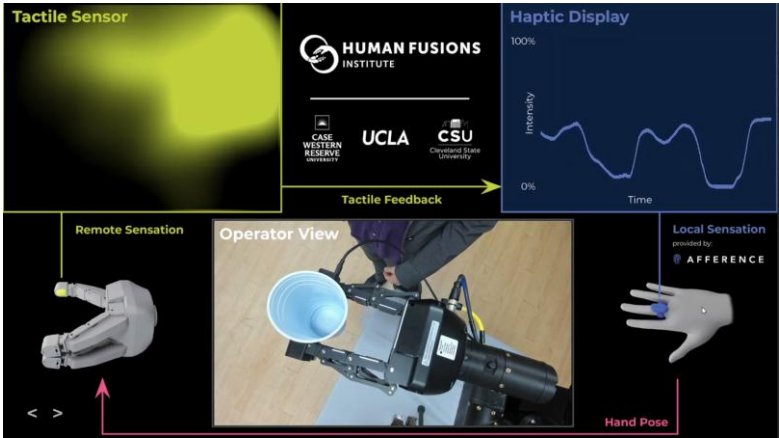


AI for Good Portable Demo

System Layout



Visualization



HUMAN FUSIONS
INSTITUTE

 **CASE WESTERN RESERVE**
UNIVERSITY

 **CSU** | Cleveland State
University

[Link](#)

ONR / United Nations AI for Good Demo

High Level Objective:

1. To create a **highly portable, standalone** demo to demonstrate the capabilities of remote touch through a robotic interface with limited computational overhead and hardware.

Specifications:

1. Tactile Sensor(s)
2. Haptic Display(s)
3. Motion Capture(s)
4. Robotic End Effector(s)



More practically:

Tactile Sensor(s) / Robotic End Effectors(s)

- Robotiq / LEAP hands with a **DIGIT 1.5** on the index finger

Haptic Display(s)

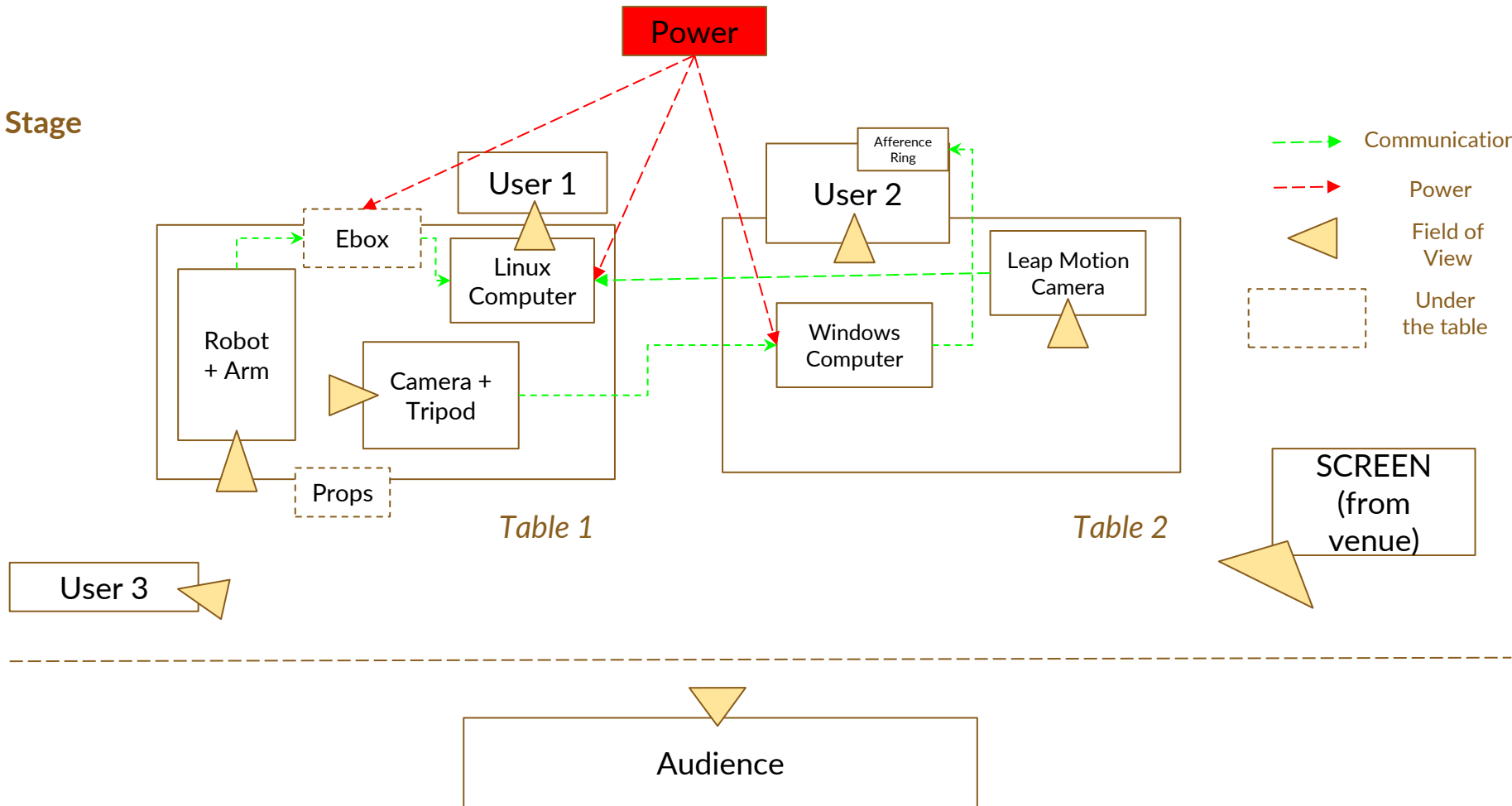
- A single Afference ring for the index finger per user
- Calibration program for the user prior to demo, based on CES 2025 protocol

Motion Capture(s)

- Leap Motion Controller to detect hand pose
- Mapping between user hand pose and end effector pose

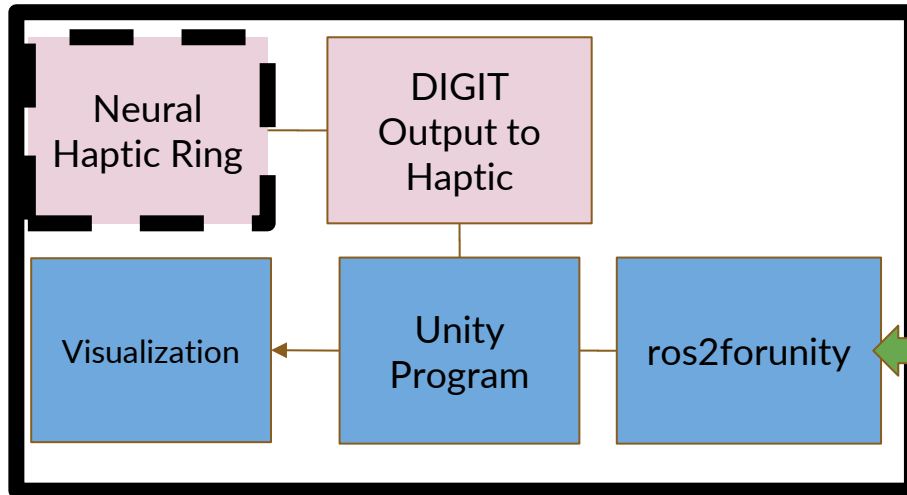
Demo Layout (v3)

Stage

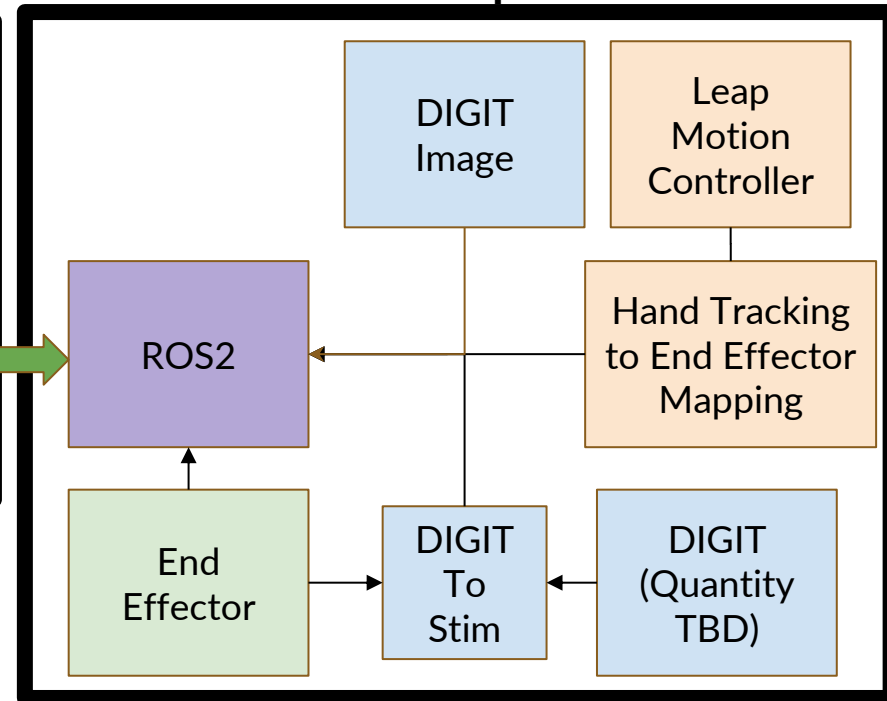


System Diagram

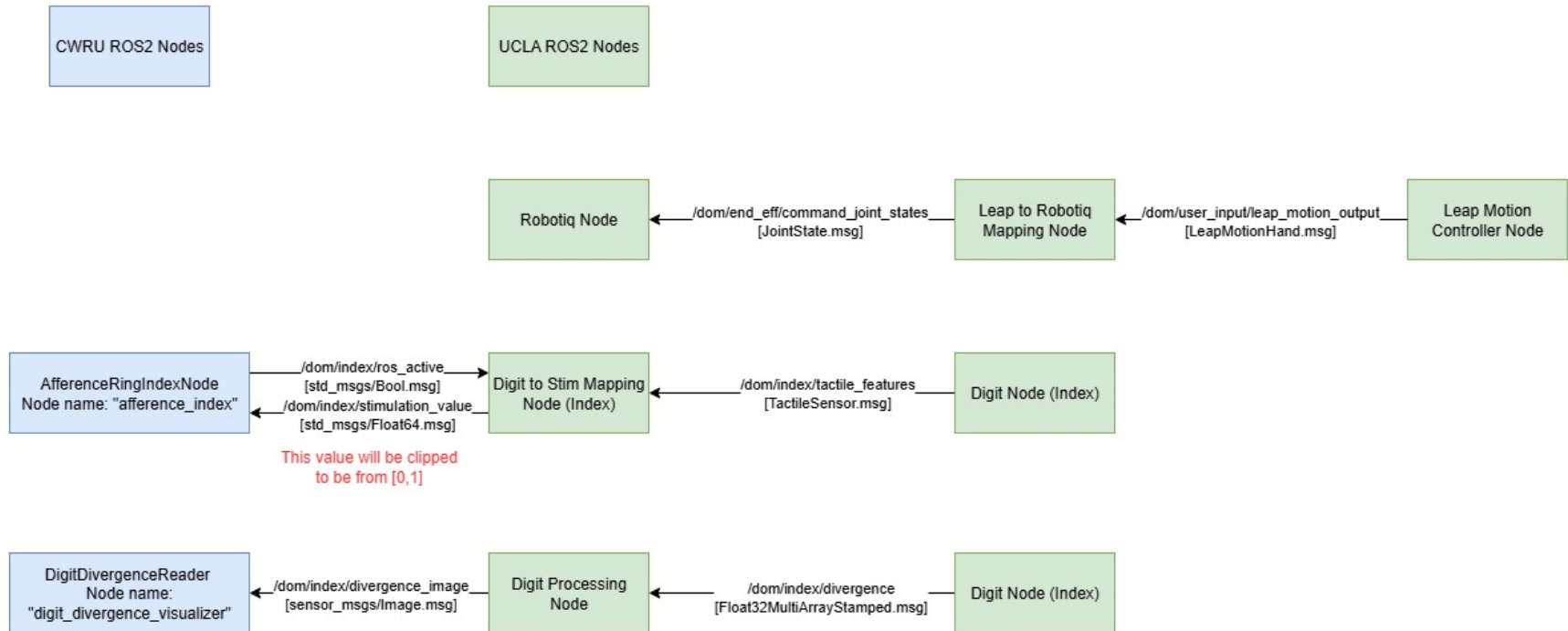
Windows Computer



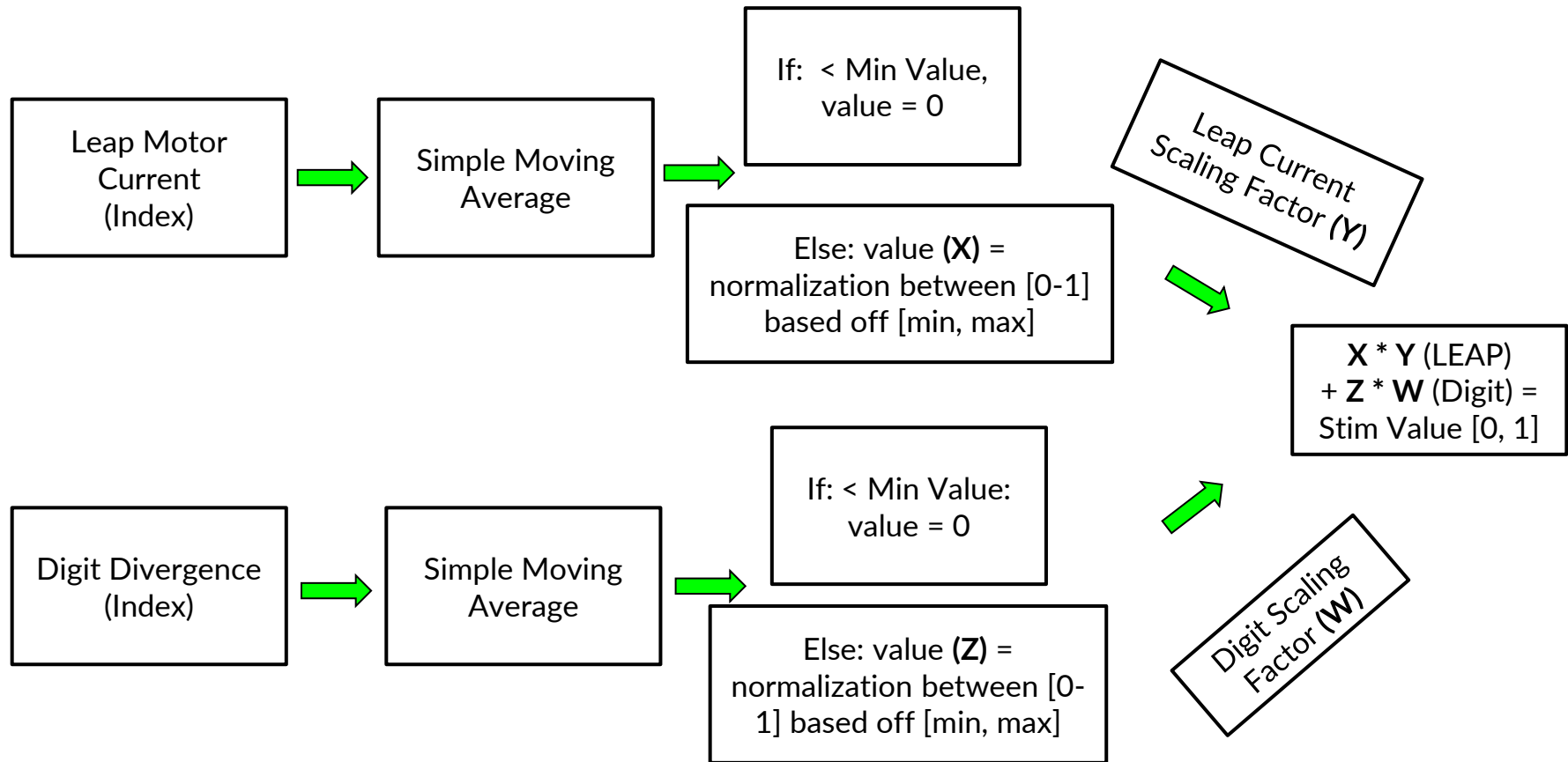
Linux Computer



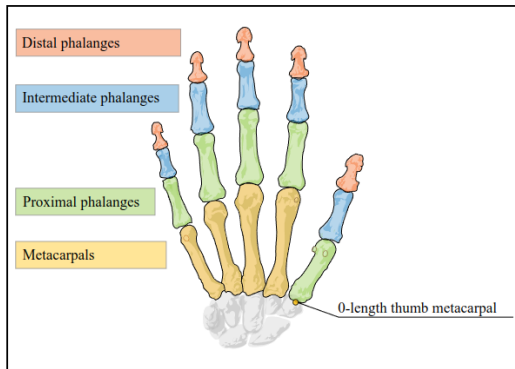
Portable Demo System Interface



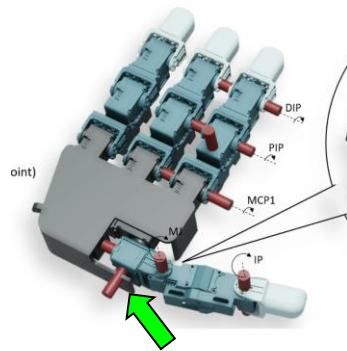
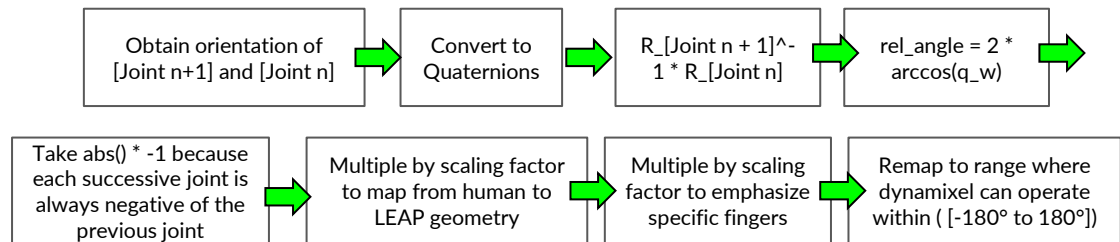
Tactile Sensor to Stim Mapping



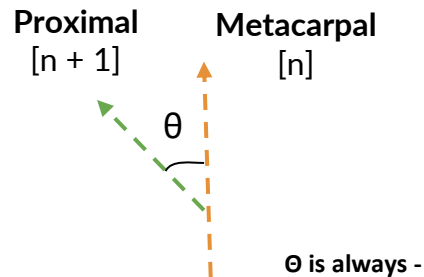
Leap to LEAP Hand Mapping



General Mapping Algorithm



Thumb mapping is weird here...

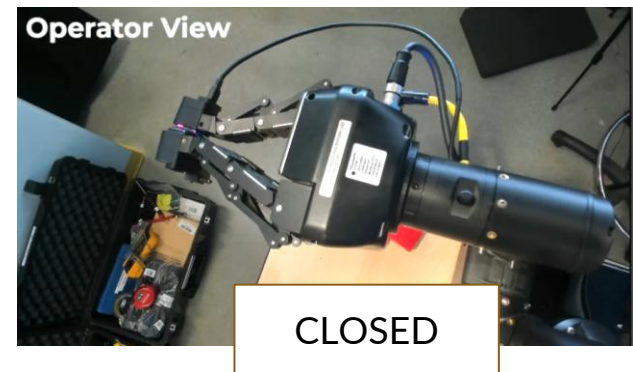
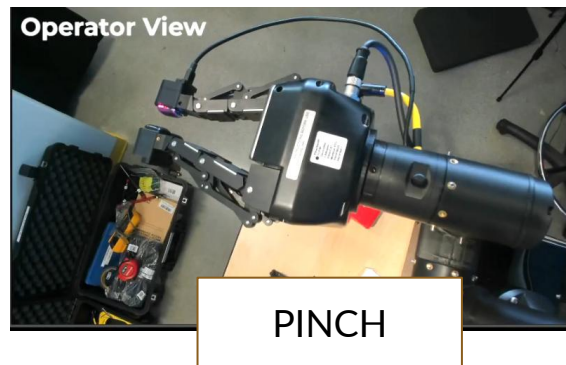
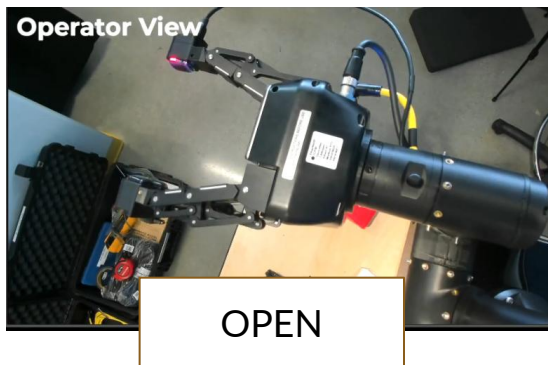


leap_ros2 changes

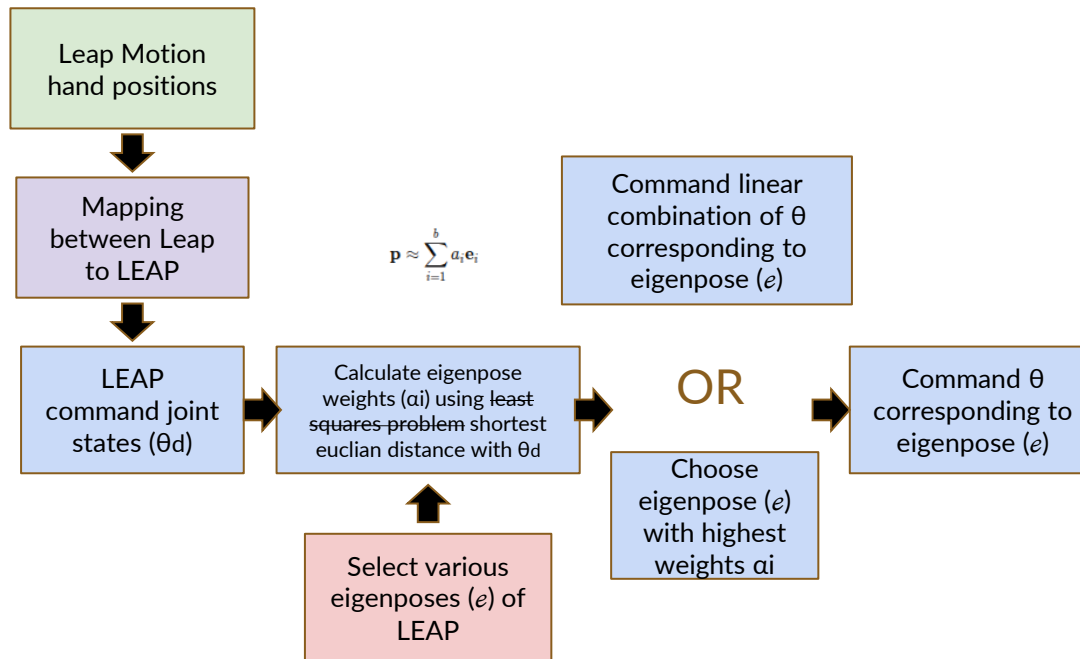
- Updated LEAP to use current based position mode
- Updated LEAP to recover if entering torque out condition

Hand Mapping Improvements

- Switch from LEAP Hand to Robotiq for simpler single trajectory mapping
- Chose three specific poses [Open, Pinch, Closed] ->
 - Associated 3 values with these positions that are used for calibration
 - Created points in between these trajectories to linear interpolate
- Created a region where the gripper moves slowly, and that corresponds to the value of the “pinch”



Eigengrasp Approach



Example Workflow

If you do center the pose, the workflow looks like this:

1. Center the pose:

$$\mathbf{p}_{\text{centered}} = \mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}} - \bar{\mathbf{p}}$$

2. Solve for amplitudes:

$$\mathbf{a} = (\mathbf{E}^T \mathbf{E})^{-1} \mathbf{E}^T \mathbf{p}_{\text{centered}}$$

3. Reconstruct pose (optional):

$$\mathbf{p}_{\text{approx}} = \bar{\mathbf{p}} + \sum_{i=1}^b a_i \mathbf{e}_i$$

1. Use the Actual Pose Directly

Since you don't need to subtract a mean pose, you can work directly with the **actual pose** $\mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$.

- Let $\mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$ be your input pose vector, representing the joint angles of the hand in some configuration.
- Let $\mathbf{e}_1, \mathbf{e}_2, \dots, \mathbf{e}_b$ be your **eigengrasps** (non-orthogonal vectors).

2. Set Up the Linear System

You want to represent $\mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$ as a **linear combination** of the eigengrasps:

$$\mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}} = a_1 \mathbf{e}_1 + a_2 \mathbf{e}_2 + \dots + a_b \mathbf{e}_b$$

This can be written as a **matrix equation**:

$$\mathbf{E} \cdot \mathbf{a} = \mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$$

Where:

- $\mathbf{E}$ is a $d \times b$ matrix where each column $\mathbf{e}_i$ is an eigengrasp.
- $\mathbf{a} = [a_1, a_2, \dots, a_b]^T$ is the vector of amplitudes, i.e., the **weights** you want to solve for.
- $\mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$ is the **actual hand pose vector**.

3. Solve for the Amplitudes

To solve for the **amplitudes** $\mathbf{a}$, you can use the **least-squares solution** since the system is usually overdetermined (i.e., you have more dimensions in $\mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$ than eigengrasps).

The solution is given by:

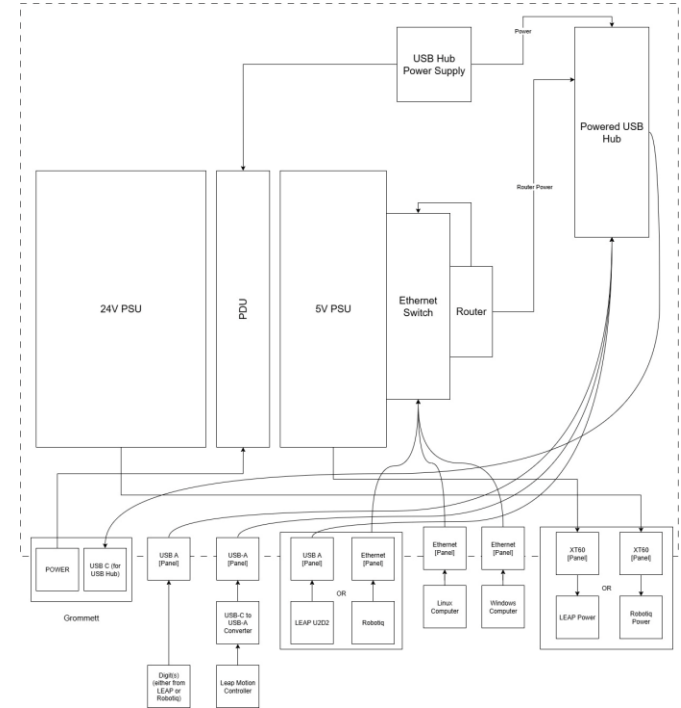
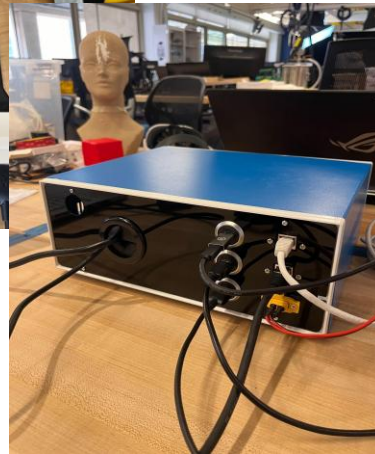
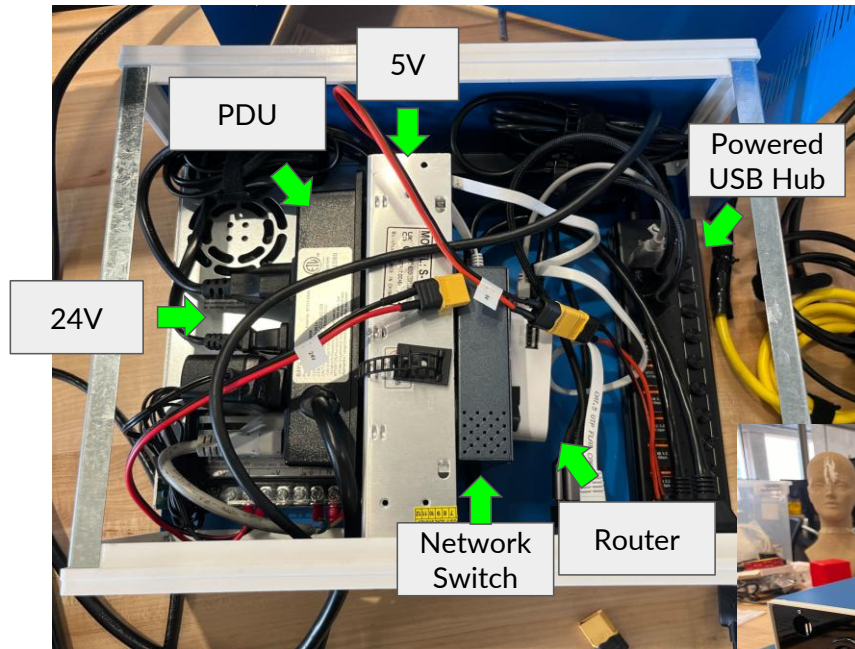
$$\mathbf{a} = (\mathbf{E}^T \mathbf{E})^{-1} \mathbf{E}^T \mathbf{p}_{\text{actual}}$$

BoM & Contingency Plan

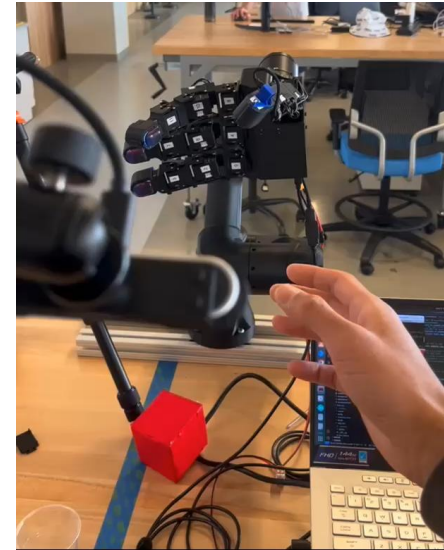
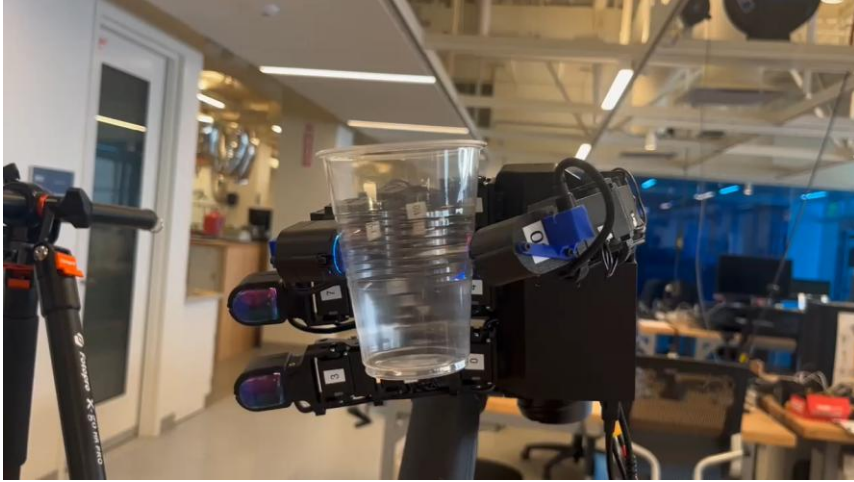
Demo Contingency Plan						
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help						
A1 Demo Issue						
Table1.8						
1	Demo Issue	Subsystem	Likelihood	Severity	Description of Issue	Contingency
4	Swiss to US Power Converter does not work OR damages Ebox	Power	Medium	5	The two step down converters we bought do not work for 240V to 120V, and do not work with the Ebox.	Have to try to find a step down converter in Switzerland that is compatible, otherwise have to show demo video
5	Ebox is confiscated during TSA	Power	Medium	5	Ebox is confiscated during TSA, and we are unable to explain it and it is taken away	May be able to plug in various cables directly into the computer w/o the Ebox (robotiq, digits, networking) and use spare 24V power supply. Otherwise show video
6	Robot Arm Breaks during shipping	Robot Box	Medium	4	Robot Arm breaks in shipping prior to demo	Use back-up arm OR Use spare parts of arm that we printed prior, use super glue / epoxy, show video as worst case backup
7	Leap Motion Tracking is not performing well based on lighting conditions of the room	Leap Motion	Medium	4	Leap Motion tracking is jittery because of light reflections, or conditions of the room, or skin color, or background color, etc	Try to move the Leap Motion or try different angles / settings to improve hand tracking. Try to have user remove sleeves, move ring to lower finger on the hand (though not the middle), bring the right hand in from the left side of the camera, bring both hands into view and then remove the left hand from view, choose a different participant, move the demo to a different location, adjust the table cloth, try to control under the table, change the heights of the Leap motion camera. Have user position themselves in different orientations. Unideal case is that the demo fidelity is fairly bad (i.e. jittery, poor tracking). Worst case show video.
8	Venue is very hot and melts Toblerone	Props	Medium	2		Purchase a different breakable, local food item.
9	Robot Arm Breaks on Stage / During Move on Stage	Robot Box	Low	5	Robot Arm breaks when we are moving the robot arm onto stage, or during the actual demo the arm breaks	
10	Leap Motion Camera is not recognized by the laptop / bandwidth issues	Leap Motion	Low	5	Like in early developments with this project, the Leap Motion camera sometimes had bandwidth issues when other ports were being used, especially conflicting when the Digit was being run.	
11	Robotiq breaks or stops functioning prior to demo	Robotiq	Low	5	Robotiq breaks during shipping or prior to demo	
12	Robotiq is confiscated during TSA	Robotiq	Low	5	Unable to convince TSA, and they take it	
13	Cables (any in the system) get unplugged during	System	Low	5	User walks or trips into cables, and they somehow get	

ONR Portable Demo BoM						
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help						
A1 Demo Version						
Table1.8						
1	Demo Version	Part	Subsystem	Packing Status	Status @ UCLA	Spare
2	Robotiq	Robotiq		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ordered
3	Digits	Digits	Robotiq	Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
4	3D Printed Robot Arm	Robot Box		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
5	Logitech Camera	Human Interface		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
6	Leap Motion Controller	Leap Motion		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
7	Leap Motion Controller Bracket	Leap Motion		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
8	EBox (Robotiq)	System	Power	Packed, no Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE
9	Affence Rings	Human Interface		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
10	Squishy Cube	Props		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ordered
11	Small Cube	Human Interface		Packed, no Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE
12	Magnetic Tray	Tools		Packed, no Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE
13	USB C to USB A Cable (6.6 ft)	Human Interface		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
14	Tape for Affence Rings	Tools		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE
15	Toblerone	Props		Packed, no Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE
16	Cup	Props		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	Spare Ready
17	Blindfold	Props		Packed with Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE
18	HDMI Cable	System		Packed, no Spare	Incorporated	NO SPARE

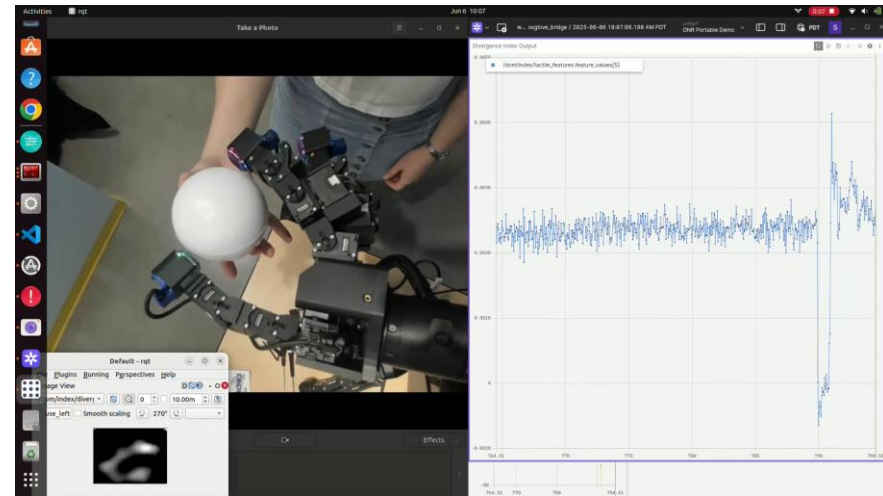
Electronics Box



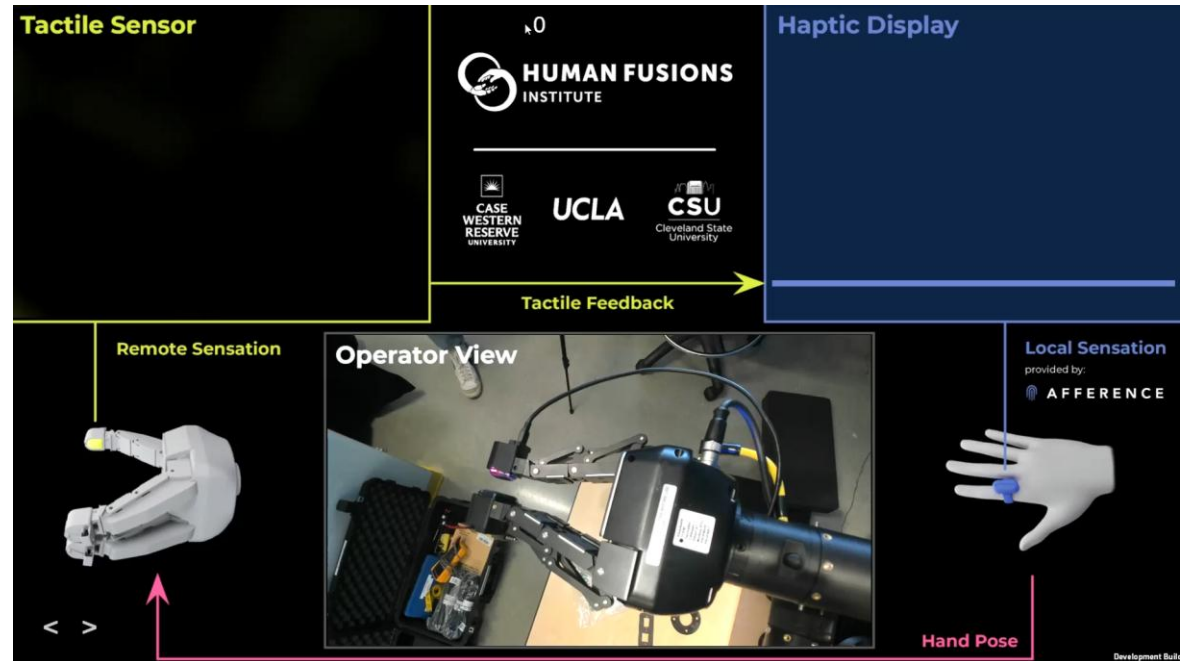
Operation Videos LEAP



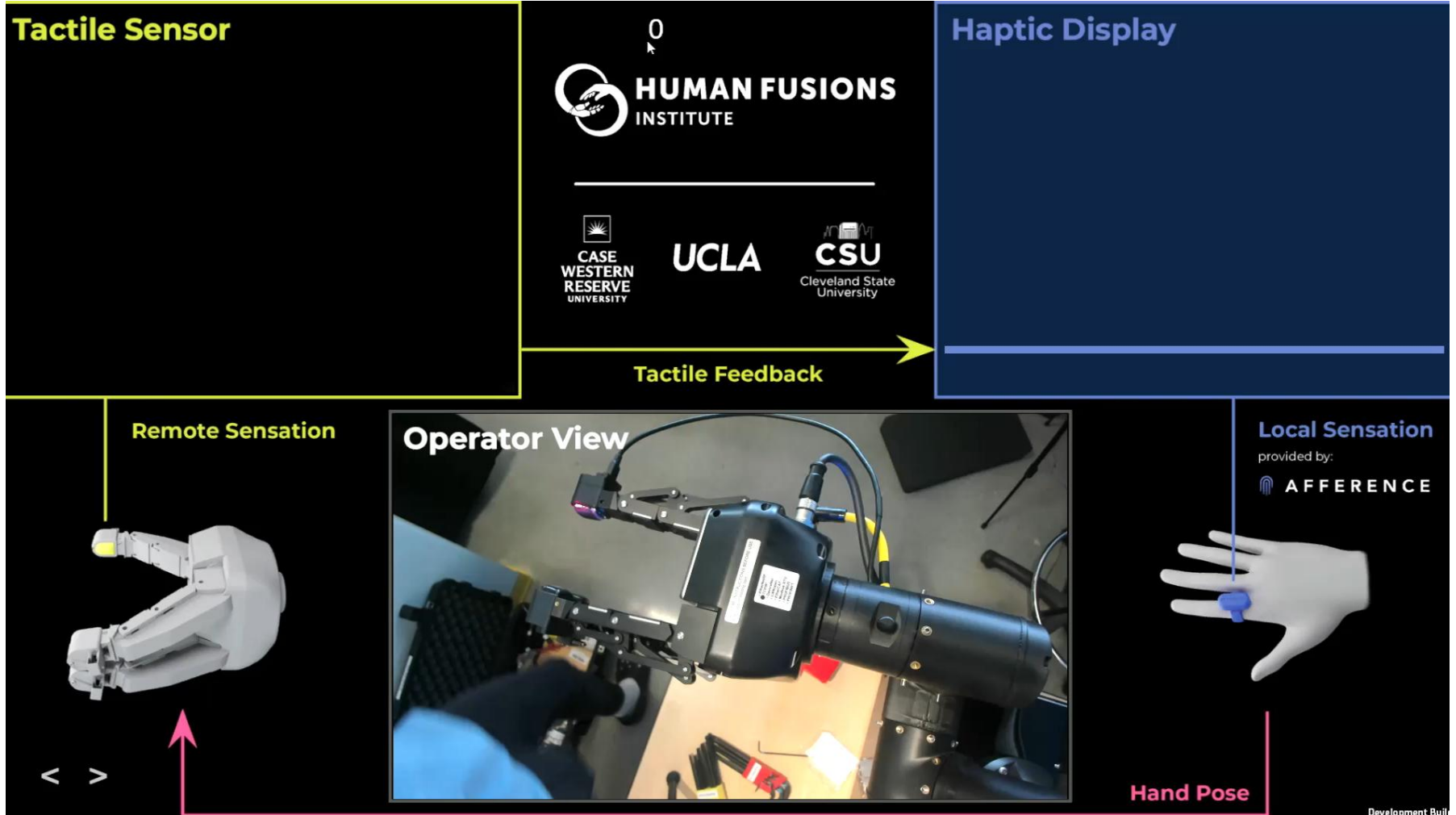
Operation Videos LEAP (cont.)



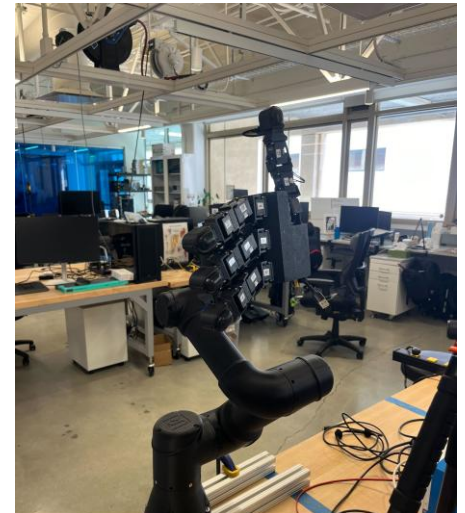
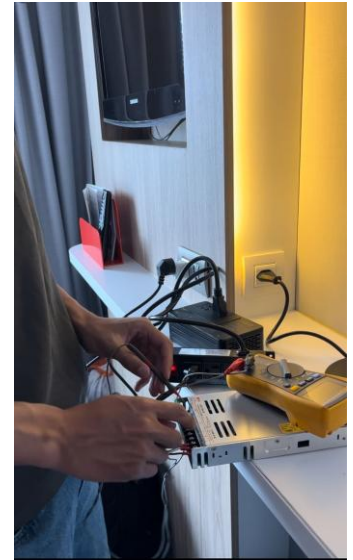
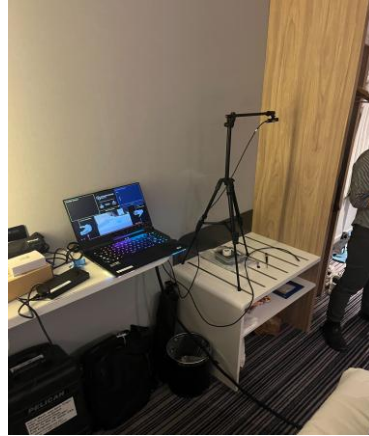
Operation Videos (Robotiq)



Digit Output Visualization



Extra Photos + Videos



Hardware Release Guidelines

1. Prior to doing a release on the overall ONR System CAD, each of the subcomponents should have their own release
 1. This is so that a release of the overall ONR System CAD, is simply matching the revisions of all the components
2. Release candidates should be named: RELEASE <LETTER> - <BRIEF DESCRIPTION>
3. In ONR BoM for subcomponents that have CAD representation, specify the release
4. Within the BoM for the subcomponent, specify a line for CAD that links to the correct CAD revision, as well as the overall technical document
5. Within the technical document, create a tab called “Releases (Mechanical)”, where information regarding the high level changes that were done during the release are enumerated, as well as details such as print settings
6. Within the technical document, add a tab called “Assembly Instructions (Mechanical)”, which will have assembly instructions for the specific release

Software Design Guidelines

1. When ready to release, create a tag of `onr_robotic_system`, which should ideally only be off of `develop` or `main`
 - a. **Ideally**, all subcommits of submodules that are referenced in `onr_robotic_system` would be referencing `develop` or `main`
2. Tags should follow semantic versioning where `onr-demo-v<MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH>`
3. For things in development going to CWRU, often it will be a major version and minor versions are smaller updates
 - a. EX: MAJOR -> a new controller
 - b. EX: MINOR -> a new ReadMe, small QoL updates to the system
 - c. Probably not using PATCH for now...
4. After tags are established, create a release in Github based off of the tag
 - a. Include high level description of the release notes
5. The releases should be designed to just download the release for simplest integration
 - a. `git tag -a onr-demo-v<....> -m 'message'`
 - b. `git tag -a onr-demo-v3.0.0 -m "First official software release of the ONR robotic system"`
 - c. `git push origin onr-demo-v<....>`

NASA Jet Propulsion Lab

Summary of Work

Robotics Mechanical Engineer

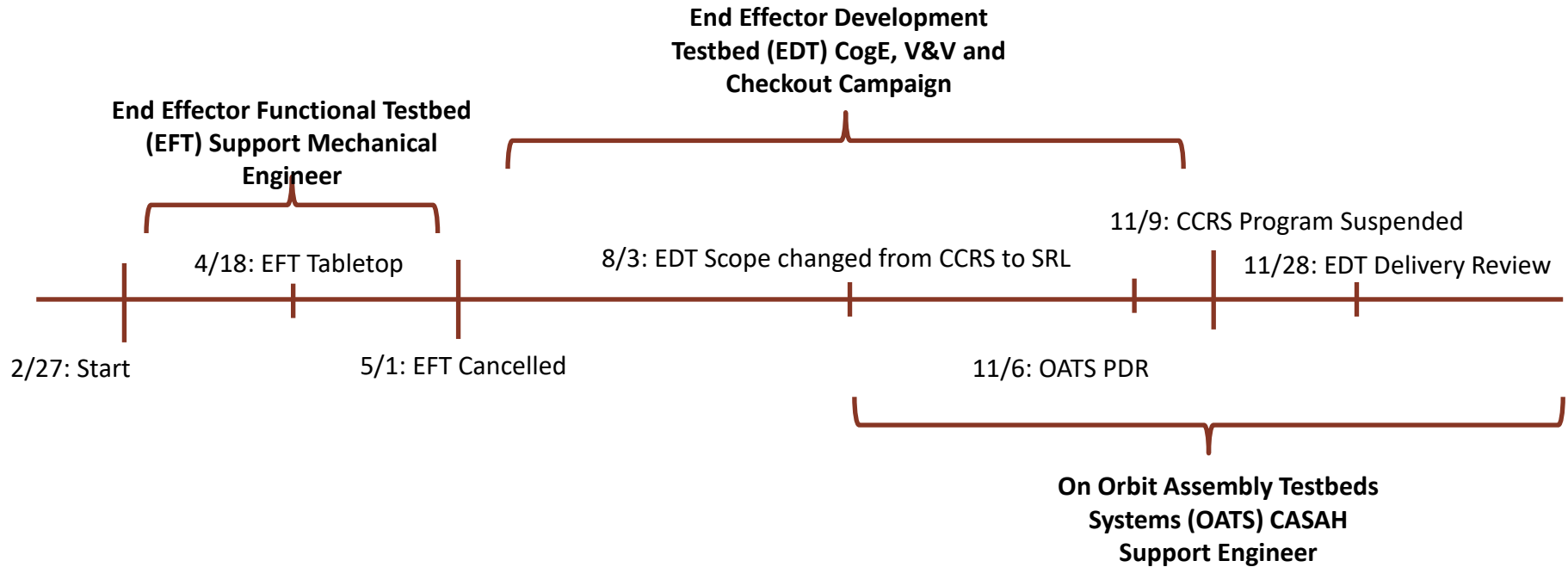
- February 2023 – February 2024

Mechanical Engineering Intern/Co-op

- May 2020 - August 2021

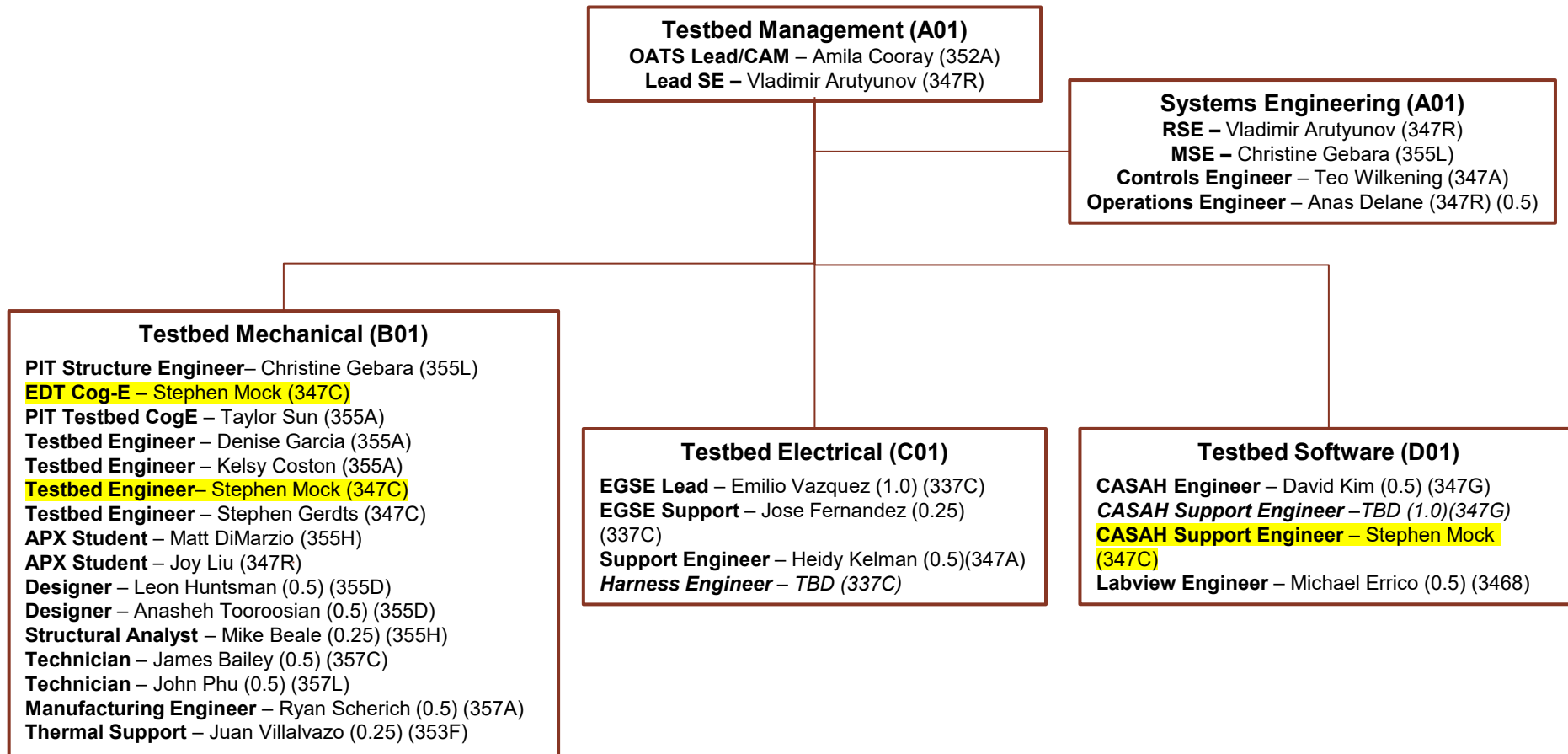
The decision to implement Mars Sample Return will not be finalized until NASA's completion of the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) process. This document is being made available for information purposes only.

Overview – CCRS Testbeds roles held by Stephen Mock



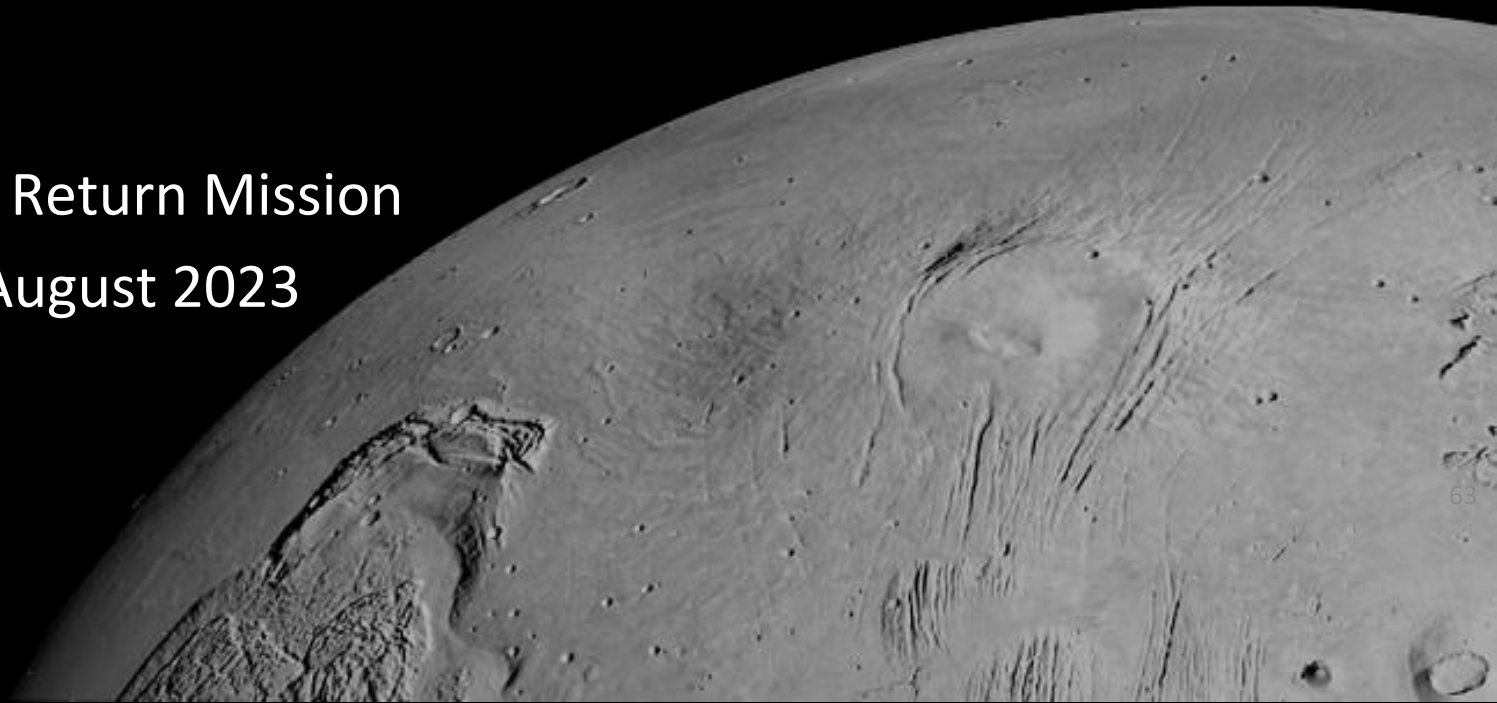
Org chart on next slide

On Orbit Assembly Testbeds Systems (OATS) Org Chart



End Effector Development Testbed (EDT) V&V

Mars Sample Return Mission
May 2023 – August 2023



Preface

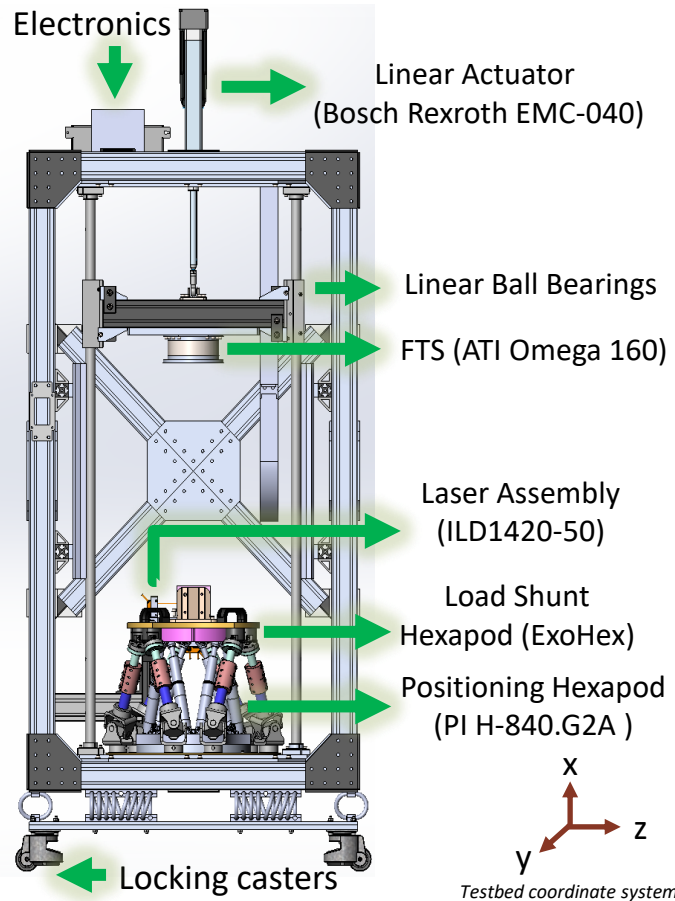
History

The End Effector Testbed (EDT) was created as part of the Capture Contain Return System (CCRS) Testbeds team to provide a venue to test prototype CCRS end effectors starting in Summer 2022. The objective of the testbed was to measure force and torque data during insertion for misaligned interfaces. It was a successor to a previous testbed for which the inner hexapod was originally purchased. With increases in load requirements, a larger 8020 structure and linear actuator were implemented for high axial loading and clocking moments. An ExoHex was designed to enable the inner hexapod to still be used for precise positioning, without having to survive high loads. EDT V&V started in May 2023, but was later rescope in August 2023 to be delivered to the Sample Retrieval Lander (SRL) team in November 2023. As a result, the purpose of the testbed and checkout tests were focused on general functionality rather than CCRS specific implementation. This package highlights the capabilities of EDT, as well as the performed checkouts, and reference information. The checkouts relate to validating the basic functionality of the testbed, particularly for safety purposes.

JPL Team

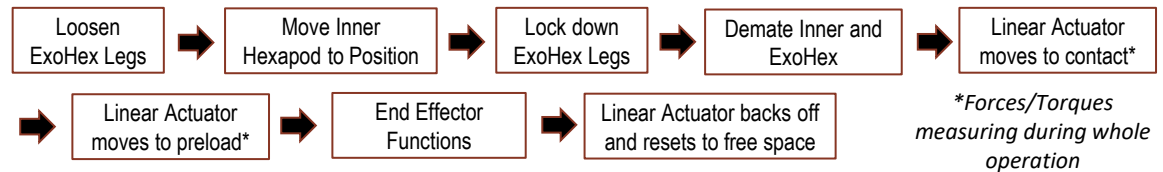
- **EDT V&V:** Stephen Mock (347C)
- **EDT Software:** Michael Errico (3468)
- **EDT Design / Build / History:**
 - Vladimir Arutyunov (347R)
 - Stephen Gerdts (347C)
 - Jake Chesin (347B)
 - Heidy Kelman (347A)
- **EDT CAD:** Heidy Kelman (347A)

EDT Overview



Design Intent: Simulate misalignments in 6DoF such that forces/torques can be measured during end effector functions

CONOPS



Main Component Capabilities

Bosch Rexroth EMC-040

- 305 mm Stroke
- 3.4 kN rated peak axial load
- Absolute encoder
- Optional limit switches (not installed)

ATI Omega 160

- Dual Calibration
- High Load: SI-2500-400
- Low Load: SI-1000-120

ExoHex

- 31kN axial load capacity at zero position
 - based off single leg proof test to 5500N
 - full assembly not proofed
- ±10mm lateral
- ±1.15° rotation (tip/tilt)
- ±0.57° rotation (clocking)
 - *Tested values*

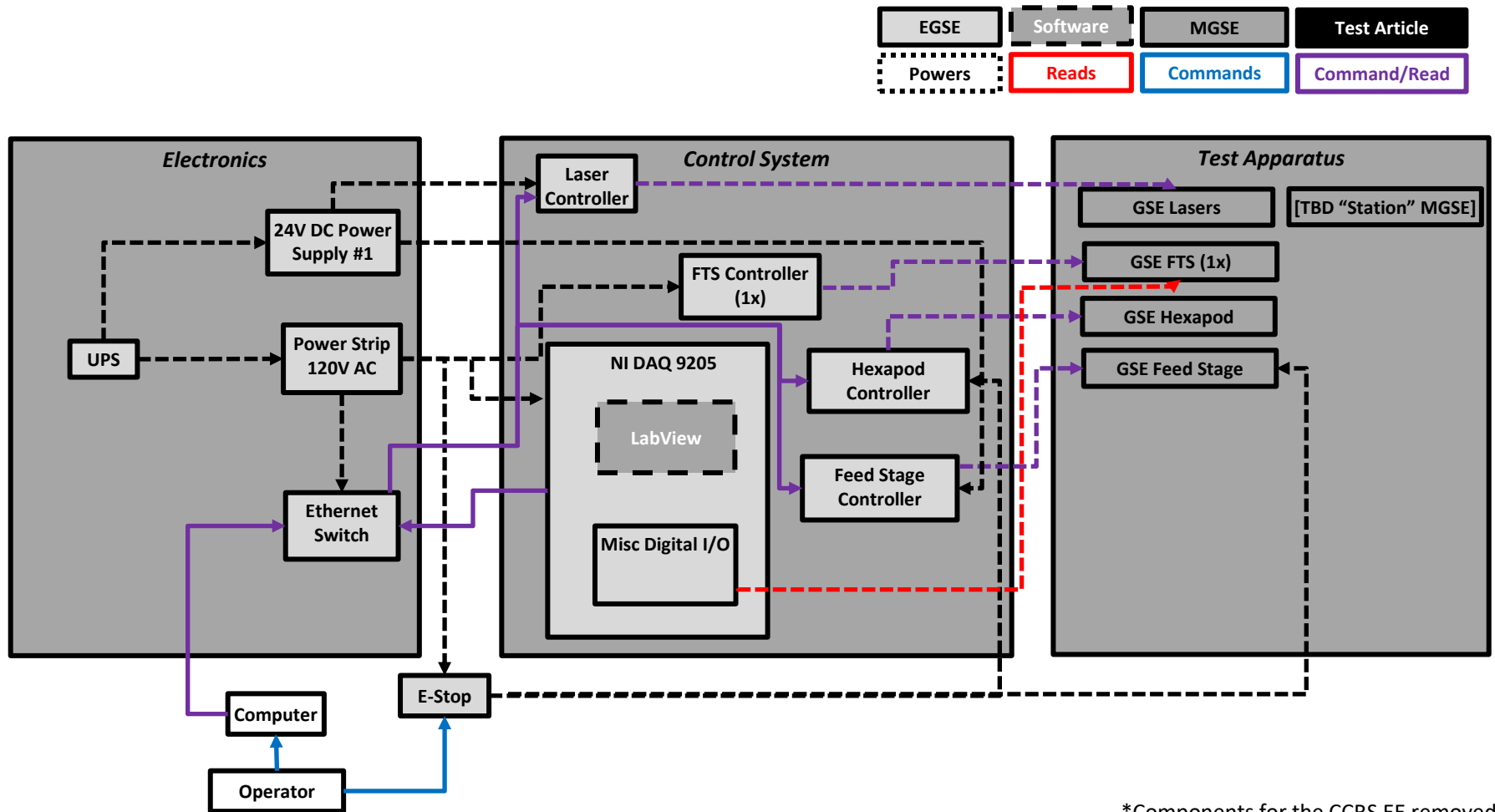
PI H-840.G2A

- 392N Fx load capacity (normal orientation)
- ±50mm lateral
- ±25mm vertical
- ±15° rotation (tip/tilt)
- ±30° rotation (clocking)
- Absolute encoder

Functional Capabilities

- ExoHex for high loads
 - Inner hexapod for precise positioning
 - ExoHex can always be detached
- LabView software for Operator GUI and Control
- FTS recording during test and for force limiting
 - NI DAQ 9205
- Interlock-based E-stop
- Feed Motion Functionality
 - Freespace Move
 - Move to Contact
 - Move to Preload / Move to No Load
- Hexapod coordinate frame changes
- Laser distance measuring capability
- Not Fully Checked Out:*
 - Stiffness Characterization via. laser assembly
 - ExoHex assembly proof loading
 - Linear actuator proof loading
 - Hexapod coord. frame changes in LabView

EDT Functional Block Diagram



*Components for the CCRS EE removed

Main Program Software Design

Configuration File:

- Linear Actuator Feed Command Parameters (position/force limits, speeds)

User Inputs:

- Linear Actuator Feed Commands
 - Free-space move
 - Move to contact
 - Move to pre-load
 - Move to no-load
- Hexapod Free-space Position move
 - Hexapod speed

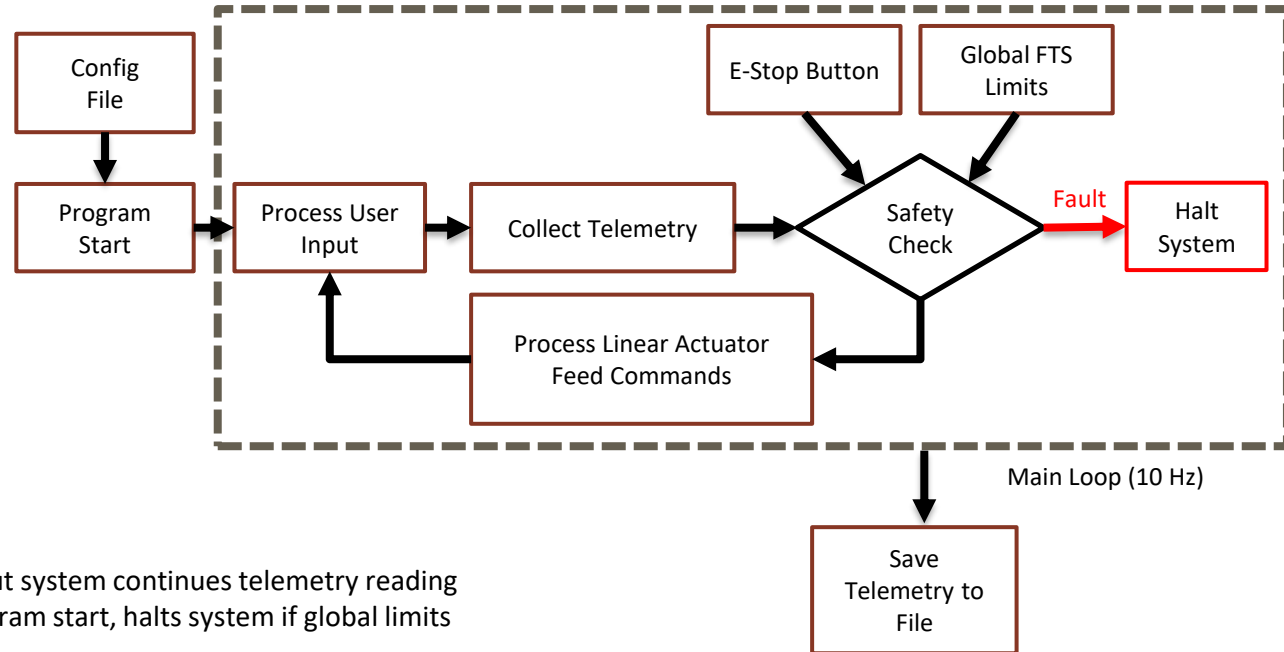
Telemetry:

- Hexapod
 - Absolute Position (X, Y, Z)
 - Absolute Rotation (XRot, YRot, ZRot)
- FTS
 - Force (Fx, Fy, Fz)
 - Torque (Tx, Ty, Tz)
- Linear Actuator
 - Absolute Position
 - Speed

E-Stop: Full system halt with physical E-stop but system continues telemetry reading

Global FTS Limits: Hard-coded and set on program start, halts system if global limits are exceeded during any operation

Software Written by **Michael Errico**



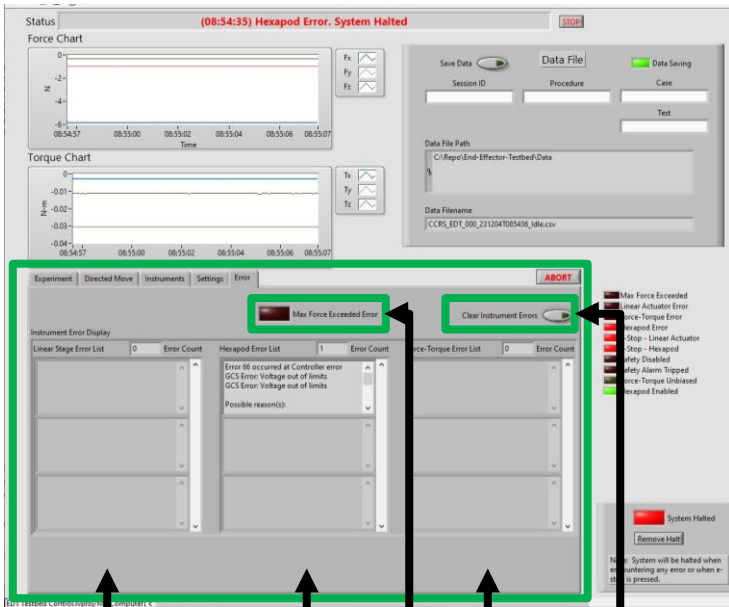
Operator GUI Screen

The screenshot shows the EDI Testbed Control.vi GUI with several key sections highlighted in green boxes and labeled with arrows:

- Testbed Status:** Points to the top status bar showing "(09:29:03) Startup Complete." and a STOP button.
- FTS: Fx, Fy, Fz:** Points to the Force Chart plot area.
- FTS: Tx, Ty, Tz:** Points to the Torque Chart plot area.
- Other testbed functionality (moving hexapod, etc):** Points to the Experiment, Directed Move, Instruments, Settings, and Error tabs.
- Linear Actuator Move commands:** Points to the "Pre-Load force currently only configurable in configuration file." section, which includes buttons for "Stop Movement", "Freespace Move", "Move to Contact", "Move to Pre-Load", and "Move to No-Load".
- Linear Actuator Feed Command Parameters:** Points to the "Directed Move Parameters" list, which includes values for Freespace Max/Min, Move Speed, Force/Torque Thresholds, Contact Move Speed, Contact Force/Torque Thresholds, Pre-Load Move Max/Speed/Force Target/Tolerance, Pre-Load Step Size, No-Load Force Target/Tolerance, and No-Load Force Tolerance.
- Data Filename Settings:** Points to the "Data File" section, which includes fields for Session ID, Procedure, Case, Data File Path, and Data Filename.
- FTS Telemetry:** Points to the "Experiment Data Point" section, which displays real-time data for Force (Fx, Fy, Fz) and Torque (Tx, Ty, Tz).
- Linear Actuator Telemetry:** Points to the "Linear Actuator" section, which displays position, velocity, and torque data.
- Hexapod Telemetry:** Points to the "Hexapod" section, which displays position (X, Y, Z) and rotation (Xrot, Yrot, Zrot) data.
- Error Status Indicators:** Points to the "Error" section, which lists various error conditions such as Max Force Exceeded, Linear Actuator Error, Force-Torque Error, Hexapod Error, E-Stop - Linear Actuator, E-Stop - Hexapod, Safety Disabled, Safety Alarm Tripped, Force-Torque Unbiased, and Hexapod Enabled.
- System Halt and Clear:** Points to the "System Halted" section, which includes a "Remove Halt" button and a note: "Note: System will be halted when encountering any error or when e-stop is pressed."

Operator GUI Screen cont.

Error Tab



Linear
Stage
Errors

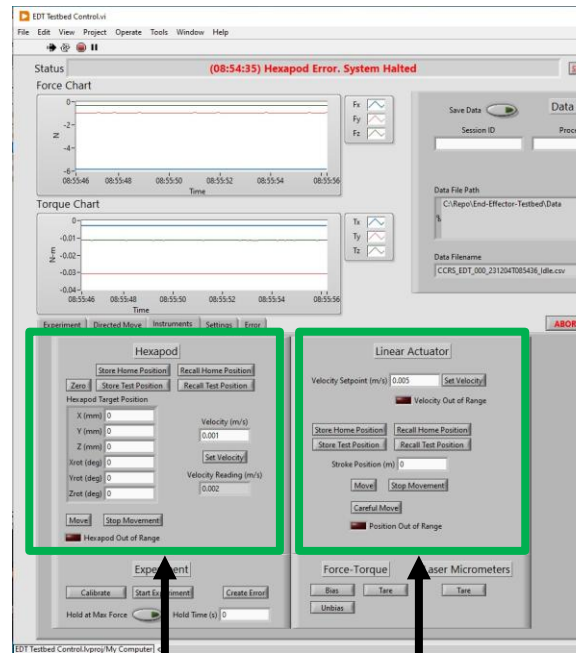
Hexapod
Errors

FTS
Errors

Global Force
Limit Indicator

Clear
Instrument

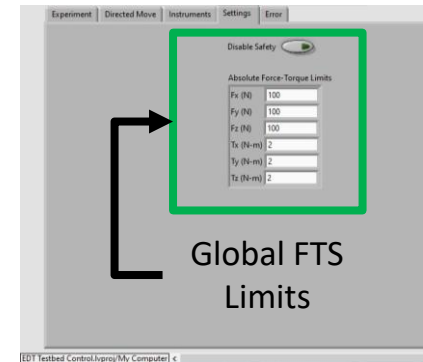
Instrument Tab



Hexapod
Commands

Linear
Actuator
Commands

Settings Tab

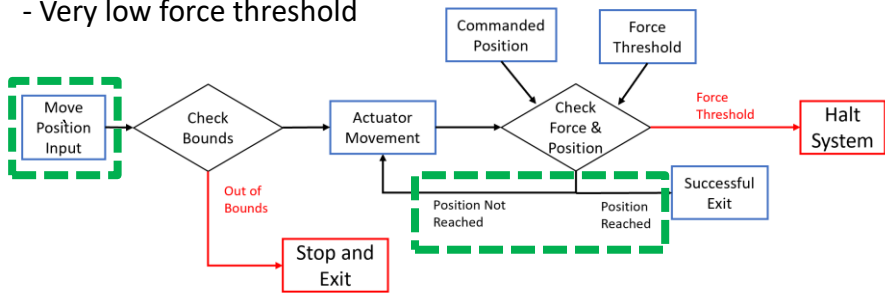


Global FTS
Limits

Linear Actuator Movement Block Diagrams

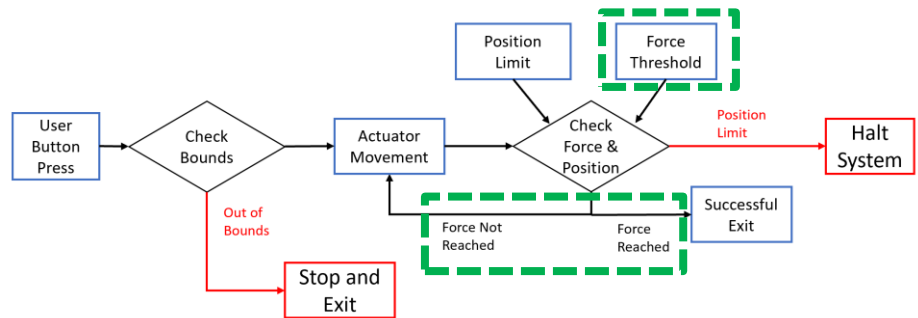
Linear Actuator Free-space Move:

- Higher speed position move with pre-defined limits
- Very low force threshold



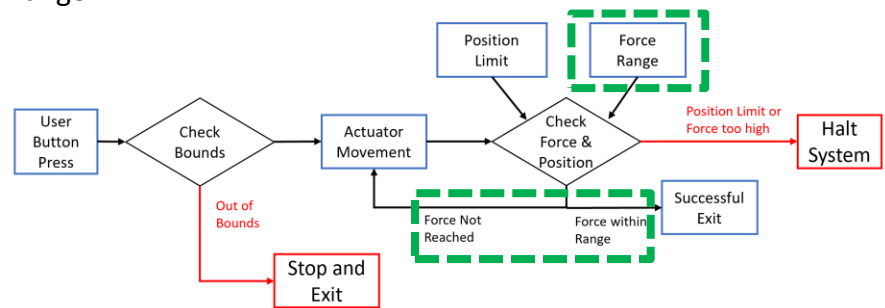
Linear Actuator Move to Contact:

- Slow movement to contact until force threshold is passed



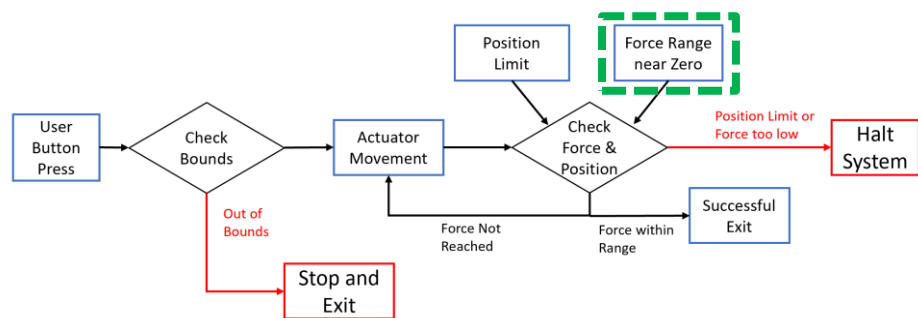
Move to Preload:

- Slow forward movement until target force is within force range



Linear Actuator No-Load Movement:

- Reverse movement to reduce force to near-zero



Checkout Summary

Basic E-Stop Checkout [10] ✓

Objective: Verify E-stop capability to stop motion of both the hexapod and linear actuator during operation, yet still maintain connection and FTS recording. Test how system halts are handled and cleared. Additional testing to see how MicroMove responds to an E-stop being pressed.

Result: E-stop halts motion, maintains connection and continues to record FTS data. System halt can be cleared when E-stop is removed. MicroMove will error when E-stop is pressed, and hexapod can be restarted after E-stop is unpressed.

Basic Hexapod Movement [06] ✓

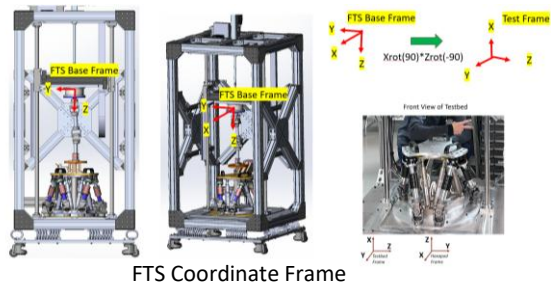
Objective: Move to the maximum 1DoF travel ranges of the hexapod using the testbed coordinate frame. Additionally, test the behavior of the hexapod to stop under global force overload error.

Result: Hexapod moves in accordance with testbed coordinate frame (using vendor provided software) and responds to force overload error in LabView.

Basic FTS Checkout [02] ✓

Objective: Confirm the coordinate system of the FTS for future coordinate transformations.

Result: FTS frame tracks as expected, and coordinate frame change to testbed frame maps correctly

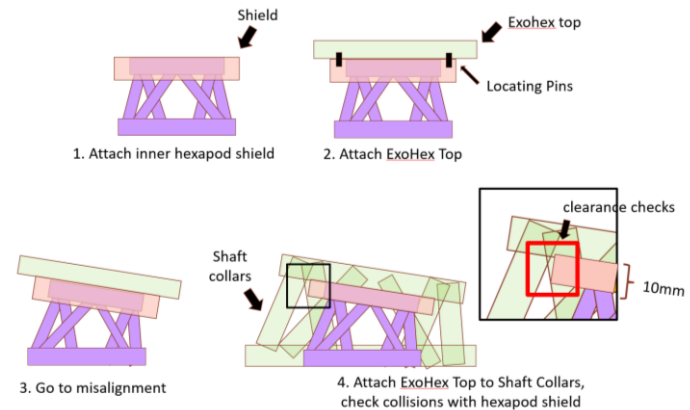


FTS Coordinate Frame

ExoHex Misalignment [09] ✓

Objective: Check for potential collisions between ExoHex strut legs and Inner Hexapod top plate during misalignment, and during potential demate motions (simulated by a hexapod shield).

Result: With the tested subset of misalignments (27 tests), no ExoHex struts were close to collisions. This however is only done for a smaller subset of misalignment and should be performed with actual test misalignments.



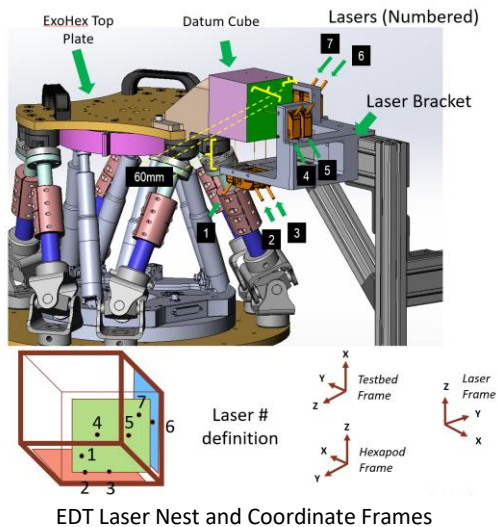
ExoHex Misalignment Test CONOPs

Checkout Summary (continued)

Basic Laser Checkout [03] ✓

Objective: Understand the capabilities of the laser nest assembly when measuring a static cube moving to different positions. Could potentially be used for future stiffness characterization

Result: Lasers measure relative movement accurately, but small errors exist which are likely due to overall misalignment of laser assembly to hexapod.



Basic Feed Motion Checkout [05] ✓

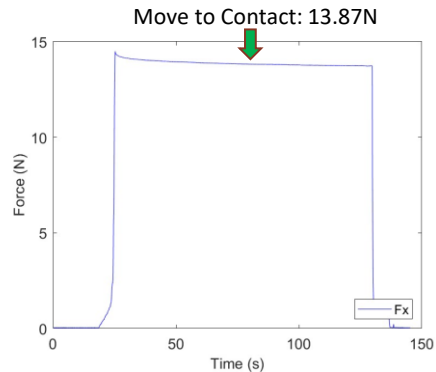
Objective: Test main linear actuator movements (freespace move, move to contact, and move to preload, move to no load).

- *Freespace Move*: higher speed movement to bring the linear actuator to a specific position, with very low force threshold.
- *Move to Contact*: Lower speed movement which moves to a force threshold and stops when it is exceeded (no tolerance).
- *Move to Preload*: Lower speed movement which moves to a specific force value with a given $\pm$ tolerance. Meant to reach the desired preload given by the test requirements.
- *Move to No Load*: Reverse "Move to Contact", in which the actuator moves away from contact so that Free-space Moves can be commanded.

Result:

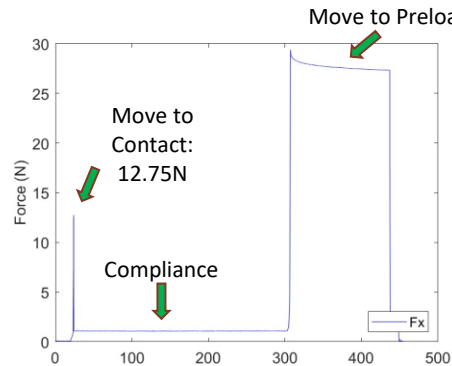
- Linear actuator program demonstrated its intended use for all four different types of movements through applying a specific preload to an aluminum can.
- Linear actuator triggers halt when overall testbed force thresholds are exceeded, preventing users from inputting new commands.

Basic Feed Motion Checkout Results



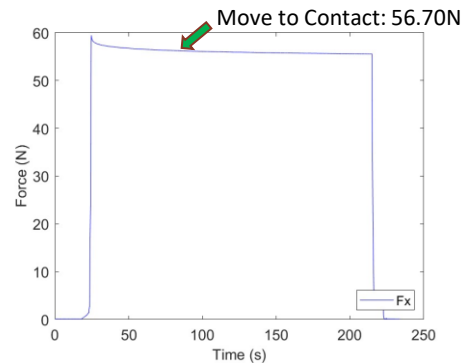
Case 2, Test 2

- Move to Contact to 10N, system stopped at 13.87N



Case 3, Test 2

- Move to Contact to 10N, system stopped at 12.75N
- Move to Preload to 25N, system stopped at 27.64N

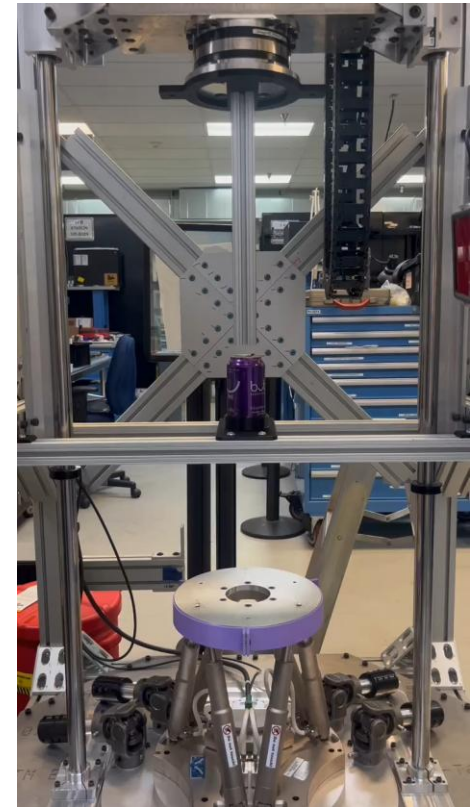


Case 3, Test 3

- Move to Contact to 50N, system stopped at 56.70N

Notes:

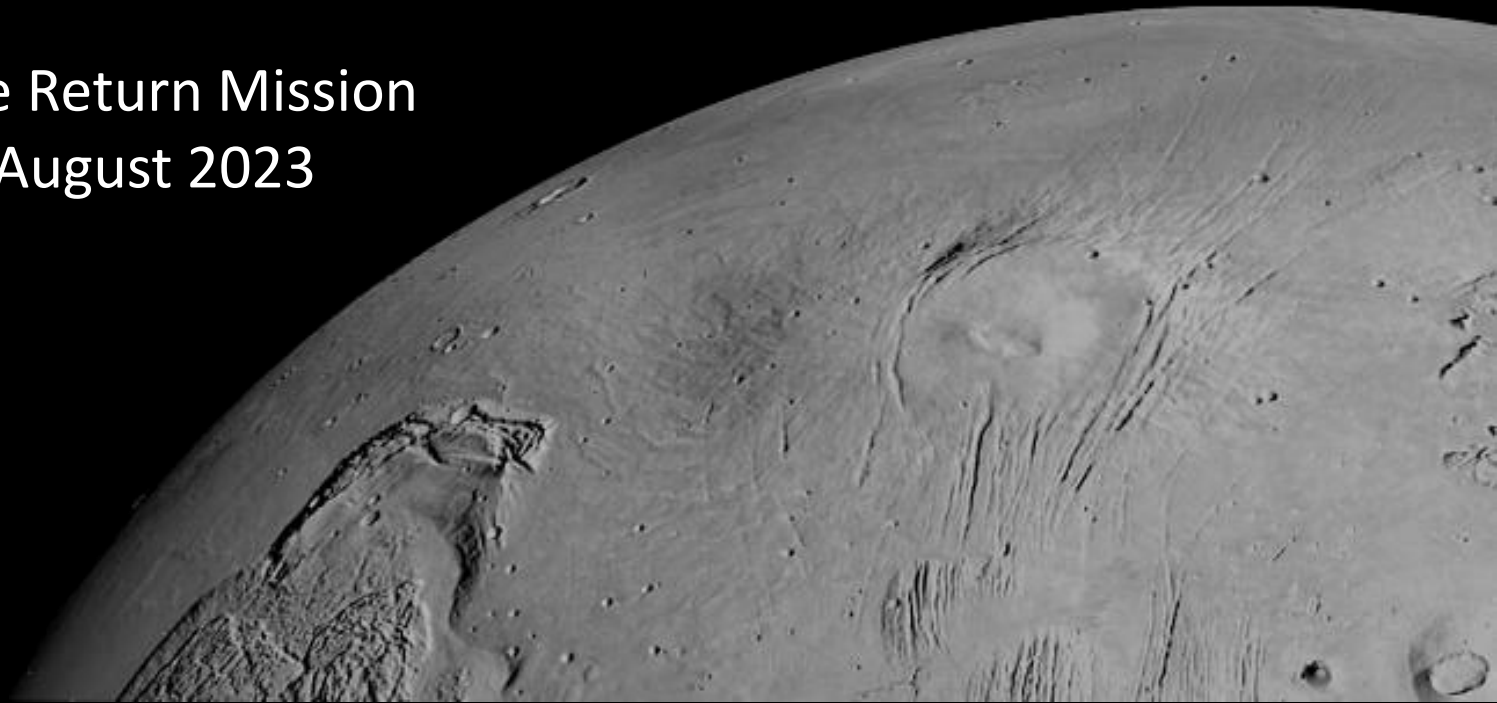
- The system does not halt perfectly as the force build-up occurs quickly; thus, the system does not stop exactly when the force threshold is crossed.
 - Move to contact speed: 1mm/s
 - Move to preload speeds 0.5mm/s
- There is some compliance in the aluminum can such that when the linear actuator stops, the force decreases



Move to Contact
Demonstration (video)

Laser Transform Module for End Effector Development (EDT) Testbed

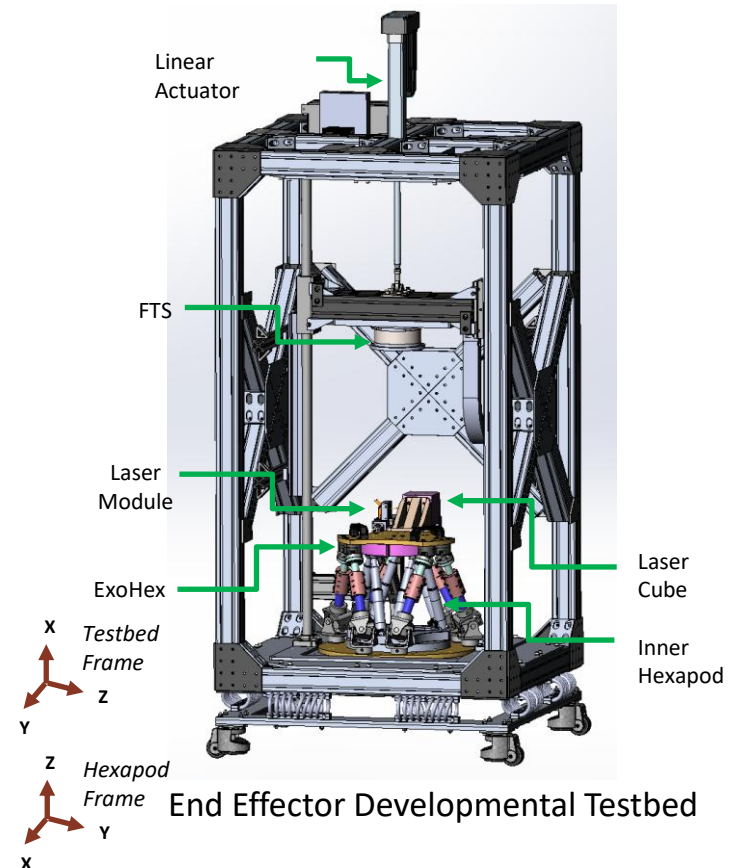
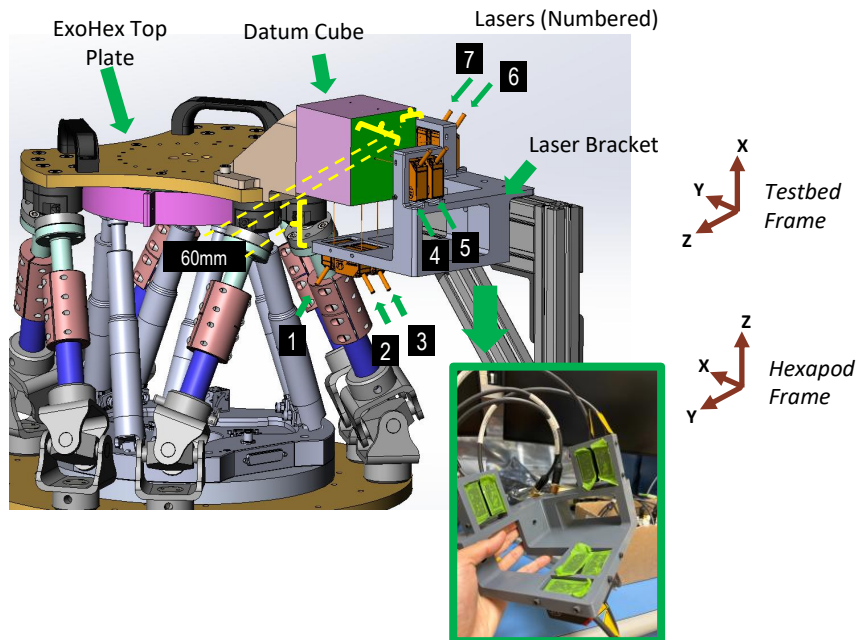
Mars Sample Return Mission
May 2023 – August 2023



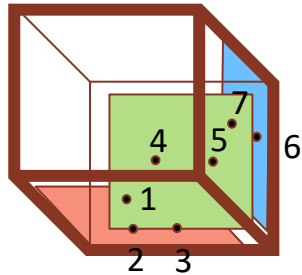
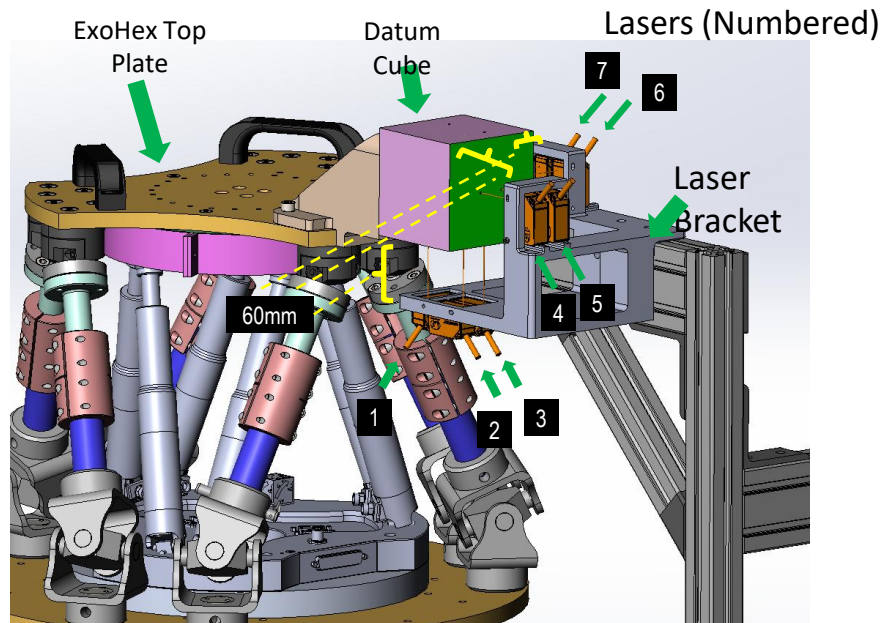
Testbed Background + Objective

Objective: Characterize stiffness of ExoHex top plate under proof load

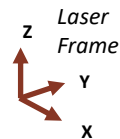
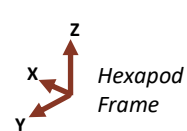
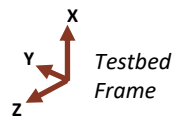
1. Datum (cube) mounted to top plate is considered rigid with hexapod top plate which will deform under external load
2. Lasers points to cube and measure changes in position in free space due to distortions
3. Using 7 lasers, perform transform calculation to define full homogenous transform of cube



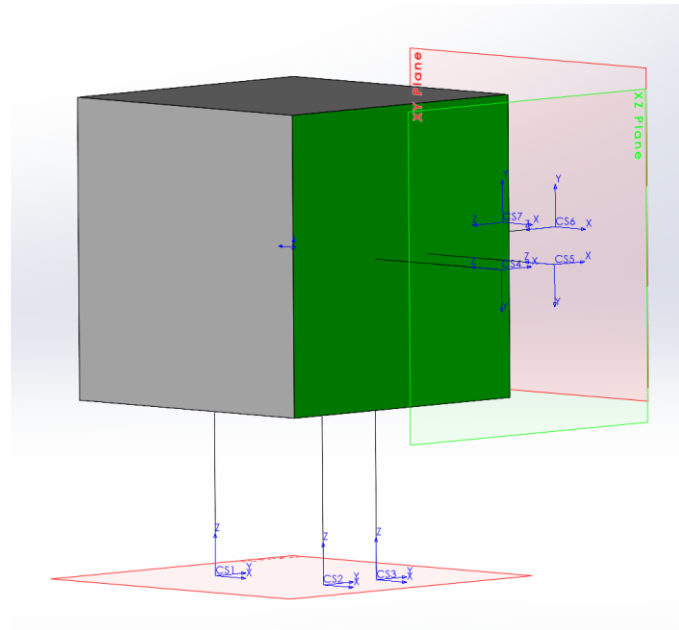
Coordinate Frame Definition



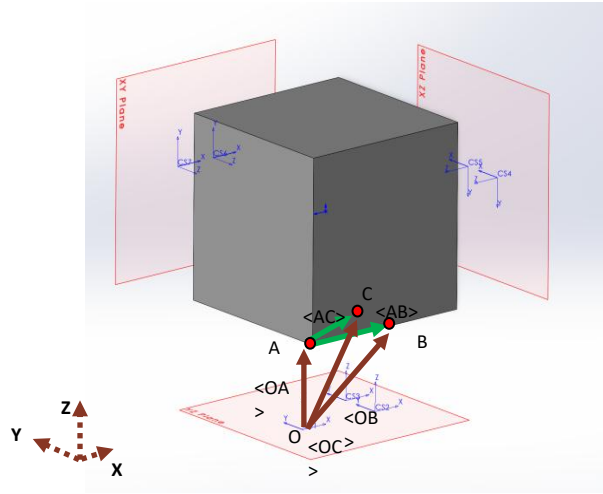
Laser #
definitio
n



- Separate CAD model to simulate rotations / translations
- Lasers represented as (very small diameter) extrusions up to surface for ground truth generation from nominal laser positions → SolidWorks sensors
- Laser Frame → Testbed Frame is $R_y(-90) * R_x(90)$



Main Vector Definition



Origin Frame (coincident with CS1)

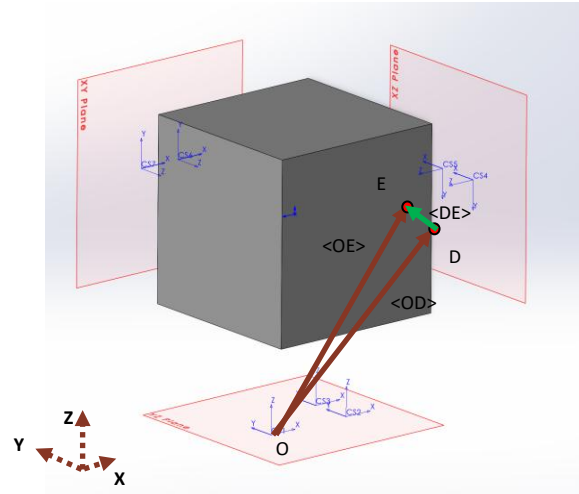
Defined in Origin Frame

Vector of Interest: $\langle AC \rangle = \langle OC \rangle - \langle OA \rangle$, $\langle AB \rangle = \langle OB \rangle - \langle OA \rangle$

Where $\langle OC \rangle = H03 * P3$, $\langle OB \rangle = H02 * P2$, $\langle OA \rangle = H01 * P1$ where P1, P2, P3 are the magnitude of the laser (in Z axis)

$$\hat{n} = \frac{\vec{AB} \times \vec{AC}}{\|\vec{AB} \times \vec{AC}\|} \quad (3)$$

```
353 Eigen::Vector3d ab = b - a;
354 Eigen::Vector3d ac = c - a;
355
356 Eigen::Vector3d n = ab.cross(ac).normalized();
```



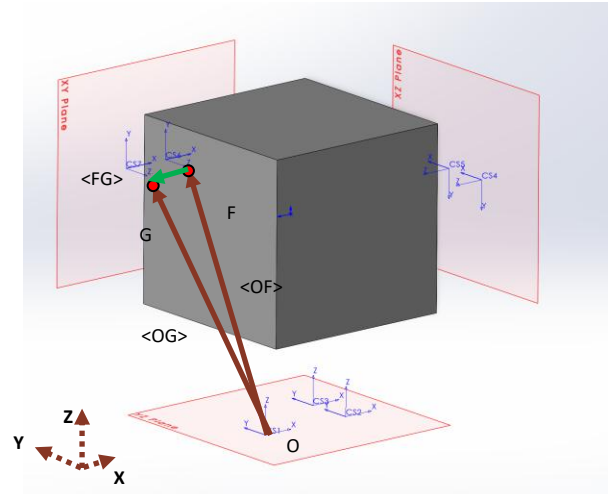
Defined in Origin Frame

Vector of Interest: $\langle DE \rangle = \langle OE \rangle - \langle OD \rangle$

Where $\langle OE \rangle = H05 * P5$, $\langle OD \rangle = H04 * P4$ and P4, P5 are the magnitude of the laser (in Z axis)

$$\frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}\|} \cdot \vec{\theta} = \frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}\|} \cdot D - \alpha \quad (9)$$

```
358 Eigen::Vector3d de = e - d;
359 Eigen::Vector3d n_cross_de = n.cross(de).normalized();
```



Defined in Origin Frame

Vector of Interest: $\langle FG \rangle = \langle OG \rangle - \langle OF \rangle$

Where $\langle OG \rangle = H07 * P7$, $\langle OF \rangle = H06 * P6$ and P6, P7 are the magnitude of the laser (in Z axis)

$$\frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}\|} \cdot \vec{\theta} = \frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}\|} \cdot F - \beta \quad (12)$$

```
361 Eigen::Vector3d fg = g - f;
362 Eigen::Vector3d n_cross_fg = n.cross(fg).normalized();
```


Rotation (Orientation) Ground Truth Tests

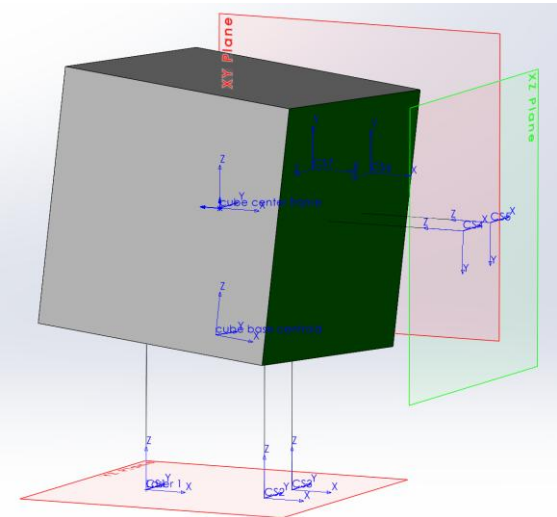
or in rotation matrix form:

$$R = \begin{bmatrix} \left(\frac{\hat{n} \times DE}{\|\hat{n} \times DE\|}\right)^T \\ \left(\frac{\hat{n} \times FG}{\|\hat{n} \times FG\|}\right)^T \\ -\hat{n}^T \end{bmatrix} \tag{17}$$

```
393 Eigen::Matrix3d R_ltm;  
394 R_ltm << -n_cross_de(0), -n_cross_fg(0), n(0), -n_cross_de(1), -n_cross_fg(1),  
395          n(1), -n_cross_de(2), -n_cross_fg(2), n(2);
```

Ground Truth Test Cases

Test #	Δ X (mm)	Δ Y (mm)	Δ Z (mm)	Zrot (deg)	Yrot (deg)	Xrot (deg)	IK Rot Match?	IK Pos. Match?
1	0	0	0	0	0	0		
2	0	0	0	1	0	0		
3	0	0	0	0	1	0		
4	0	0	0	0	0	1		
5	0	0	0	1	2	0		
6	0	0	0	1	2	3		
7	0	0	0	-2	-5	3		



Rotation Test Cases

- Test individual rotations, as well as rotations in sequence, as well as with either +/- signage
- Correctly tracked Euler Angles (for both positive and negative), as well as sequences of Euler Angles
 - Rounded (to the first decimal place) → might be due to sig-figs on laser output from CAD
- When rotating about centroid of cube, the cube base centroid also translates, which was captured in the positional inverse kinematics

Translation Ground Truth Tests

$$\begin{bmatrix} \hat{n}^T \\ \left(\frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}\|} \right)^T \\ \left(\frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}\|} \right)^T \end{bmatrix}_{(3 \times 3)} \{ \underline{\mathcal{O}} \}_{(3 \times 1)} = \begin{Bmatrix} \hat{n} \cdot A \\ \frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{DE}\|} \cdot D - \alpha \\ \frac{\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}}{\|\hat{n} \times \vec{FG}\|} \cdot F - \beta \end{Bmatrix}_{(3 \times 1)} \quad (13)$$

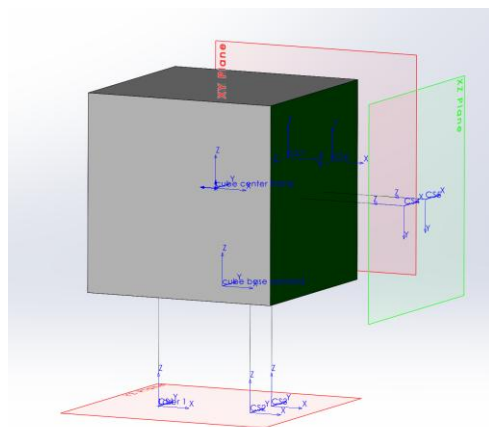
```

364 Eigen::Matrix3d A;
365 A << n(0), n(1), n(2), n_cross_de(0), n_cross_de(1), n_cross_de(2),
366     n_cross_fg(0), n_cross_fg(1), n_cross_fg(2);
367
368 Eigen::Vector3d rhs;
369 rhs << n.transpose() * a,
370     n_cross_de.transpose() * d + laser_target_tool_axis_offset_,
371     n_cross_fg.transpose() * f + laser_target_tool_axis_offset_;
372
373 Eigen::FullPivLU<Eigen::Matrix3d> lu(A);
374 Eigen::Vector3d origin = lu.solve(rhs);

```

Ground Truth Test Cases

Test #	Δ X (mm)	Δ Y (mm)	Δ Z (mm)	Zrot (deg)	Yrot (deg)	Xrot (deg)	IK Rot. Match ?	IK Pos. Match?
1	0	0	0	0	0	0		
2	+2.5	0	0	0	0	0		
3	-2.5	0	0	0	0	0		
4	0	+2.5	0	0	0	0		
5	0	0	+2.5	0	0	0		
6	+2.5	+1	0	0	0	0		
7	+2.5	0	+1	0	0	0		
8	0	+2.5	+1	0	0	0		
9	+2.5	+1	+5	0	0	0		



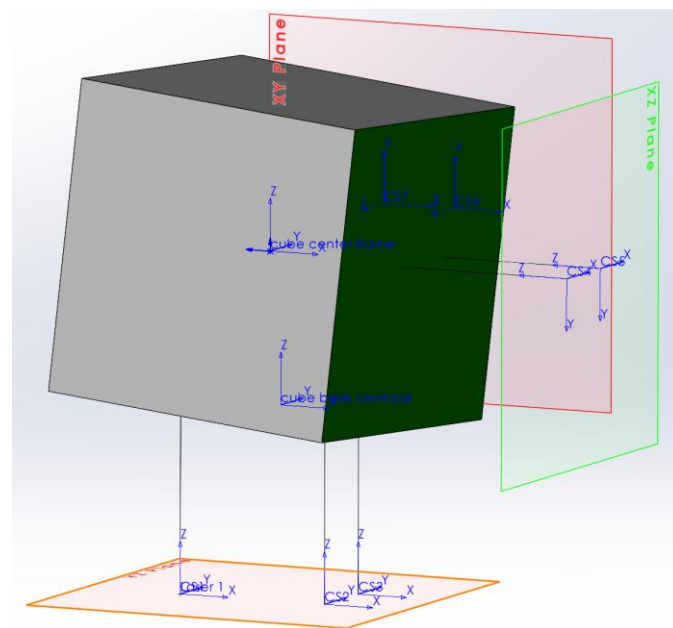
Translation Test Cases

- Test individual translations, as well as multiple translations, as well as with either +/- signage
- Tests worked in accordance with translations (and had no rotations)
- Rounded (to the first decimal place) → might be due to sig-figs on laser output from CAD

Combined Ground Truth Tests

Ground Truth Test Cases

Test #	ΔX (mm)	ΔY (mm)	ΔZ (mm)	Zrot (deg)	Yrot (deg)	Xrot (deg)	IK Rot. Match ?	IK Pos. Match?
1	5	7.5	10	-2	-5	3		
2	-5	-7.5	-10	-2	-5	3		
3	-5	-7.5	-10	2	5	-3		
4	1	3	5	2	0	0		
5	5	3	1	0	3	0		
6	3	2	1	-5	0	0		

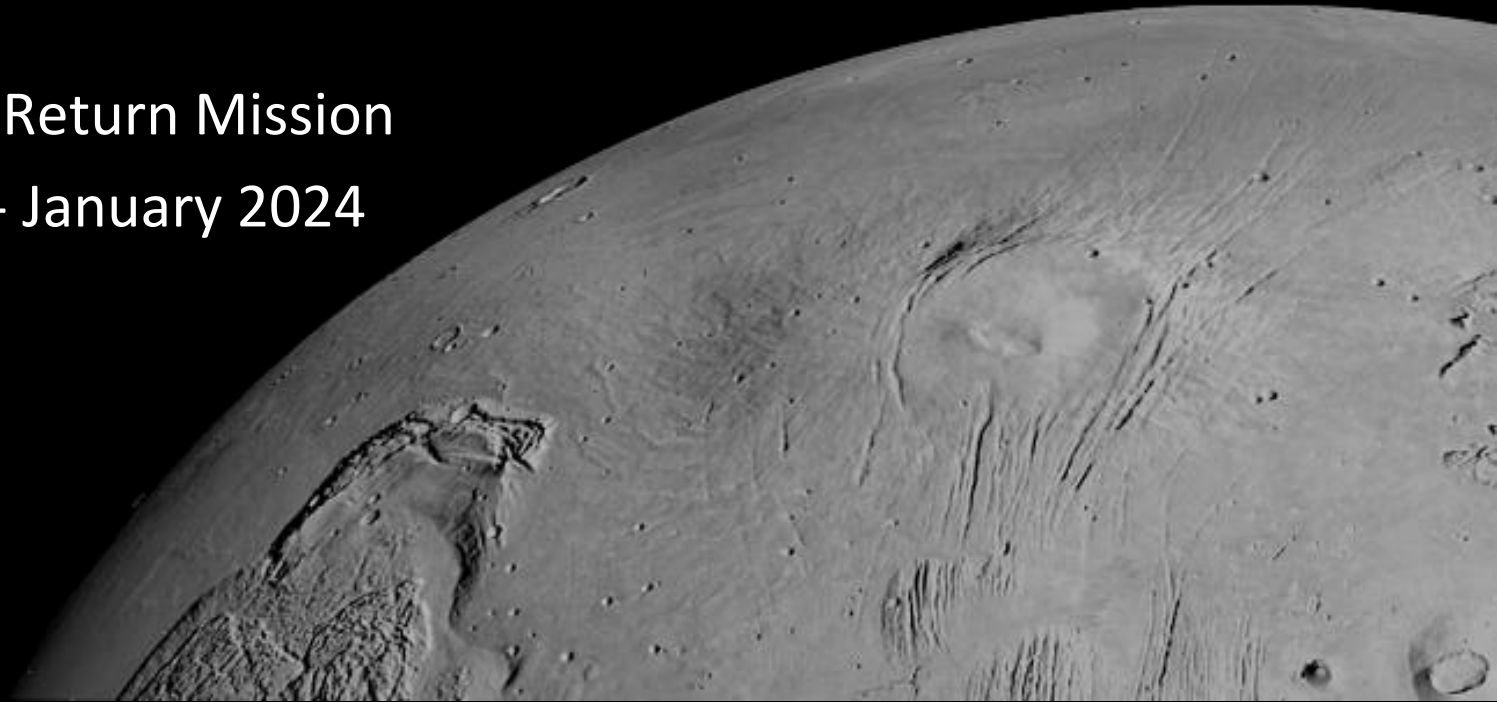


Combined Test Cases

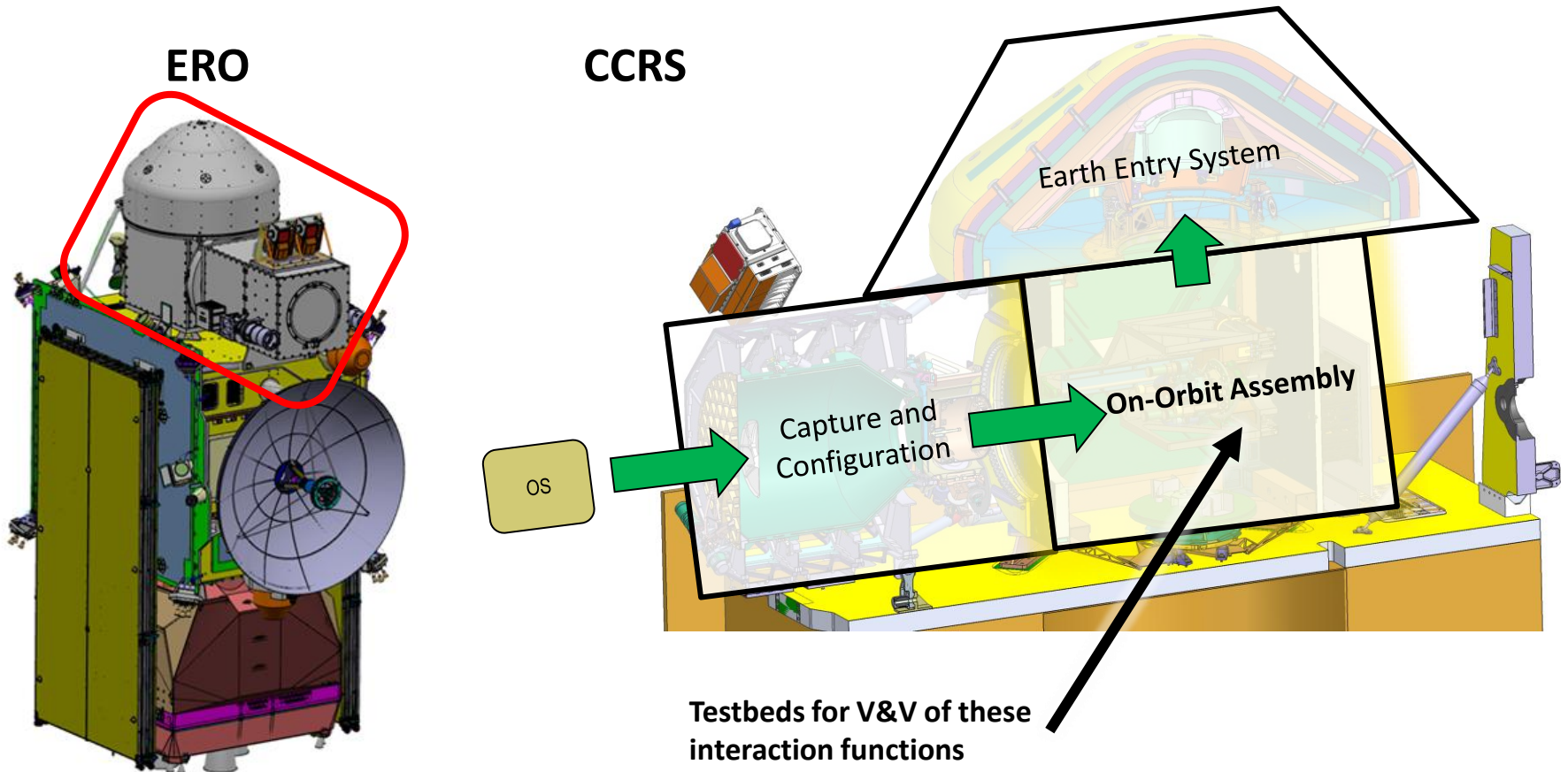
- Test both translations and rotations at centroid of cube
 - Every case works for the inverse kinematics!
- Rounded (to the first decimal place) → might be due to sig-figs on laser output from CAD

Software Development Summary of Work

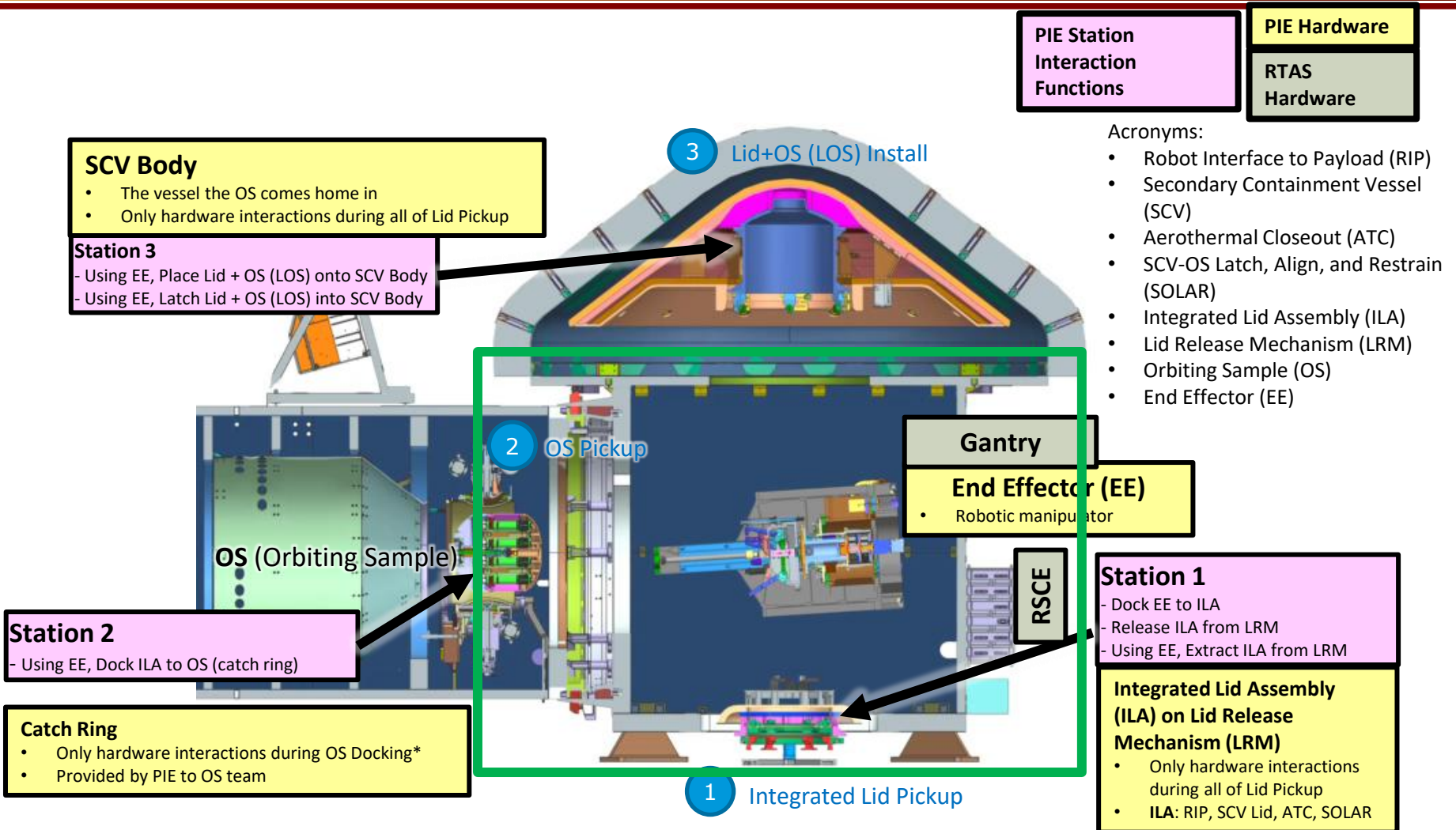
Mars Sample Return Mission
August 2023 - January 2024



Capture, Containment, and Return System (CCRS) in ERO Context



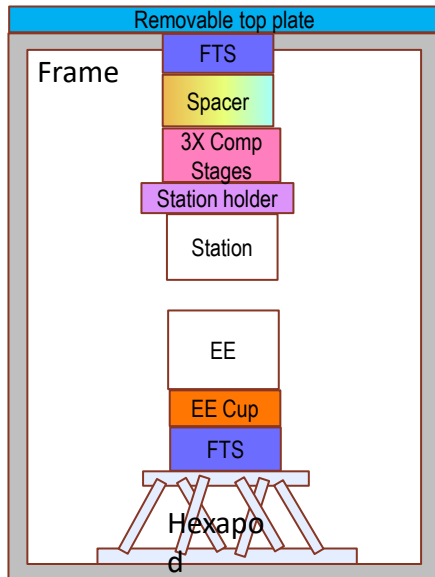
CCRS Overview for Testbeds context



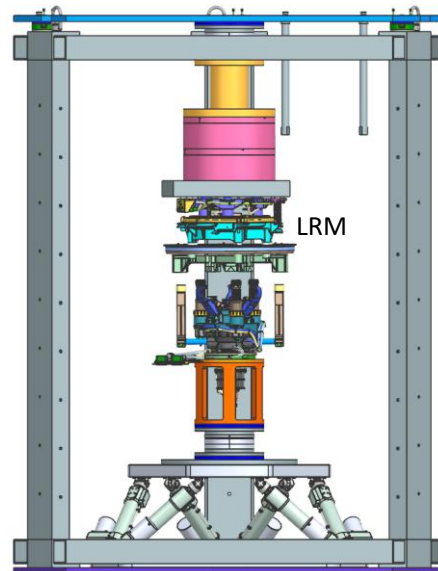
PIT Overview

PIT: Pickup and Installation Testbed

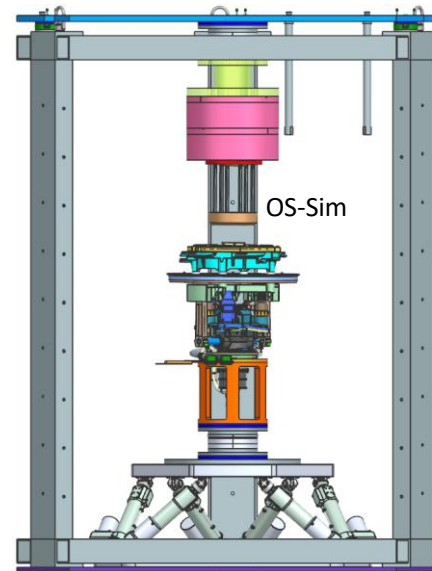
Goal: Test and measure station and tool interactions between CCRS end effector and various interfaces given a specific misalignment in **TVAC** environment



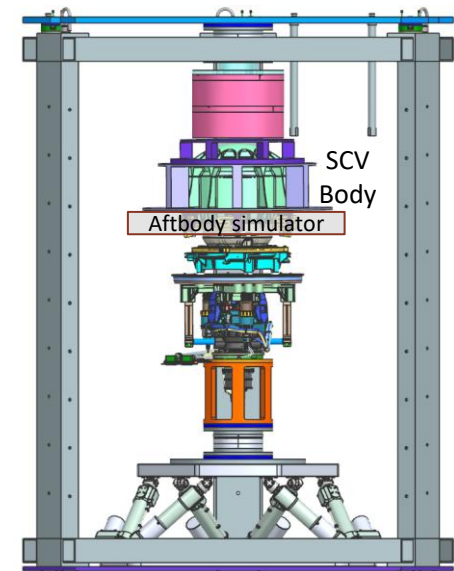
Generalized Configuration



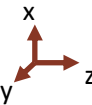
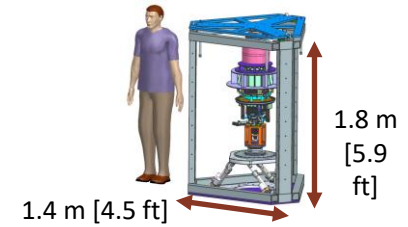
Lid Pickup



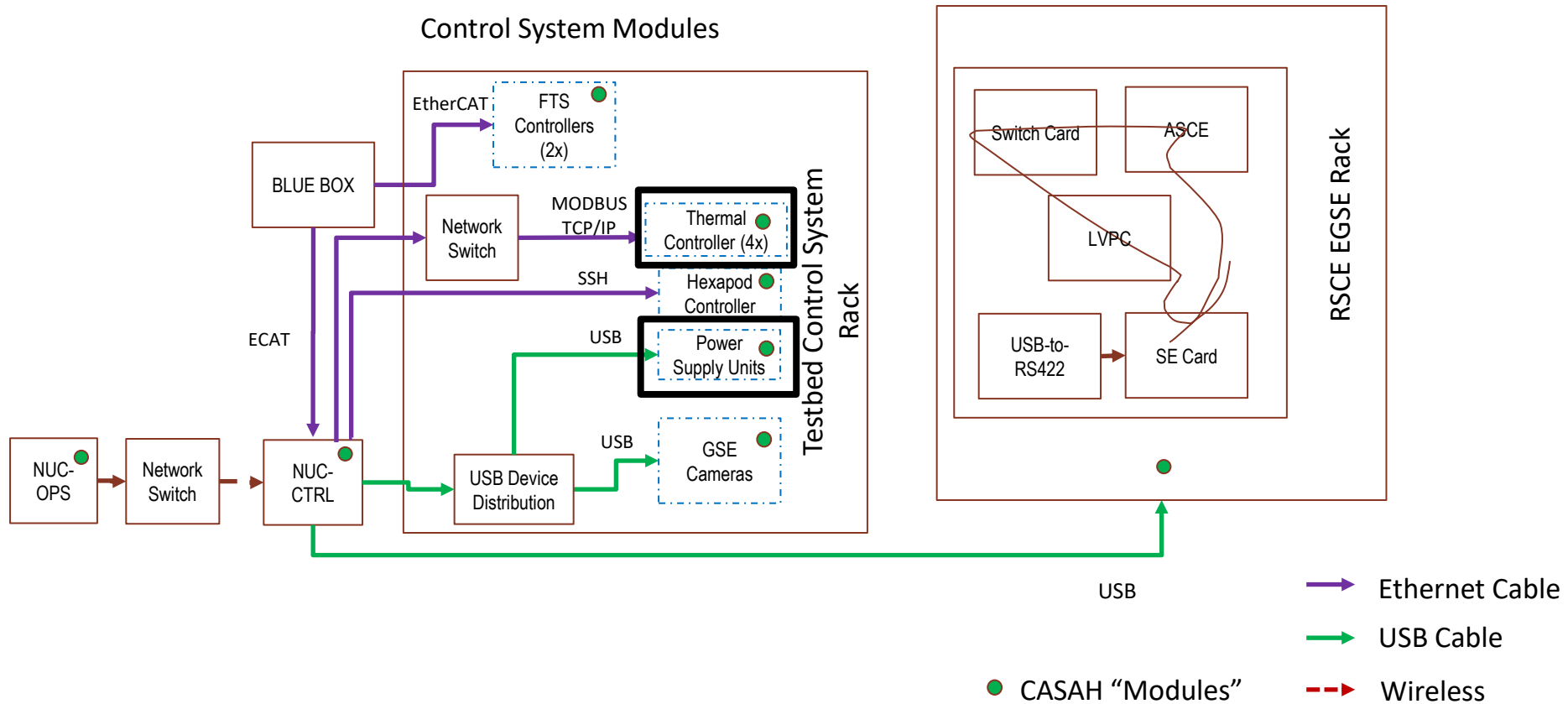
OS Pickup



LOS Install

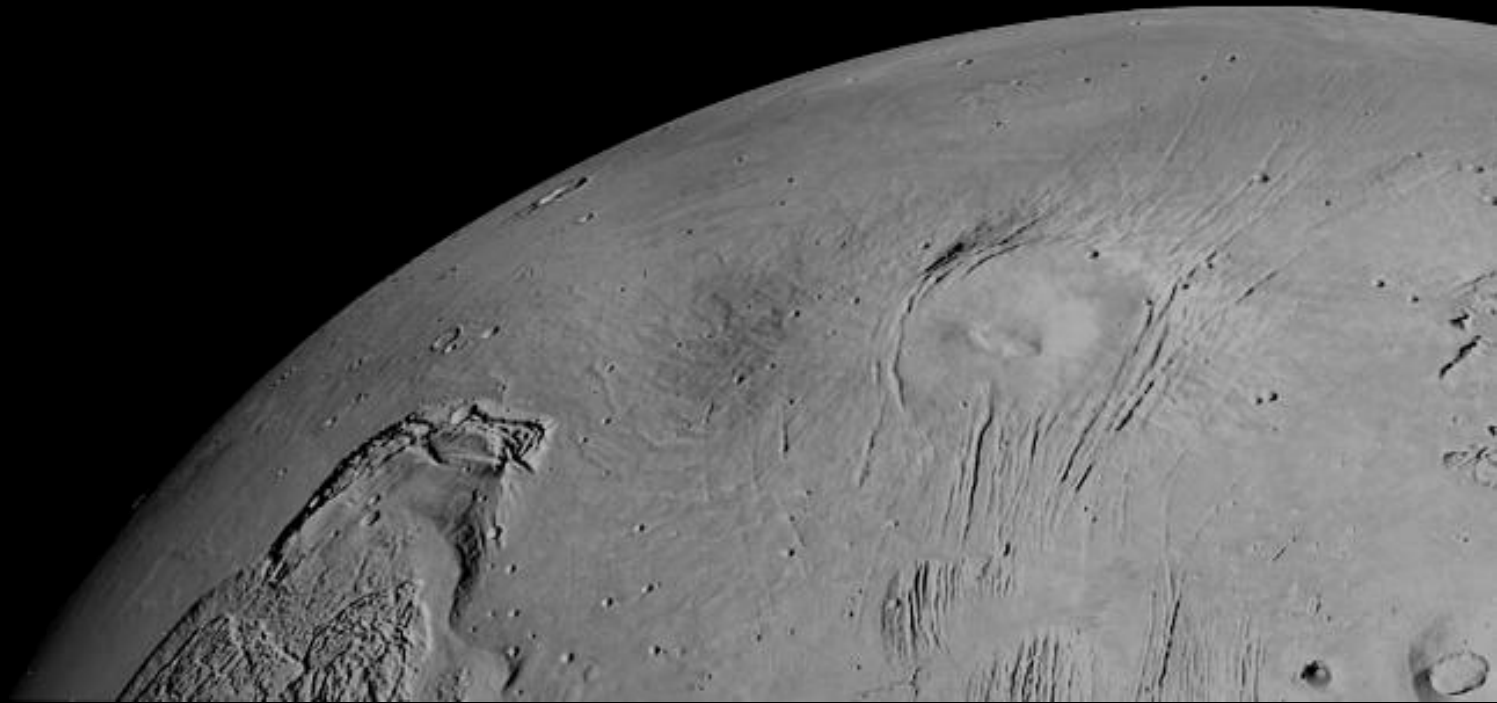


PIT Software Functional Block Diagram



PSU_MGR:

ROS2 Power Supply Package



Keysight Power Supply

- Objective: Create a CASAH Module that can manage multiple Keysight Power Supplies (PSU) with the core functionality of
 1. Initialize PSUs
 2. Query and Publish Telemetry
 3. Allow operators / other modules to
 1. Clear errors
 2. Change channel outputs (ON/OFF)
- Intended use was to turn ON/OFF motors for RSCE Rack Sequencing
- Previous scope included error management -> later moved to FP_MGR

Nomenclature

- Module** (CASAH Module): represented by **psu_mgr**, manages multiple instances of a Power Supply Class
- Mainframe**: Refers to an instance of the Power Supply Class and represents a single mainframe which houses multiple channels
- Channel**: One of the four smaller power supplies present in a mainframe which have their own voltage, current, power requirements
 - Assumes each frame has four channels – some frames have two channels combined - have not tested this behavior*

Keysight Series N6700

Mainframe (1x)



Channels (4x)



PSU Output Channels

Main Functionality of UPS

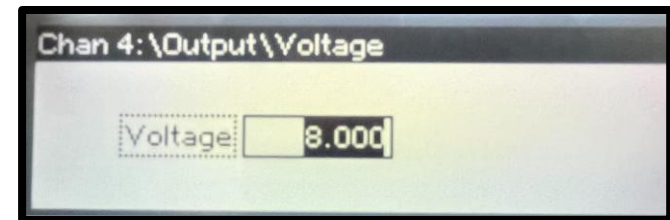
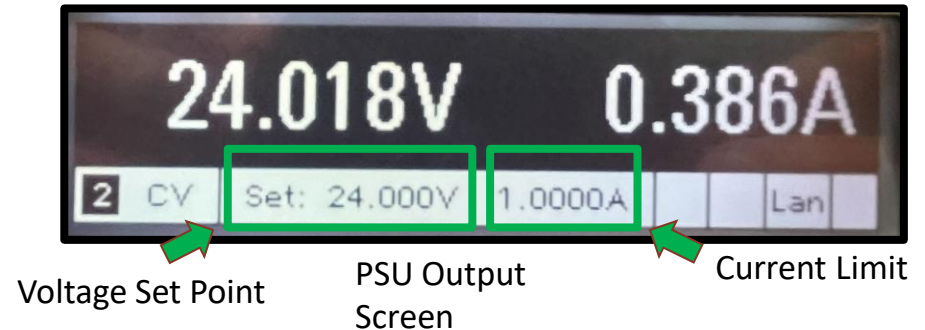
Hardware Pre-existing Functionality:

- Over Protection settings to Protect Hardware
 - Channel will stop outputting during Overvoltage (OV) or Overcurrent (OC) event

Needed Software Functionality:

- Turn on/off Power Supply Channels
- Read/Set Voltage Set Points, Current Limit
- Read/Set Overvoltage Set Points
- Read/Set Overcurrent Set Points
- Read Overvoltage Errors
- Read Overcurrent Errors
- Read Voltage Output
- Read Current Output

PSU can be separately programmed via. screen



PSU Voltage Settings



PSU Overvoltage
Protection Settings

Keysight Power Supply Wrapper

KeysightPowerSupply.py

Instance Data:

- ID
- usb_addr
- output_states []
- currents []
- current_limits []
- voltages []
- voltage_setpoints []
- error []
- error_enum[]
- overvoltage_setpoints []
- overcurrent_enables []
- fault

Functions:

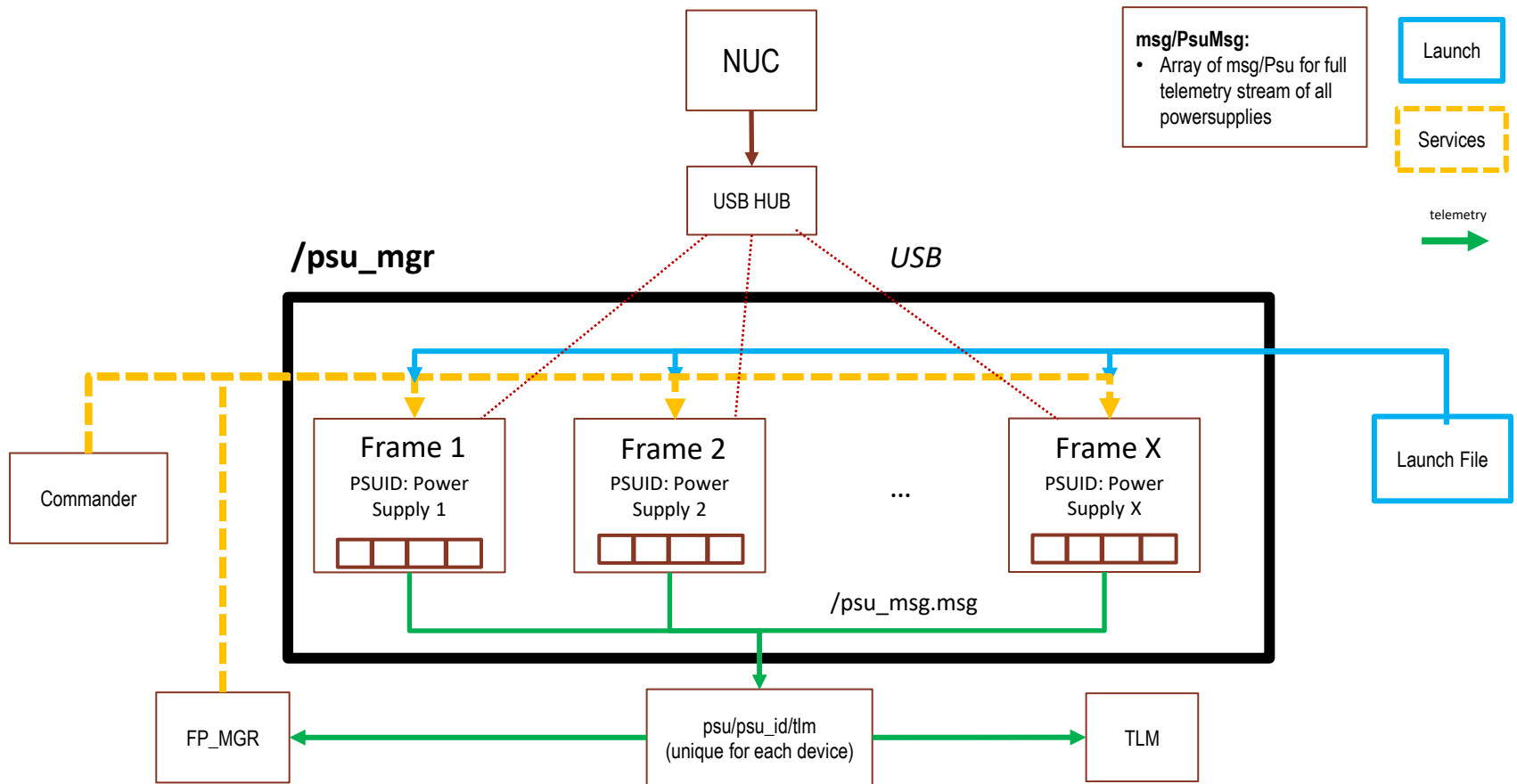
- Set/Read Output States
- Set/Read Current Limit Set Points
- Set/Read Voltage Set Points
- Set/Read Overvoltage Set Points
- Set/Read Overcurrent Enable State
- Read Error
- Read Error Enum
- Read Current Measurement
- Read Voltage Measurement
- Read Fault

- Fault defined as any error on any channel for a single frame

Communication & API:

- Uses Virtual instrument Software Architecture (VISA) API
 - Can communicate using TCP / USB
 - VISA Layer gives specific “VISA” address to hardware
 - NI-VISA Library
- Commands are sent through Standard Commands for Programmable Instruments (SCPI)
 - EX: OUTP ON, (@2)
 - Set channel 2 OUTPUT to ON
- Used **PyVISA** library -> module written in Python
 - Library supports multithreading
- Index of the array corresponds to channel of mainframe

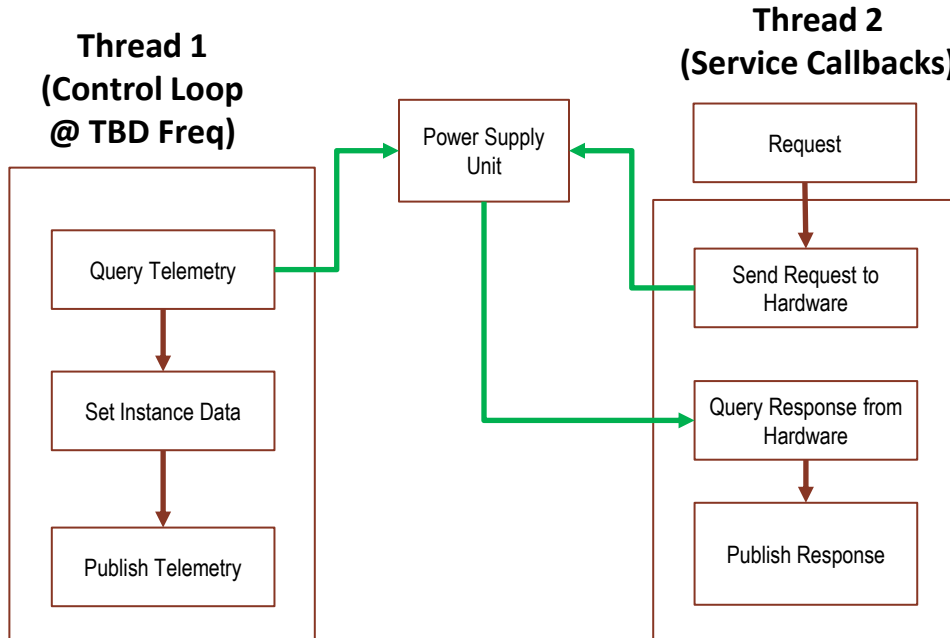
PSU_MGR Setup



Architecture #1: Asynchronous Control, Multithread

Assumed Requirements:

1. Query / Publish telemetry at specific frequency every time
2. Timing of service call timing is not strict; can be performed whenever possible



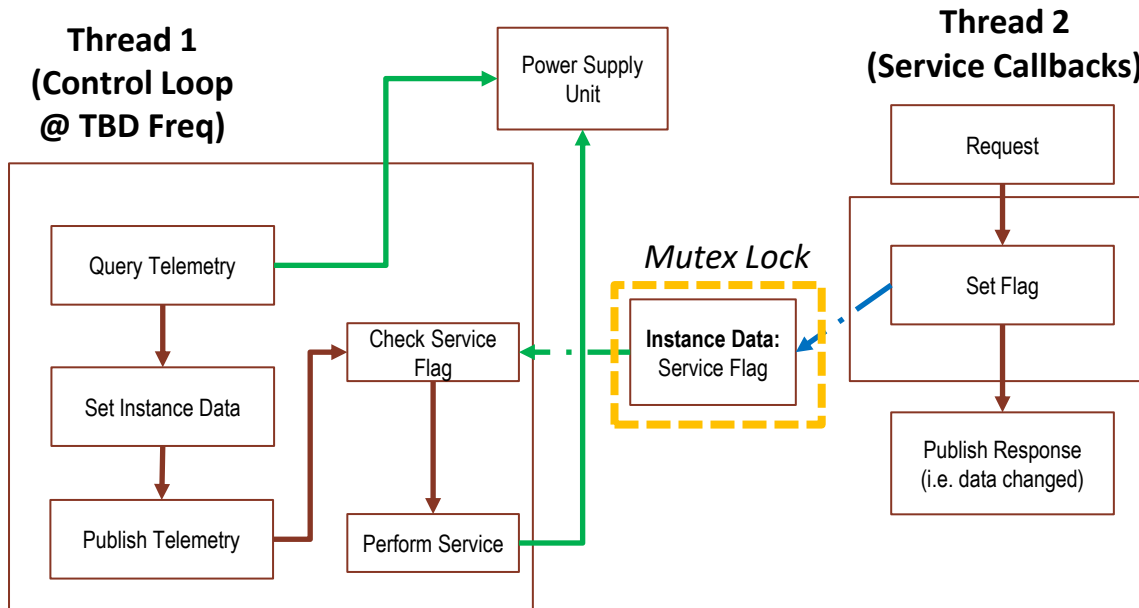
Notes:

- Asynchronous control scheme
- Requires multiple communication interfaces with different threads
 - i.e. multiple TCP Clients to the same server (hardware)
- **Keysight Power Supply** does not support multiple interfaces
 - Tested multiple clients and multithreading
 - Did not work (I/O errors)
- Vendor claims that the PSU cannot query multiple requests at the same time

Architecture #2: Synchronous Control, Single Loop

Assumed Requirements:

1. Query / Publish telemetry at specific frequency every time
2. Timing of service call timing is not strict; can be performed whenever possible



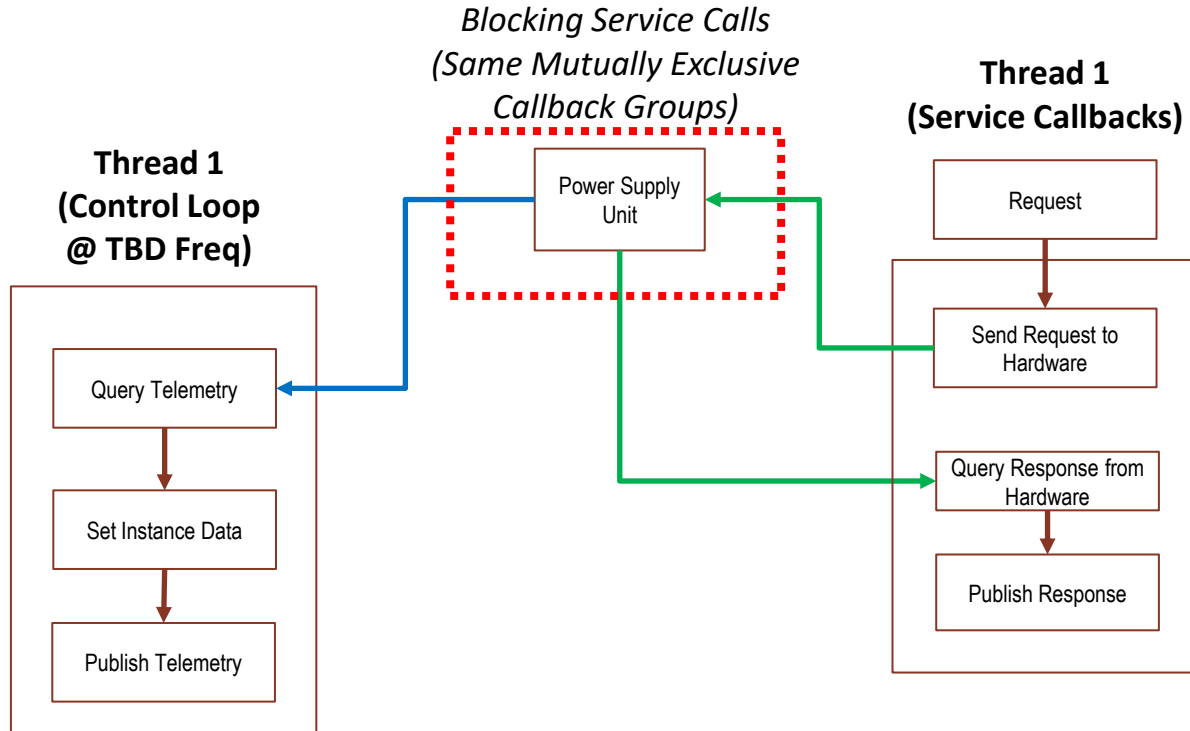
Notes:

- Synchronous Control Loop
- Only one thread can access hardware at a time
 - risks “overrun” in a single cycle if performing service takes a long time compared to required control loop frequency

Architecture #3: Asynchronous Control, Single Thread

Assumed Requirements:

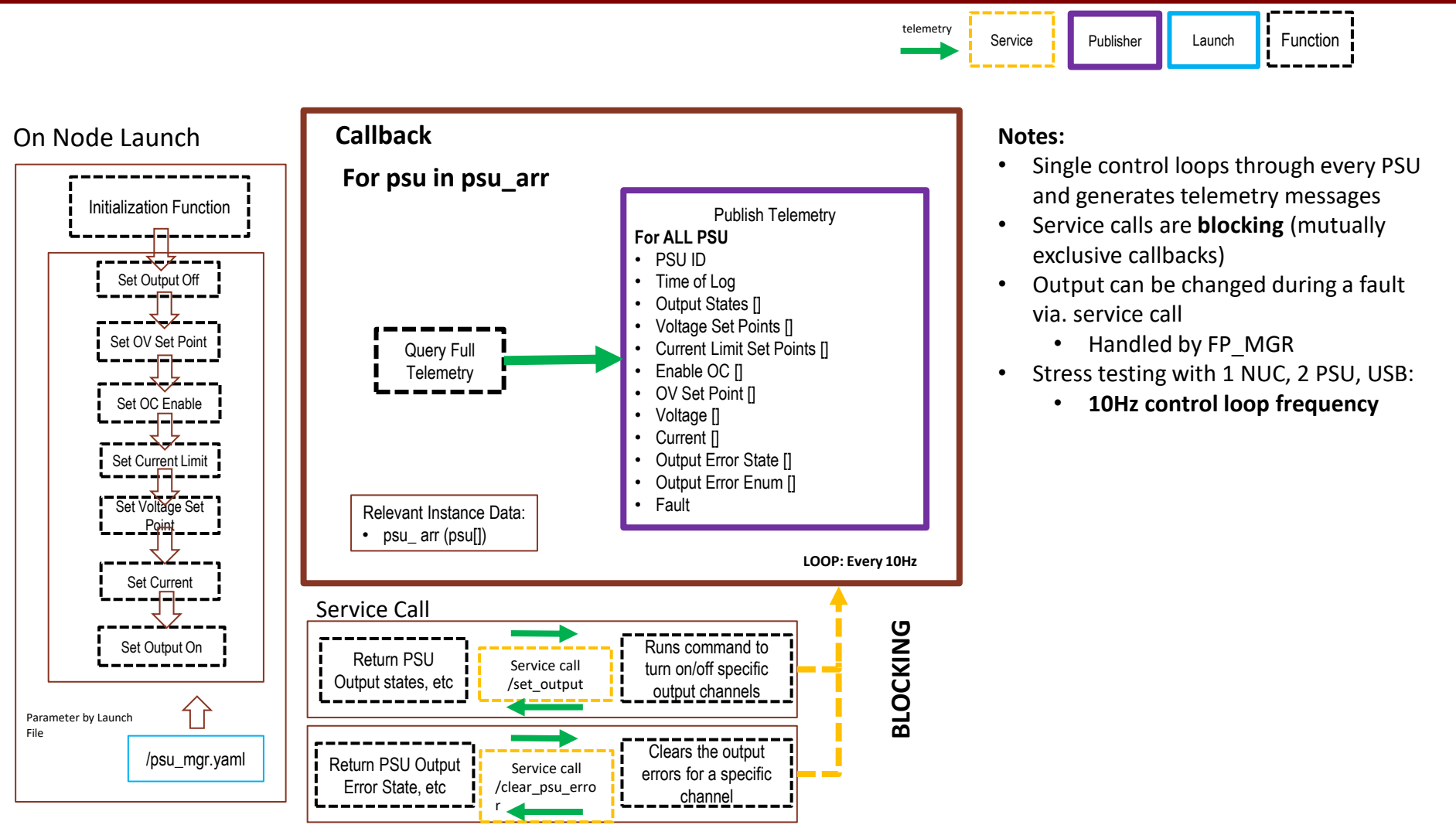
1. Query / Publish telemetry at specific frequency is not critical if **delayed**
2. Service calls should be performed when available (even if blocking)



Notes:

- Asynchronous Control Scheme
 - Only one callback runs and interfaces with hardware at a time
- Assumes that telemetry output can be delayed if service call takes too long
 - Need requirements on control loop frequency
- **Chosen architecture since hardware does not support multithreading**

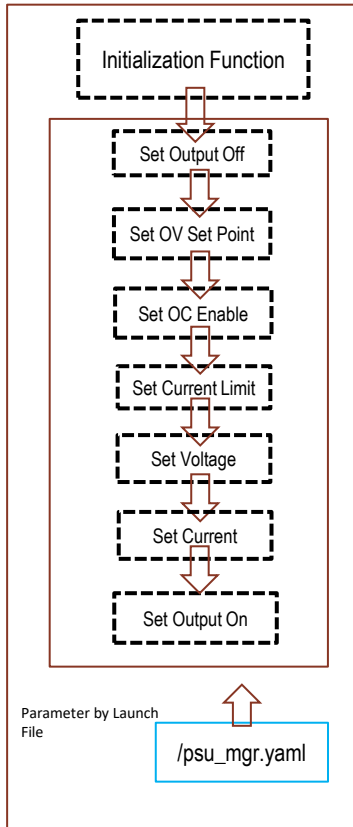
State Machine for Single Power Supply Node



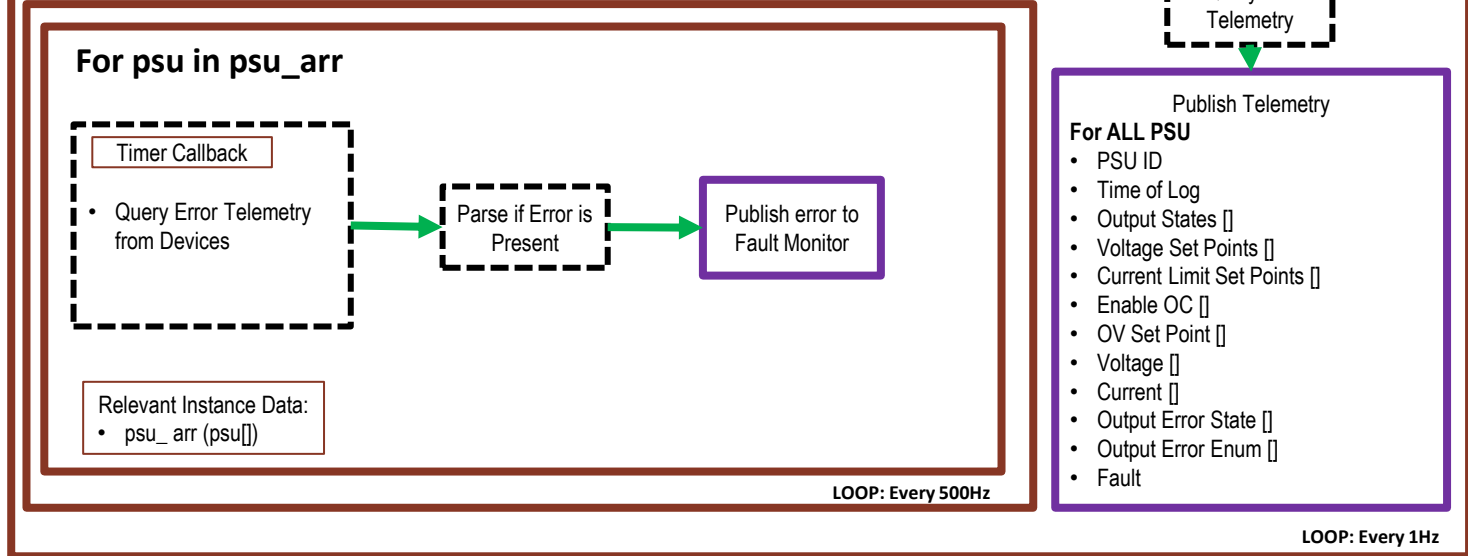
Alternative Architecture



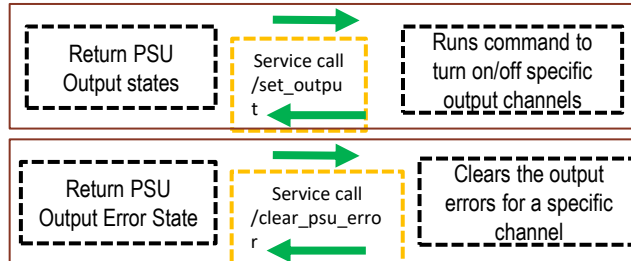
On Node Launch



Callback



Service Call

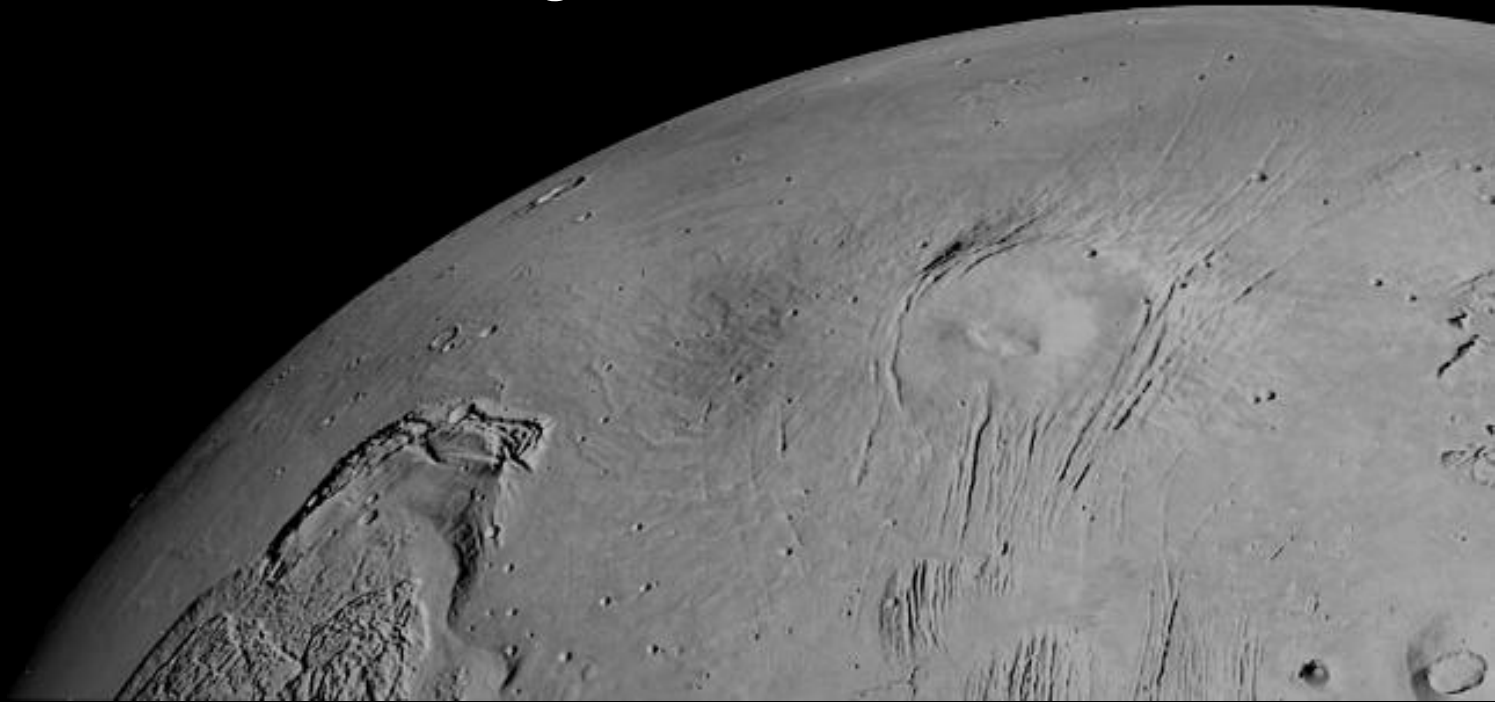


BLOCKING

Notes:

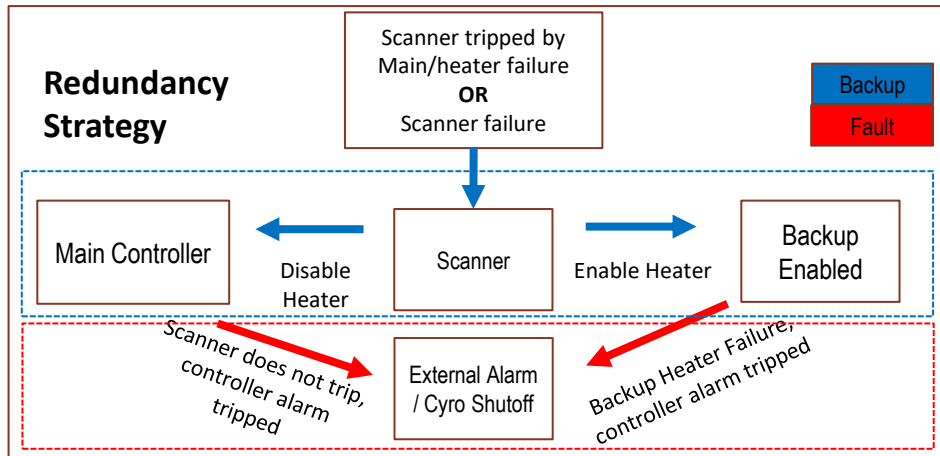
- Two control loops
 - Faster 500Hz rate for error checking
 - Slower 1Hz for telemetry output
- Publishes directly to fault monitor

THM_MGR:
ROS2 Thermal Controller Package



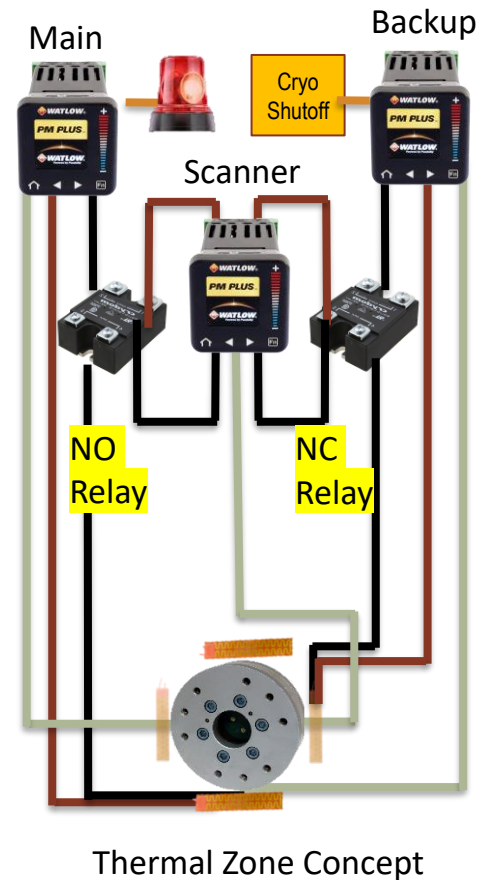
Thermal Manager Objective

- Objective: Create a CASAH Module that can manage multiple Thermal Controllers the core functionality of:
 1. Initializing Controllers
 2. Query and Publish Telemetry
 3. Allow operators / other modules to
 1. Clear errors
 2. Change Alarm Set Points
 3. Change Heating Control Set Point
- Controllers originally to be used for TVAC Testing [-50C to 70C]
 - Heaters and Thermocouples for closed loop control to set point
 - “Thermal Zones” for Single Redundancy
 - Watlow PM PLUS PID & Integrated Limit Controller, Omega Heaters, Crydom DC Relays



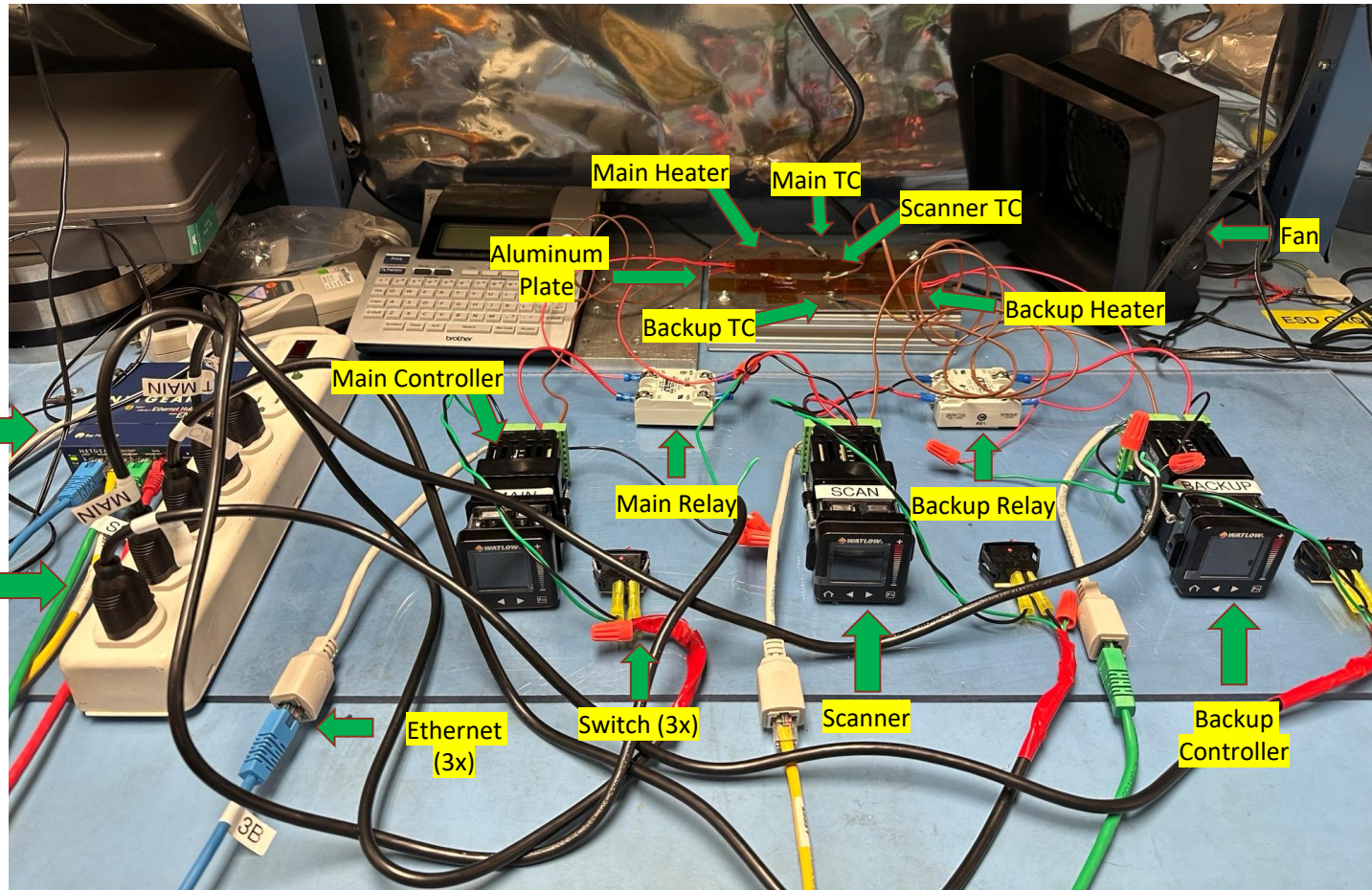
Single Failure -
Redundancy

Double Failure -
Hardware at Risk



FlatSat Physical Setup

* 120VAC or 24V DC



Thermal Controller Required Functions (Manual & Commanded)

Main Controller

1. Set Control Set Point to **T_Set_Point**
2. Set Alarm 1 Set Points to **T_Alarm_Low**, **T_Alarm_High**
3. Heat until **T_Set_Point** [Output 1]

Scanner

1. Set Alarm 1,2 Set Points to **T_Scanner_Low**, **T_Scanner_High**
2. Disable main heaters if **T_Scanner_Trip** is reached [Output 2]
3. Engage Relay for Backup Heaters if **T_Scanner_Trip** is reached [Output 1]

Backup Controller

1. Set Control Set Point to **T_Set_Point**
2. Set Alarm 1 Set Points to **T_Alarm_Low**, **T_Alarm_High**
3. Heat until **T_Set_Point** [Output 1]

Hardware Details

- All heating / alarm control is done by controllers onboard processing
- Controller sends PWM signals to heaters to reach temperature based on TC readings
 - Closed Loop (PID)
- Each controller has **2x** outputs, alarms
- If alarm is triggered, relays enable / disable outputs with latching
- Alarm set points must be set during operation
 - Otherwise, alarm will trip when trying to reach control loop set point

$T_{\text{alarm_high}}$ ————— 28°C (TBD)

$T_{\text{scanner_high}}$ ————— 25°C (TBD)

$T_{\text{set point}}$ ————— 15°C

$T_{\text{scanner_low}}$ ————— 5°C

$T_{\text{alarm_low}}$ ————— 3°C

$T_{\text{operational}}$ ————— 0°C

Main Functionality of THM_MGR

Hardware Pre-existing Functionality:

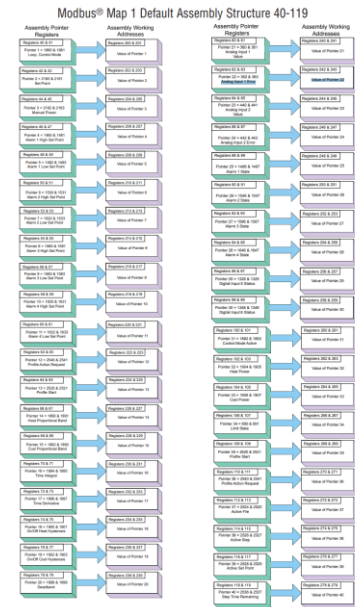
- PID Heating
- Alarm Output Behavior

Needed Software Functionality:

- Set Control Set Point
- Set Alarm (High / Low)
- Read Temperature
- Read TC Error
- Read Alarm 1,2 State
- Read Heat Power
- Read Alarm 1,2 Set Points (high / low)
- Read Control Set Points

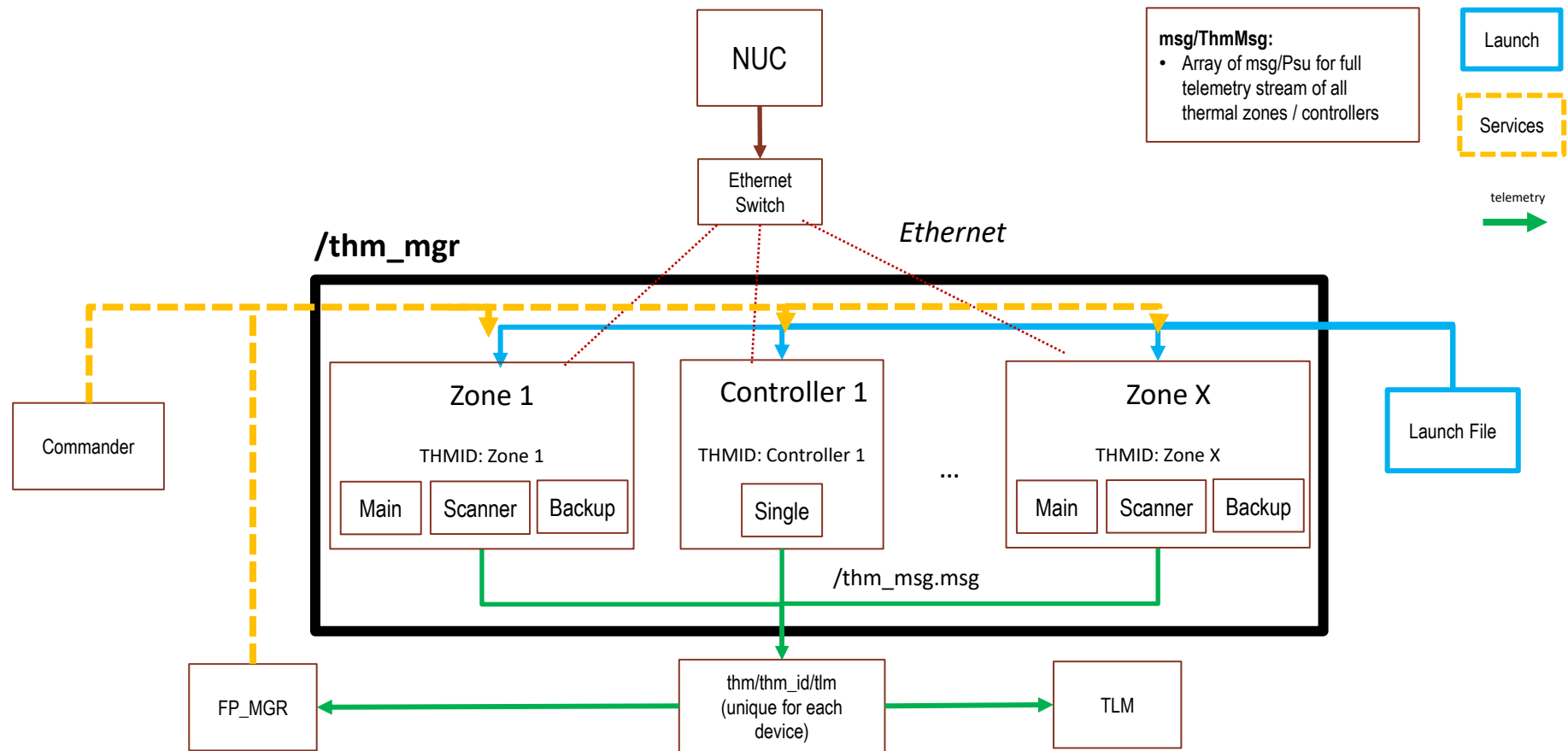
Thermal Controller can be separately programmed via. screen

- Watlow Controllers use MODBUS TCP
 - Write/Read from specific registers (32bit)
 - Using PyModbus library – **does not support multithreading**



MODBUS Register List

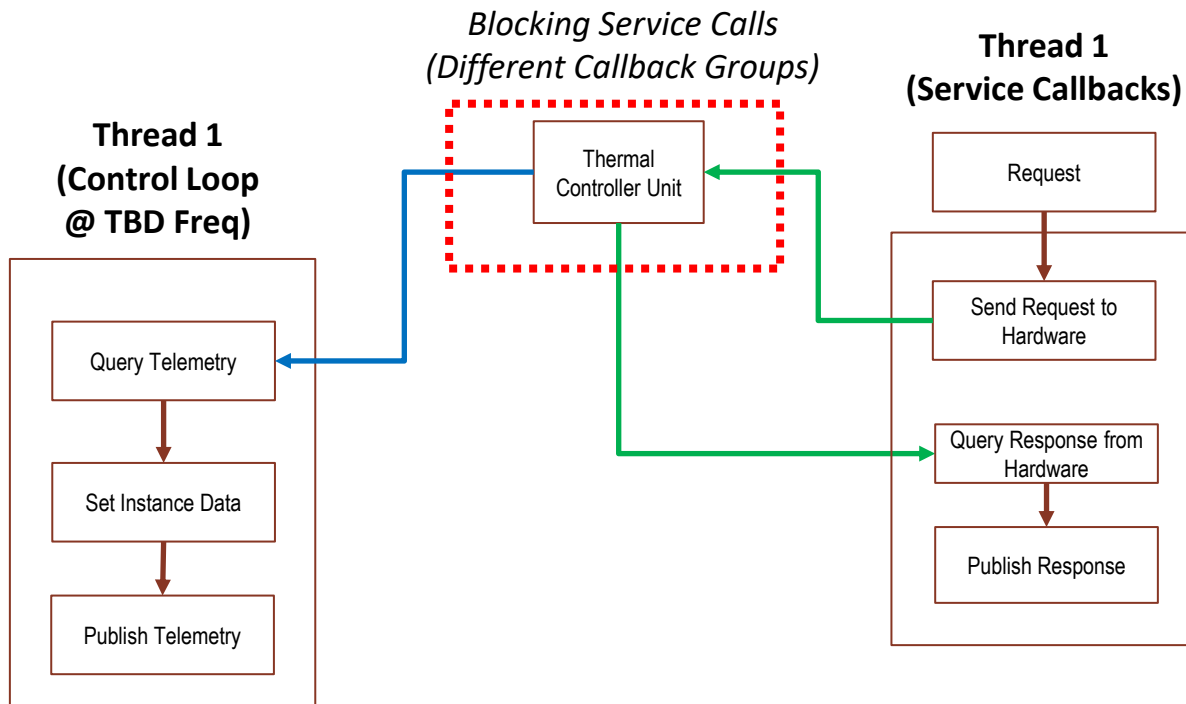
THM_MGR Setup



Architecture #3: Asynchronous Control, Single Thread

Assumed Requirements:

1. Query / Publish telemetry at specific frequency is not critical
2. Service calls should be performed when available (even if blocking)



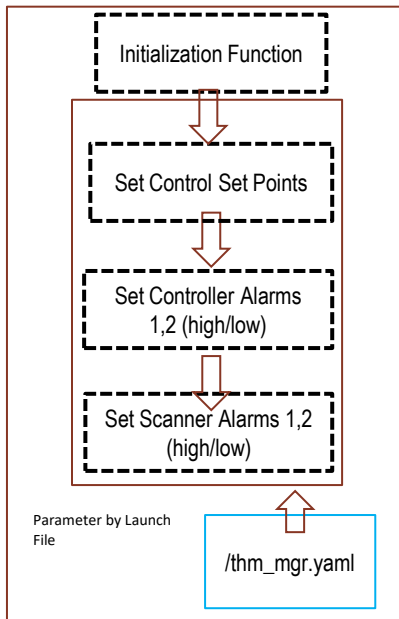
Notes:

- Asynchronous Control Scheme
 - Only one callback interfaces with hardware at a time
- Assumes that telemetry output can be delayed if service call takes too long
 - Need requirements on control loop frequency
- **Chosen architecture since PyModbus does not support multithreading**

State Machine for Thermal Manager



On Node Launch



Relevant Instance Data:
• thm_arr[]

Callback

For thm_controller in thm_arr

Timer Callback

- Query Telemetry from Devices

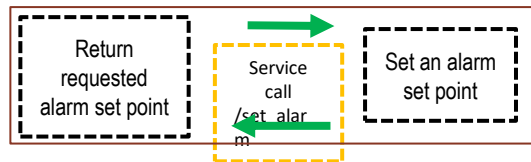
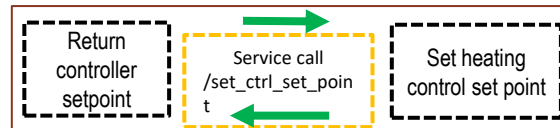
LOOP: Every 1Hz

Publish Telemetry

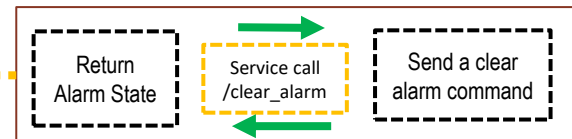
For each Thermal Controller

- Thermal Controller ID
- Architecture
- Time of Log
- Temperature Reading []
- TC Error []
- TC Error []
- Heat Power []
- Control Set Points []
- Alarm 1,2 States []
- Alarm 1,2 (high/low) Set Points []
- Module Faulted?

Service Call

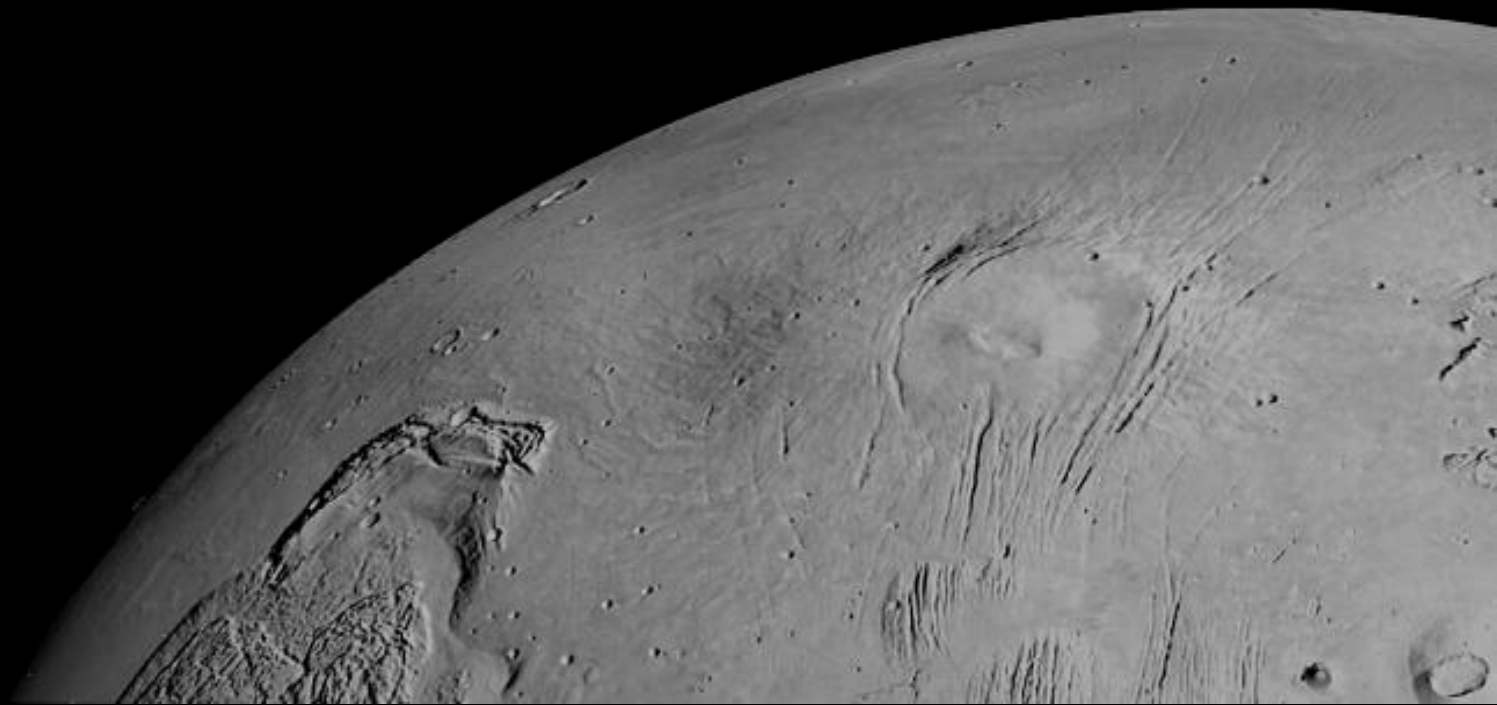


BLOCKING



- Seems to be a large latency during service and telemetry queues when using thermal zones (**up to 5 seconds**)
- Single controller works with 1Hz

V&V

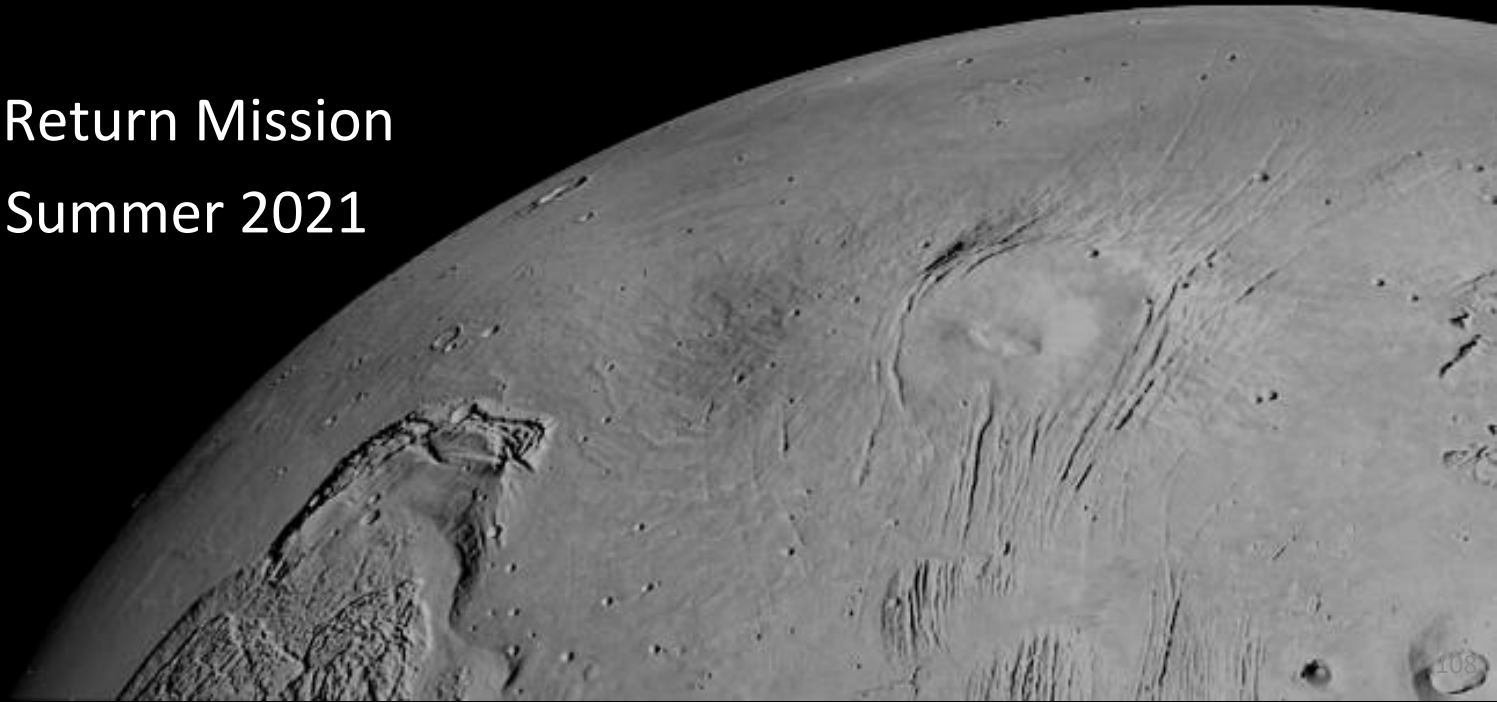


- Performed basic checkouts for Symétrie Hexapod
 - Range of Motion
 - Stopping with FTS
- Helped with test procedure / actually interfacing with CASAII operator tools, testbed deployment



End Effector Initial Developmental Testbed

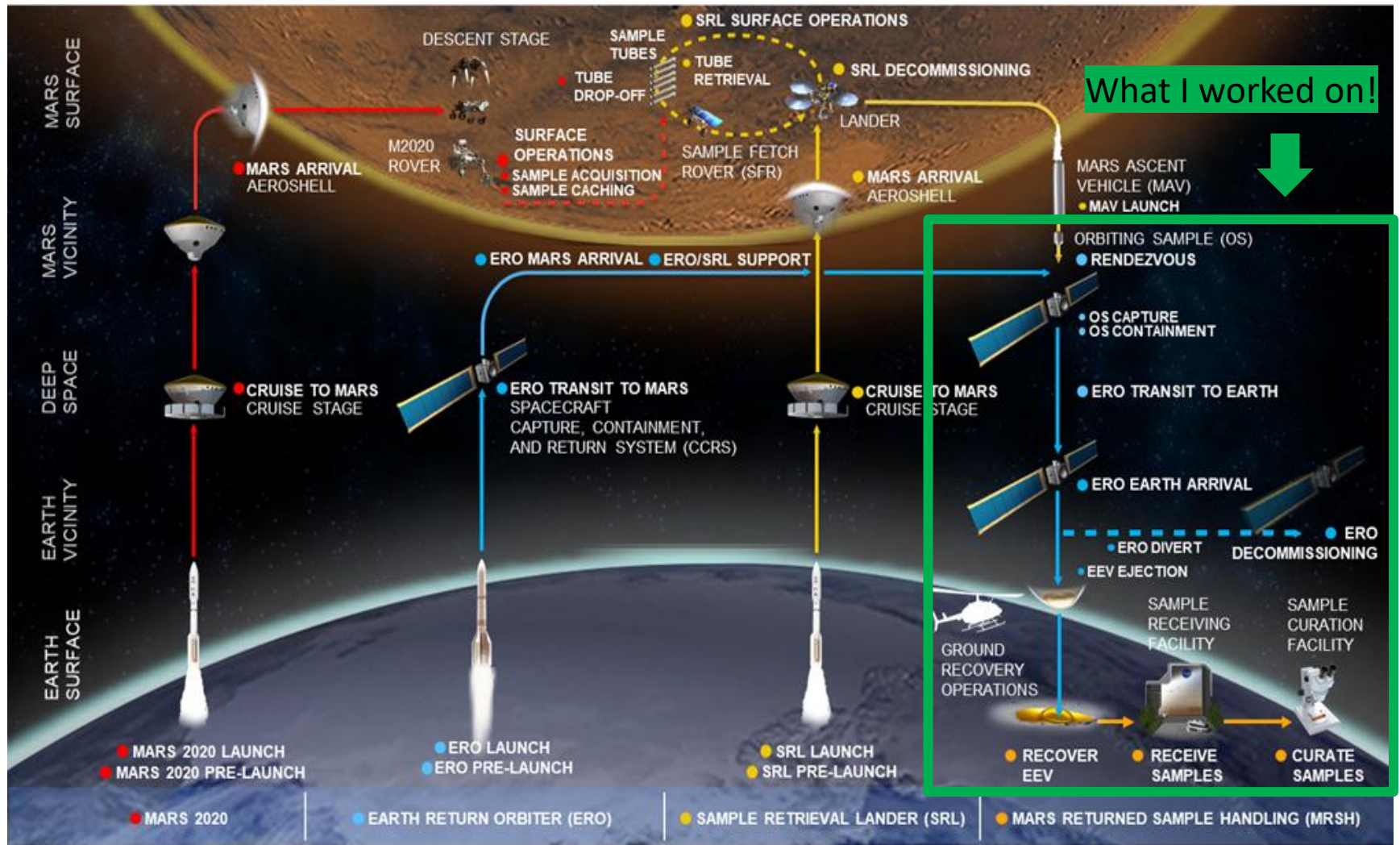
Mars Sample Return Mission
Spring 2020 - Summer 2021



Disclaimer

- The decision to implement Mars Sample Return will not be finalized until NASA's completion of the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) process
- This document is being made available for information purposes only
- The information presented has been approved through export control and has been released to be shown to the public

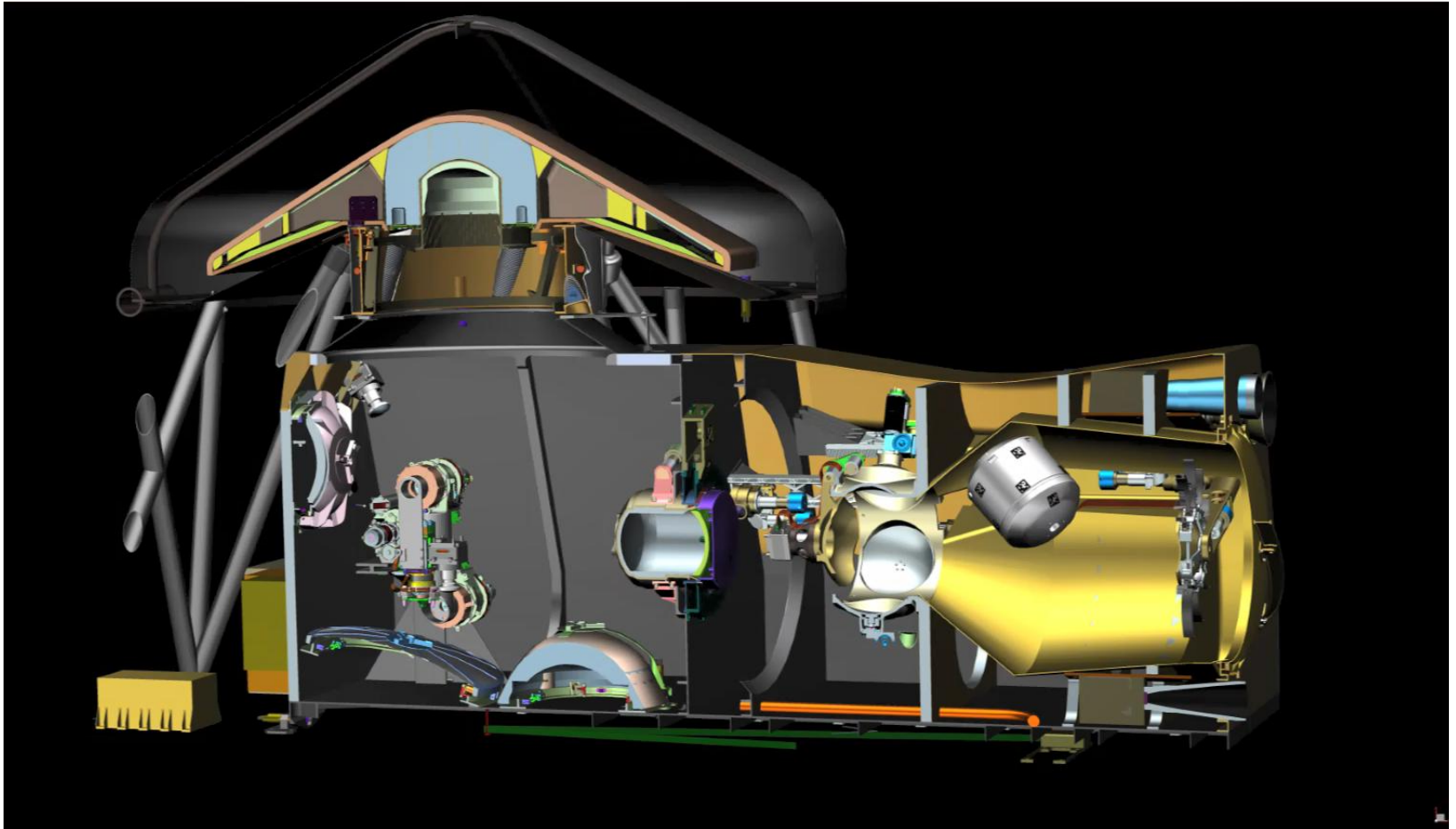
Mars Sample Return Planning Overview



Pre-Decisional Information – For Planning and Discussion Purposes Only

CCRS Containment Operations

The CCRS Capture and Containment Module uses an end effector on the Robotic Transfer Arm to perform a series of assembly tasks to contain the OS, assemble the OS into the EEV, and maintain the Earth clean zone



Artist's Concept

Assembly Operations

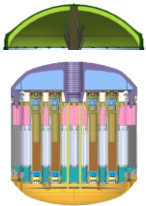
OS = Orbiting Sample

PCV = Primary Containment Vessel

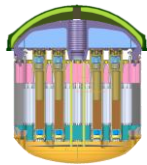
SCV = Secondary Containment Vessel

CAM = Containment Assurance Module

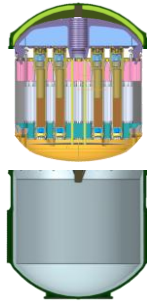
EEV = Earth Entry Vehicle



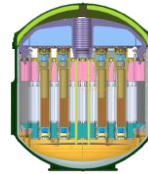
1. PCV Lid aligned with OS



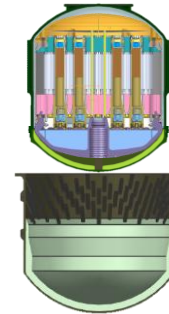
2. PCV Lid mated with OS



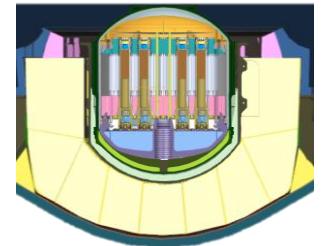
3. OS aligned with PCV Base



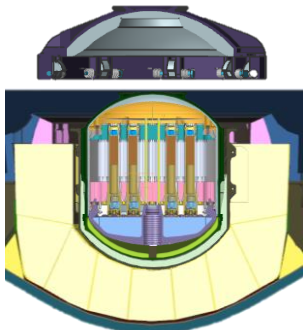
4. PCV Base and Lid mated and brazed



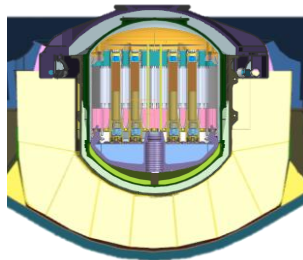
5. PCV aligned with the SCV Base



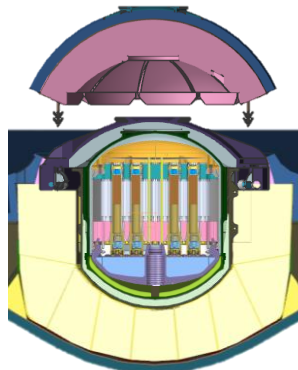
6. PCV inserted into SCV Base/EEV



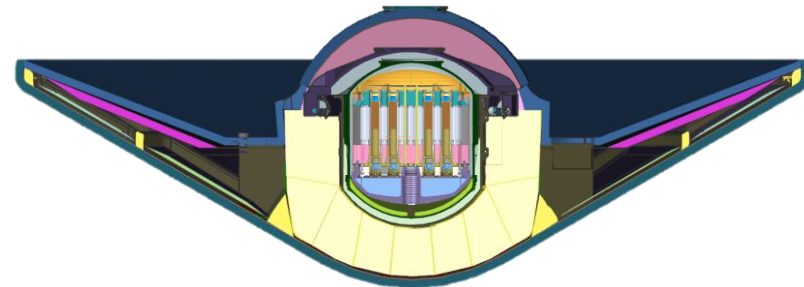
7. SCV Lid aligned with the SCV Base/EEV



8. SCV Lid mated with the SCV Base/EEV



9. CAM Lid aligned with the EEV



10. CAM Lid mated with the EEV

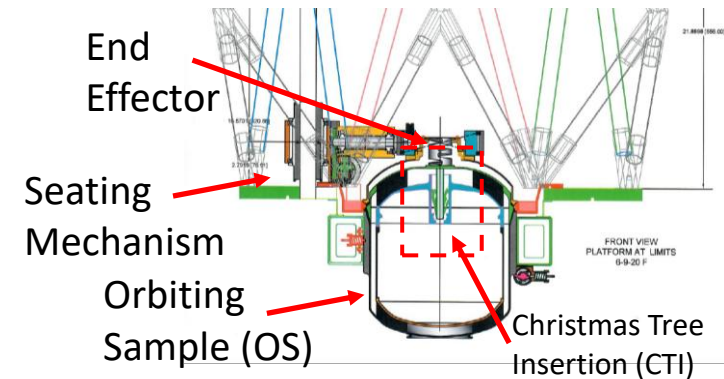
The Problem: End Effector Misalignment

End Effector Misalignment can be due to a variety of issues such as:

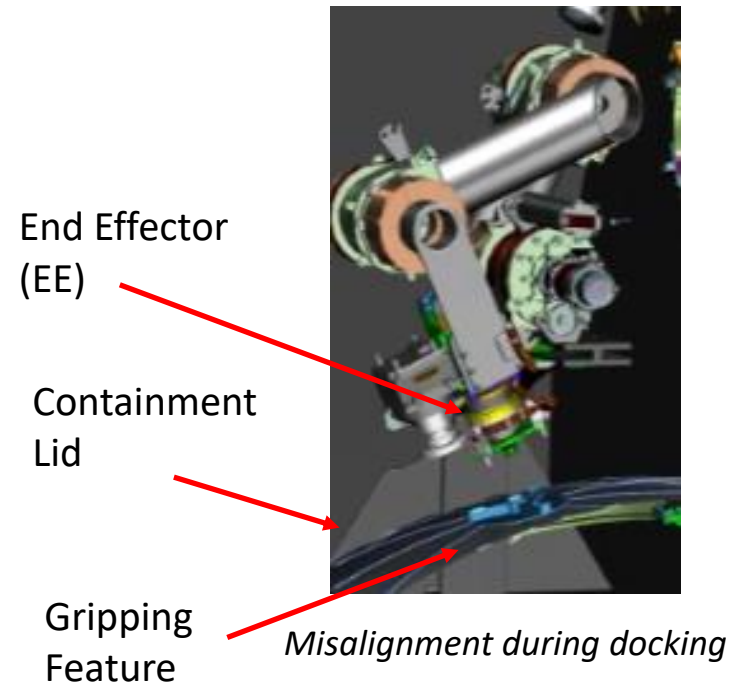
- **Joint errors** (encoder inaccuracy/sensitivity)
- **Kinematic Errors** (model is not 100% true to real geometry)
- **Non-kinematic errors** (backlash, stiffness, temperature effect)

Objectives:

1. Create a platform to test behavior of Robotic Transfer Arm (RTA) end effectors when misalignment is present
 - **Not testing static preloading of seals due to higher load requirements**
2. Test the capability of mechanical alignment strategies (e.g., Christmas Tree Insertion, end effector posts)
3. Measure the forces and torques present during docking/insertion procedures



PCV Lid Insertion into OS



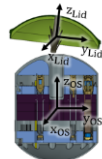
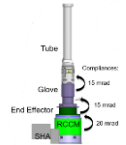
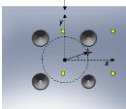
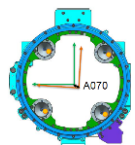
Testbed Requirements

Load Requirements

Function	Force Required (N)	75% Margined Load Required (N)*	Rationale
CTI Insertion	80	140	Load Estimates calculated and provided from previous work. Magnitudes of values quite similar to those presented in MSL Bit Box and M2020 SHA insertion tests.   MSL Bit Box M2020 SHA
Braze Insertion	80	117	
PCV Grip	200	350	
PCV Place	200	350	
SCV Lid Grip	200	350	
SCV Lid Place	200	350	
CAM Lid Grip	200	350	
CAM Lid Place	100	175	
ERM Lid Grip	200	350	
ERM Lid Place	200	350	

* 75% added margin accounts for uncertainty in force required

Displacement Requirements

Offset	Required	Rationale
Position (along x-axis)	+/- 10 mm	All of the requirements are based off the SHA EE Misalignments. Each of the following requirements have ~200% Margin. Additionally, the magnitude of the errors are similar to those present in the MSL Drill and Bit Box Tests      EE Misalignment OS Pin Insertion SHA EE RCCM (M2020) Drill and Bit Box (MSL) SCS Bit Exchange (M2020)
Position (along y-axis)	+/- 10 mm	
Angular (about x-axis)	+/- 2.86 deg	
Angular (about y-axis)	+/- 2.86 deg	
Clocking (about z-axis)	+/- 2.86 deg	

Testbed Requirements

Stroke Requirements

Function	Stroke Required (mm)	50% Margined Stroke Required (mm)*	Rationale
CTI Insertion	65.8	98.7	Stroke Estimates calculated and provided from current CAD models of CCRS Architecture.
Braze Insertion	184.6	276.9	
PCV Grip	11.3	17.0	
PCV Place	201.6	302.4	
SCV Lid Grip	10.4	15.6	
SCV Lid Place	88.6	132.9	
CAM Lid Grip	19.5	29.3	
CAM Lid Place	133.5	200.3	
ERM Lid Grip	10.4	15.6	
ERM Lid Place	17.6	26.4	

* 50% added margin accounts for uncertainty in stroke required

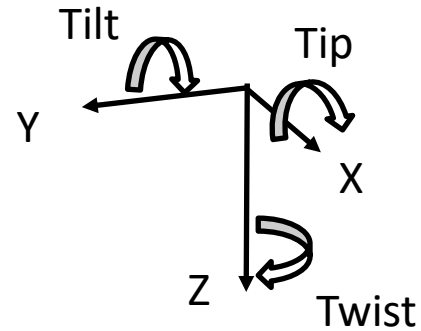
Testbed Requirements

Functional requirements the testbed:

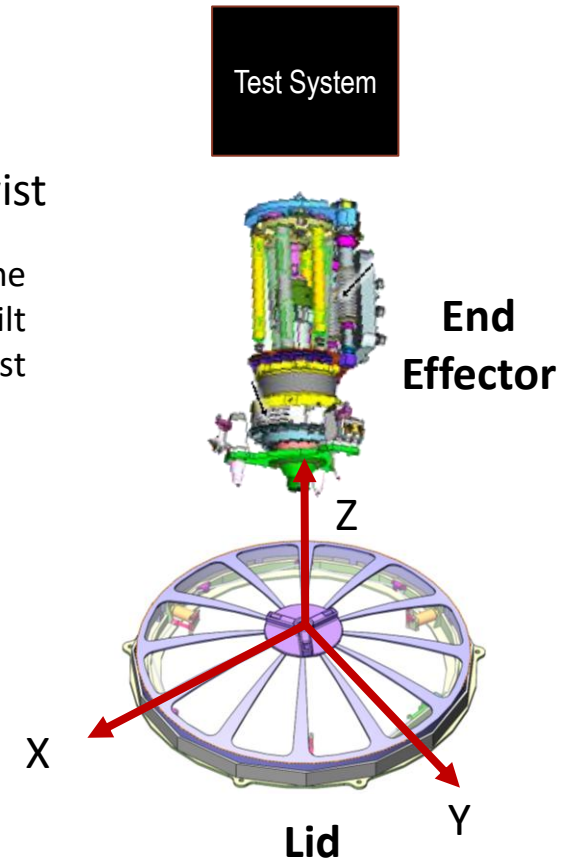
- Apply Force
- Provide Motion (6-DoF)
 - Provide Initial Alignment Error
 - Lateral
 - Angular
 - Clocking
- Measure Forces (6-DoF)

These requirements can be met using:

- Stewart Platform
- Linear Actuator
- 6-Axis Force Torque Sensor

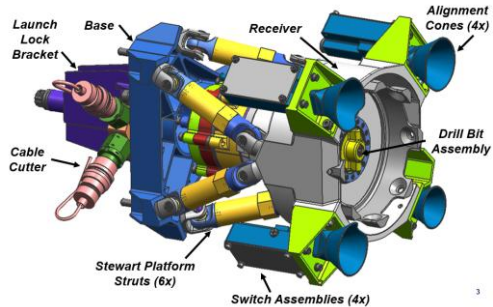


Lateral – XY plane
Angular – XY Tip/Tilt
Clocking – Z Twist



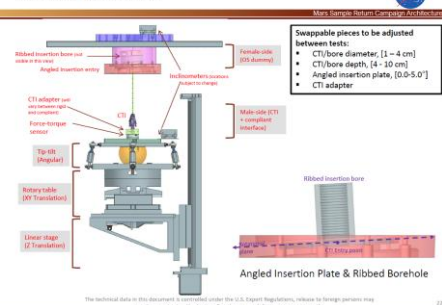
Previous Flight Project Testbeds

MSL Bit Exchange Development Test (2008)

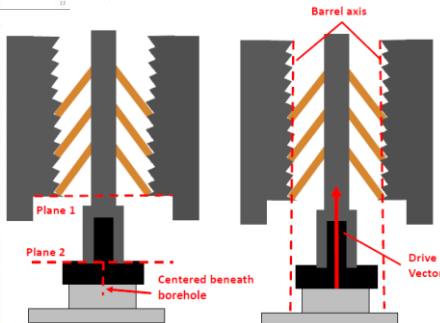
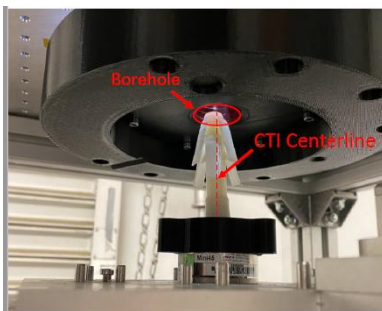
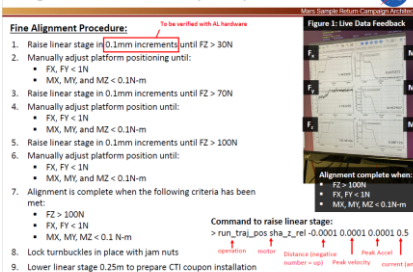


IFACT: Insertion Force & Alignment Characterization Testbed

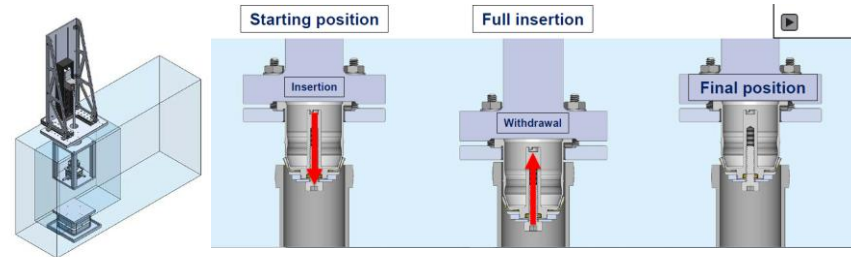
Testbed Overview



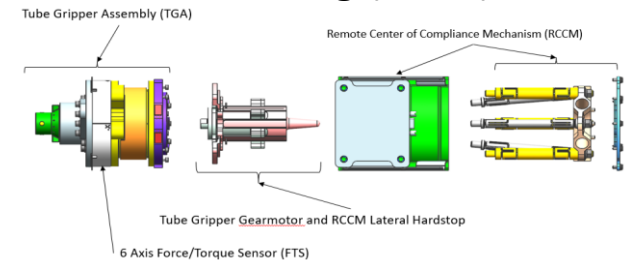
Alignment Procedures (Cont.)



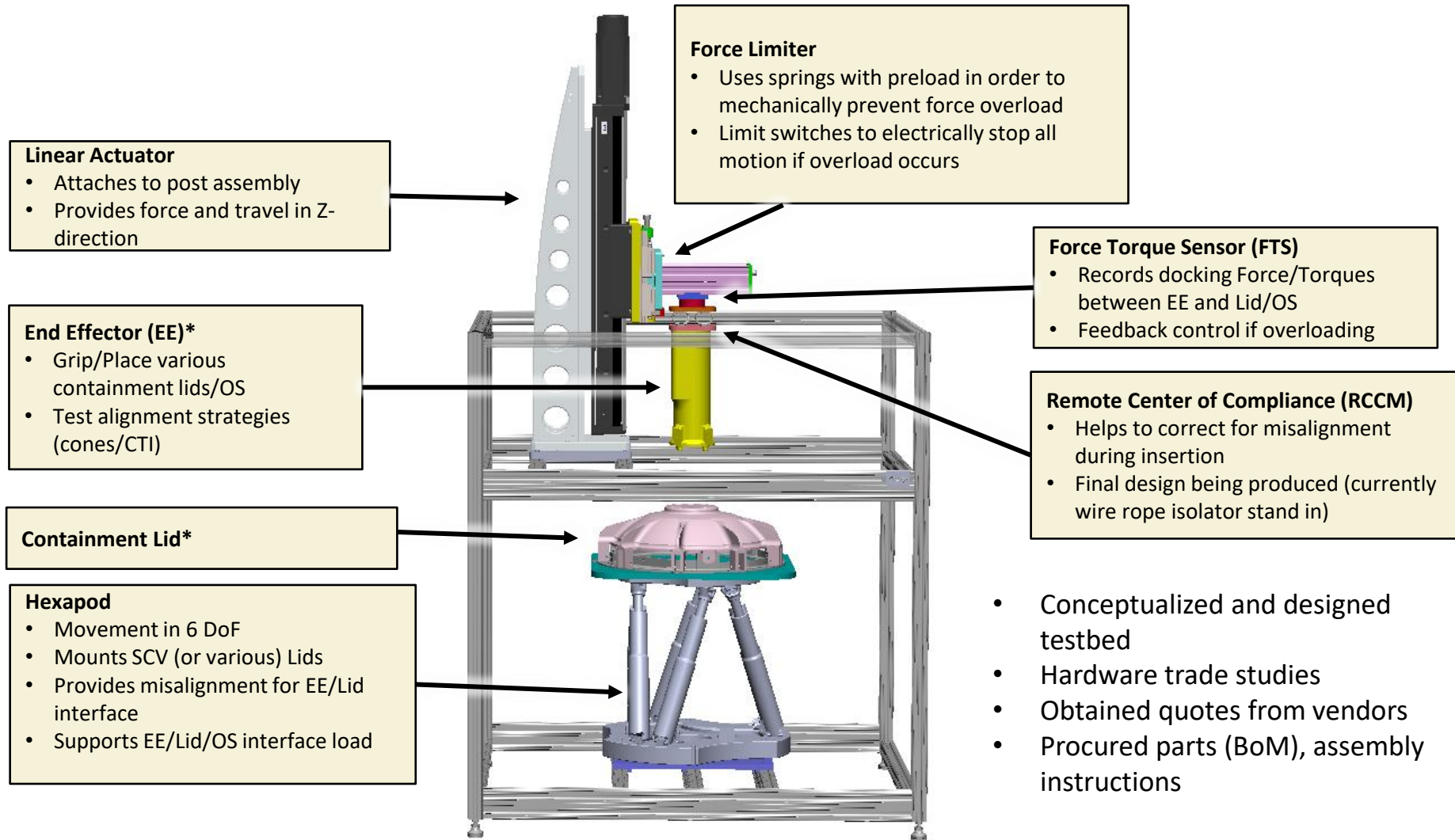
M2020 Tube Retainer Performance Characterization Testing (2020)



M2020 SHA Insertion/Misalignment Testing (2017)

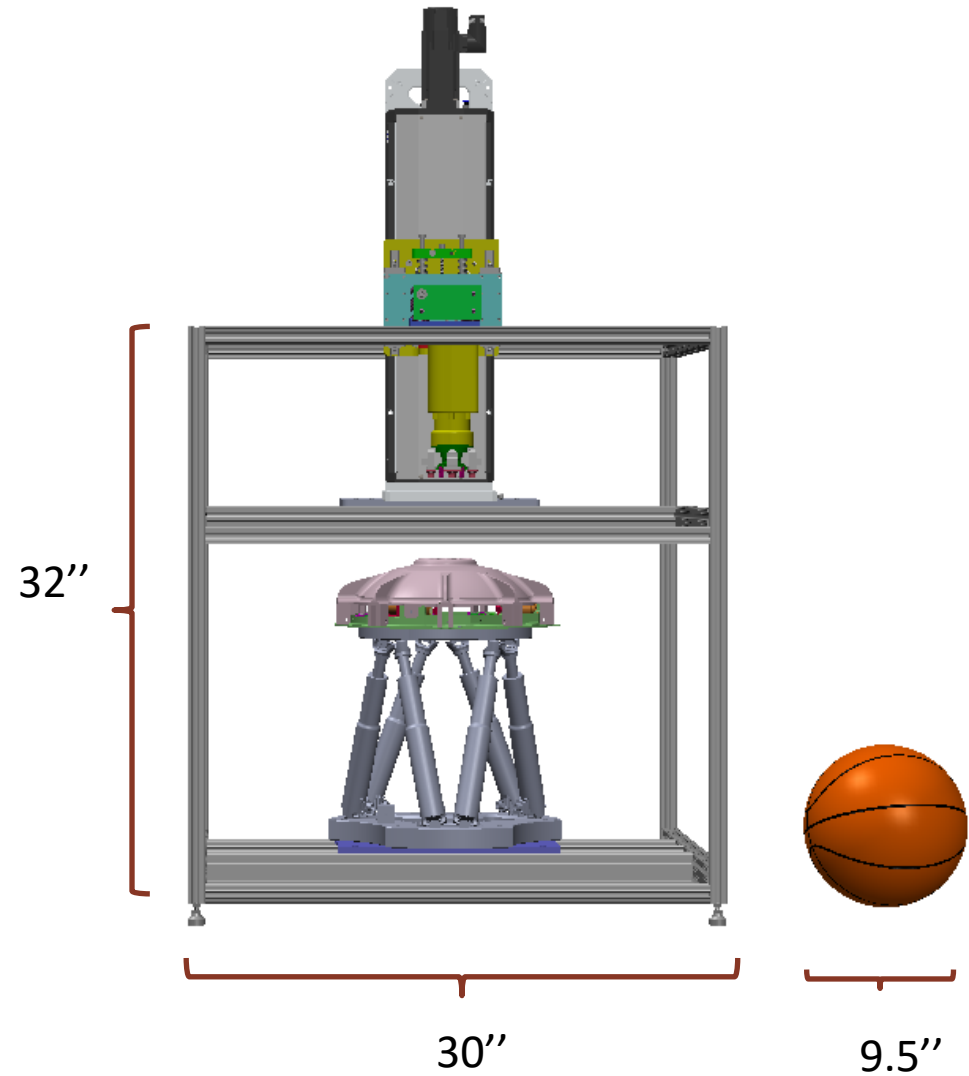
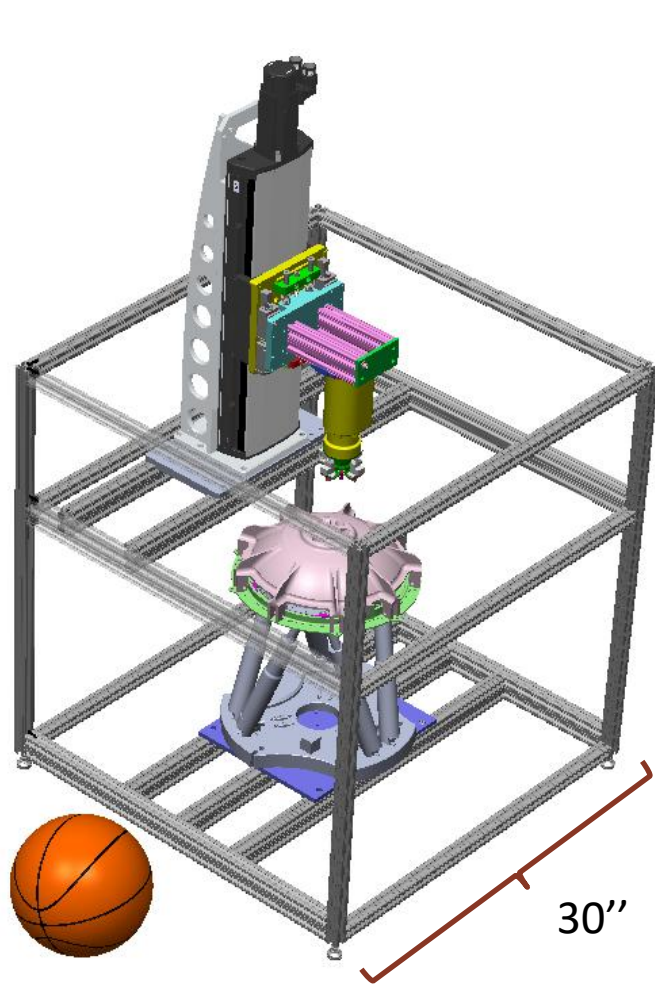


Testbed Configuration



*These pieces are still in development, not final models

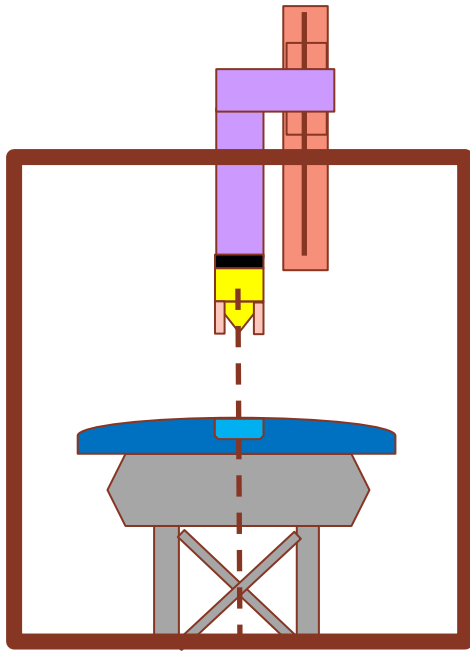
Test Bed Dimensions



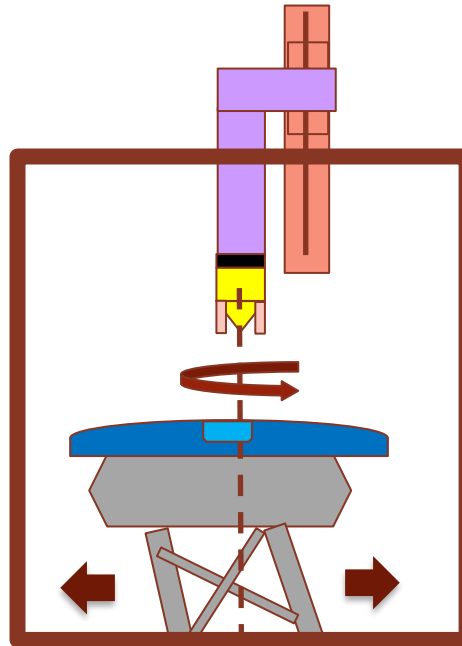
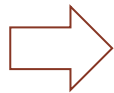
Additional Photos



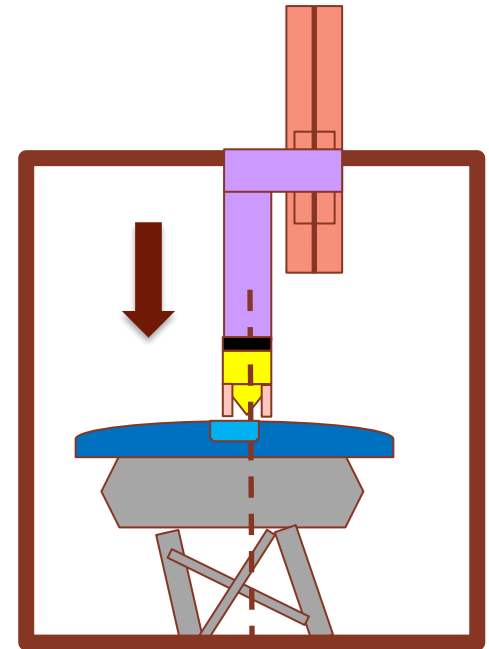
Testbed Operational Concept



1. Calibrate and align hexapod to end effector



2. Move the hexapod in 5 DoF (lateral, angular, clocking) to create misalignment



3. Move Linear Actuator down vertically, begin docking until

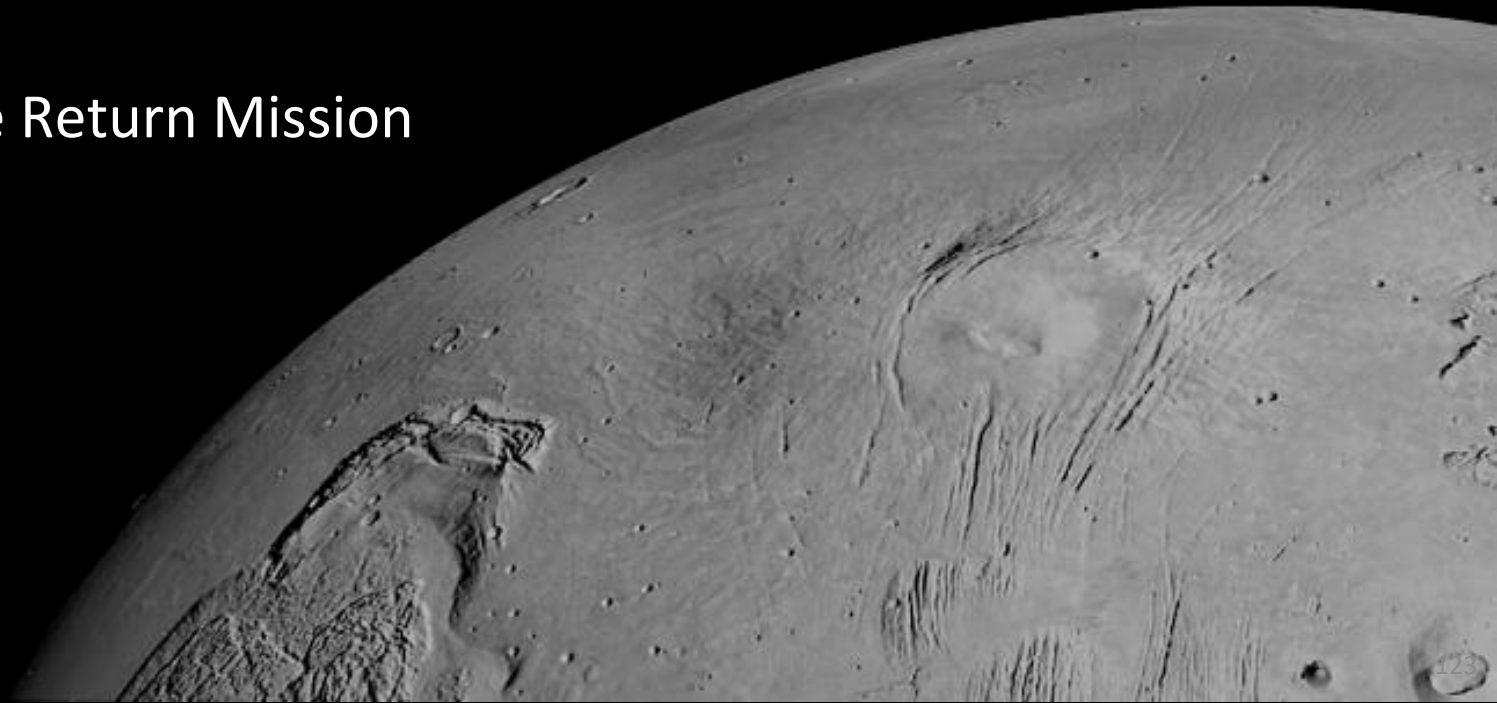
- Load reached (350N)
- Switches Triggered
- Timeout

Record FTS Data and reset alignment

Real Life Photos/Demonstration

Mars Sample Return Handling Concept of Operations

Mars Sample Return Mission
Winter 2021



Disassembly Components

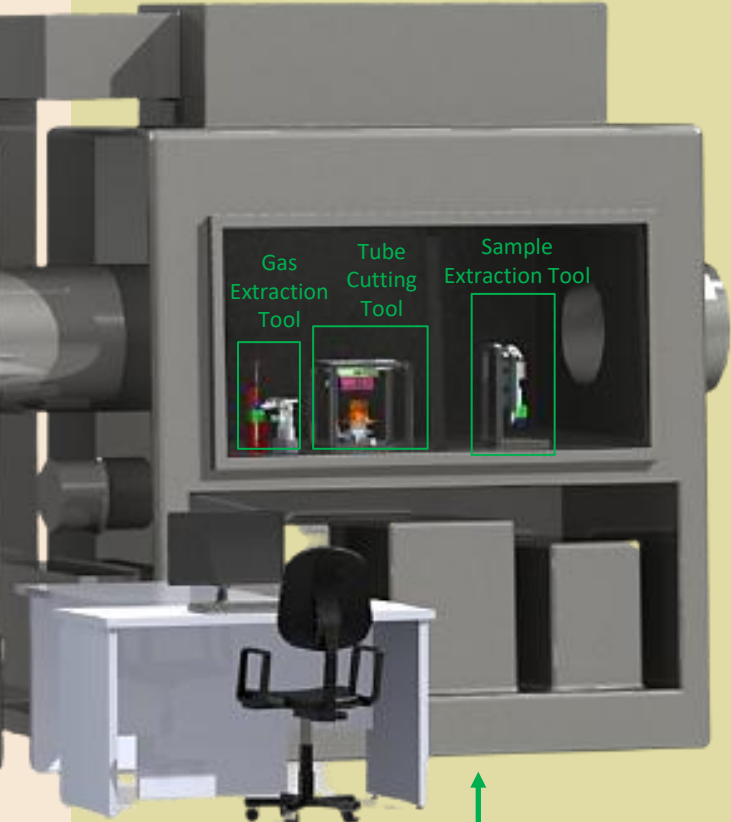


EEV Disassembly



First Double Walled Isolator

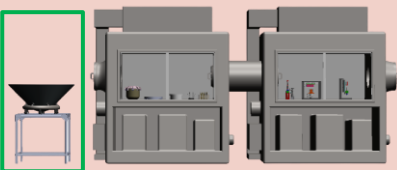
COS Disassembly



Second Double Walled Isolator

Tube Disassembly

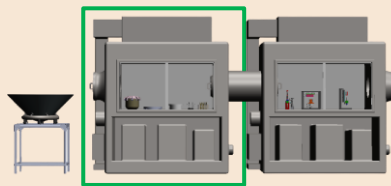
EEV Disassembly



Breach Room

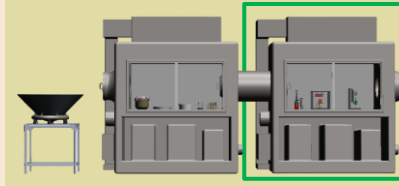
ISO Level: 6
Temperature: 20C
Pressure: 1 atm
Atmosphere: Air
Humidity: 30%

COS Disassembly



First Isolator

ISO Level: 4
Temperature: 20C
Pressure: 1 atm
Atmosphere: Nitrogen
Humidity: 0%

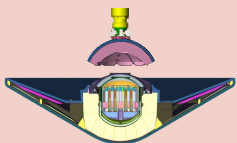


Second Isolator

ISO Level: 3
Temperature: 20C
Pressure: 1 atm
Atmosphere: Nitrogen
Humidity: 0%



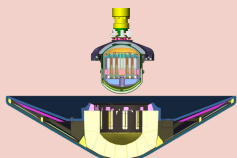
1. CAM Lid retention bolts released



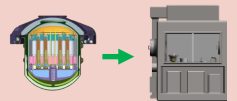
2. CAM Lid lifted away from EEV



3. SCV Base – EEV bolts removed



4. SCV removed from EEV

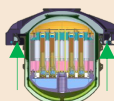


5. SCV moved to first isolator

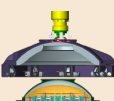
SCV Disassembly



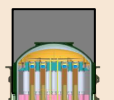
6. SCV has hole drilled to equalize pressure



7. SCV Lid latches are pressed to release Lid



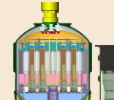
8. SCV Lid is lifted away from the SCV Base



9. Sleeve deflects pawls



10. COS is gripped by gripper

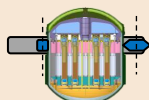


11. COS is removed from SCV Base

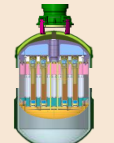
PCV Disassembly



12. PCV has hole drilled to equalize pressure



13. PCV cut along some TBD location below the braze line



14. OS is removed from the PCV Base

OS Disassembly



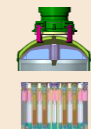
15. OS has bottom cap bolts removed



16. OS bottom cap is lifted away from the OS and atmosphere sample is curated



17. OS Lid latches are pressed to release lid



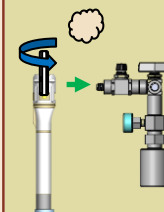
18. OS body removed from OS and PCV Lids



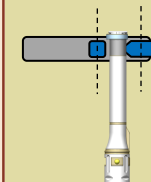
19. RSTA are removed one by one from OS body



20. RSTA are moved to second isolator



21. RSTA are vented and gasses are collected



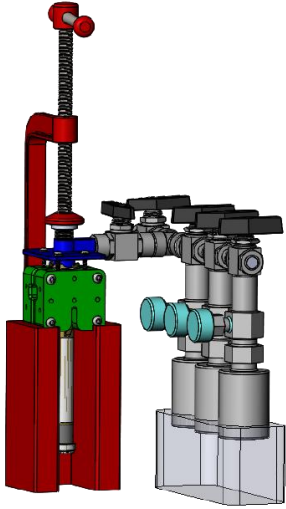
22. RSTA are cut below hermetic seal and above alumina



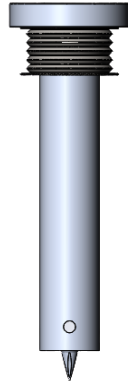
23. RSTA halves are separated and samples are curated

Tube Disassembly Tools

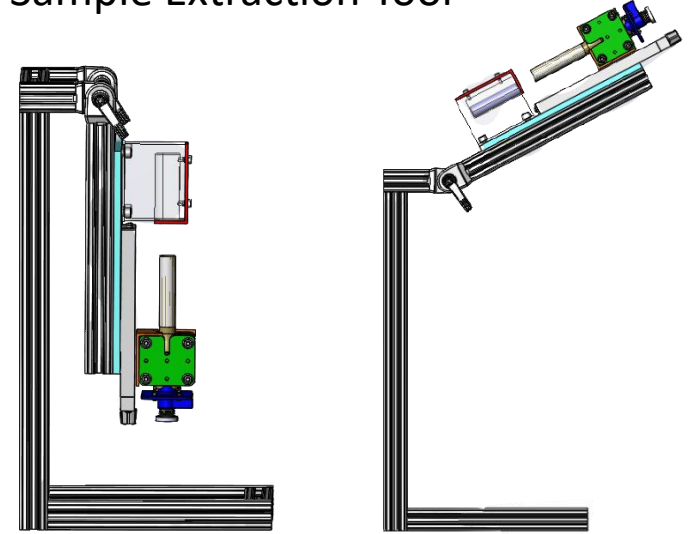
Gas Extraction Tool



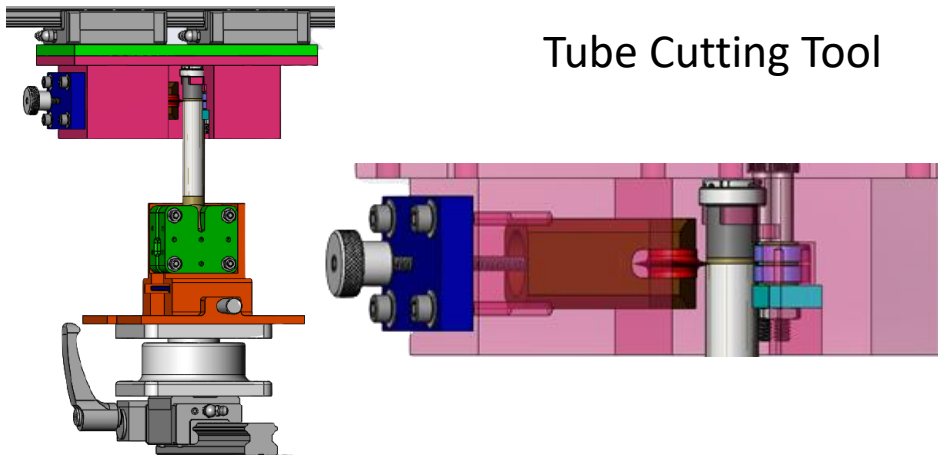
Puncture Tool



Sample Extraction Tool



Tube Cutting Tool



- Three conceptual tools
 - Demonstrate the various tube opening processes
- [Published IEEE Paper!](#)
- High level; no detailed design

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Gas Puncture Trade Space

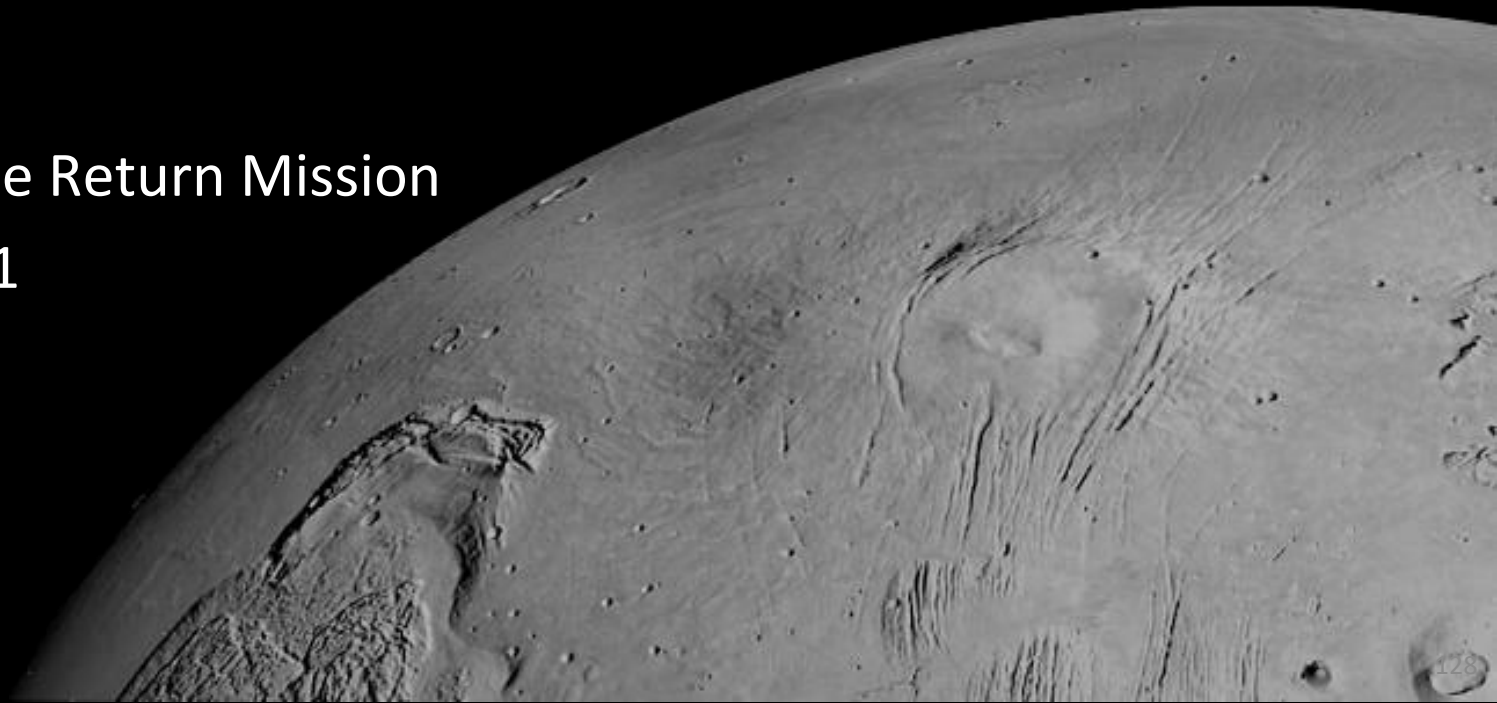
Process	Vibration	Chip/Dust Production	Potential Loss of Gas	Tube Deformation	Sample Composition Affected	Introducing Contaminant	Complexity	Overall Risk
Center Punch with Arbor Press	Medium	Low	Low	Low	No	Low	Low	Medium
Center Punch with Jackscrew	Low	Low	Low	Low	No	Low	Low	Low
Standard Drill Bit	High	High	Medium	Medium	Low	Low	Low	High
Step Bit	Medium	Medium	Medium	Medium	Low	Low	Low	Medium
Rotary Cutting Disc	High	High	Medium	Low	Medium	Low	Low	High
Slide Hammer	High	Medium	Low	Medium	Medium	Low	Low	Medium
Laser Cutter	Low	Low	High	Low	High	High	High	High
Melting and Inserting Tool	No	No	Low	High	Very High	No	High	High

Suggestion: Using a center punch with a jackscrew to create a slow and continuous pressing motion.
Small hole the size of tool tip will be created with little chip production for gas extraction

Testing has proven the capability of this tool with arbor press but jackscrew design has not been tested

Robotic Transfer Arm (RTA) Kinematics

Mars Sample Return Mission
Winter 2021



RTA Kinematics Simulation

Animation (1 for true, 0 for false)

Plot Joint Data Overtime? (1 for true, 0 for false)

Plot Margin Table? (1 for true, 0 for false)

Plot Lid/Arm Clearances? (1 for true, 0 for false)

Step Size

Program Features

- Forward and Inverse Kinematic simulation of 3DoF Planar RTA
- Specific poses, linear path planning, step size, animation, elbow transitions
- Calculates joint torques
 - Assuming arm moves slowly; static analysis
- Clearance checks with NTE Volumes
- Optimizing script to decrease link length and decrease joint torque
 - Parameter Search

Animation (1 for true, 0 for false)

1

Plot Joint Data Overtime? (1 for true, 0 for false)

0

Plot Margin Table? (1 for true, 0 for false)

0

Plot Lid/Arm Clearances? (1 for true, 0 for false)

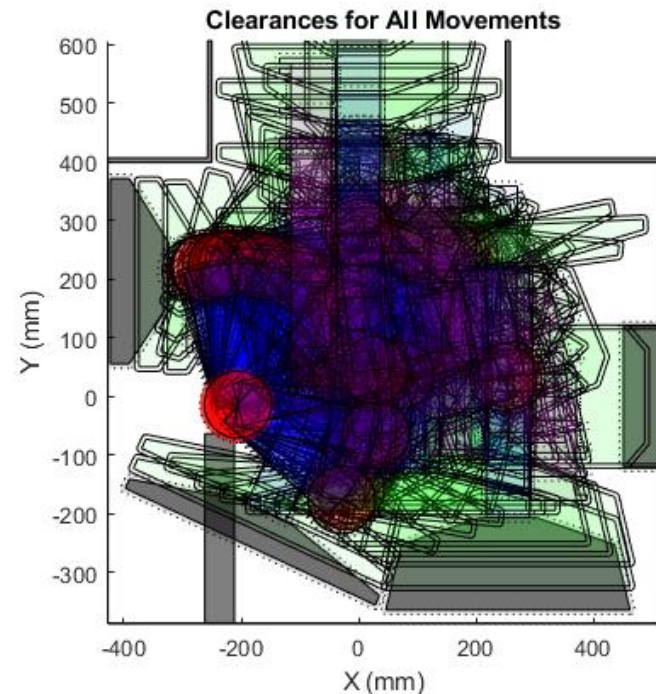
1

Step Size

2

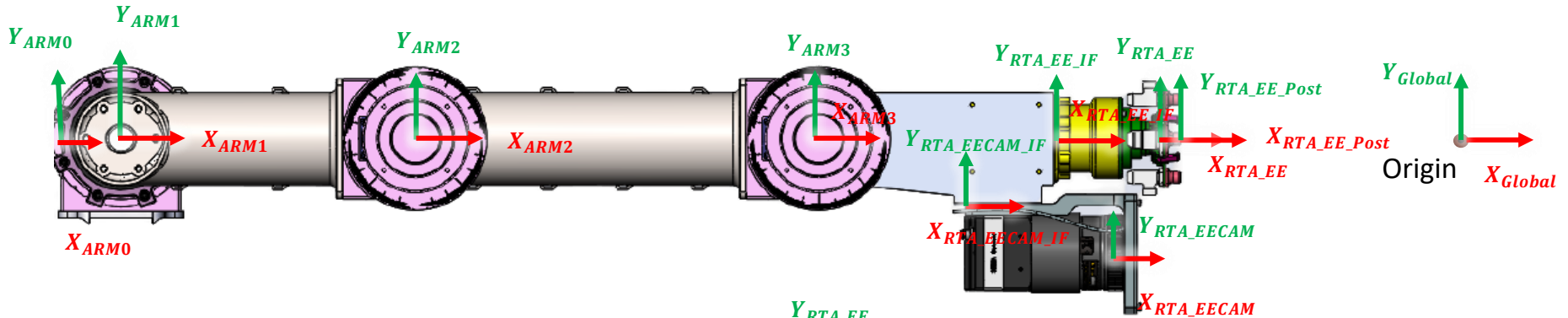
OK

Cancel

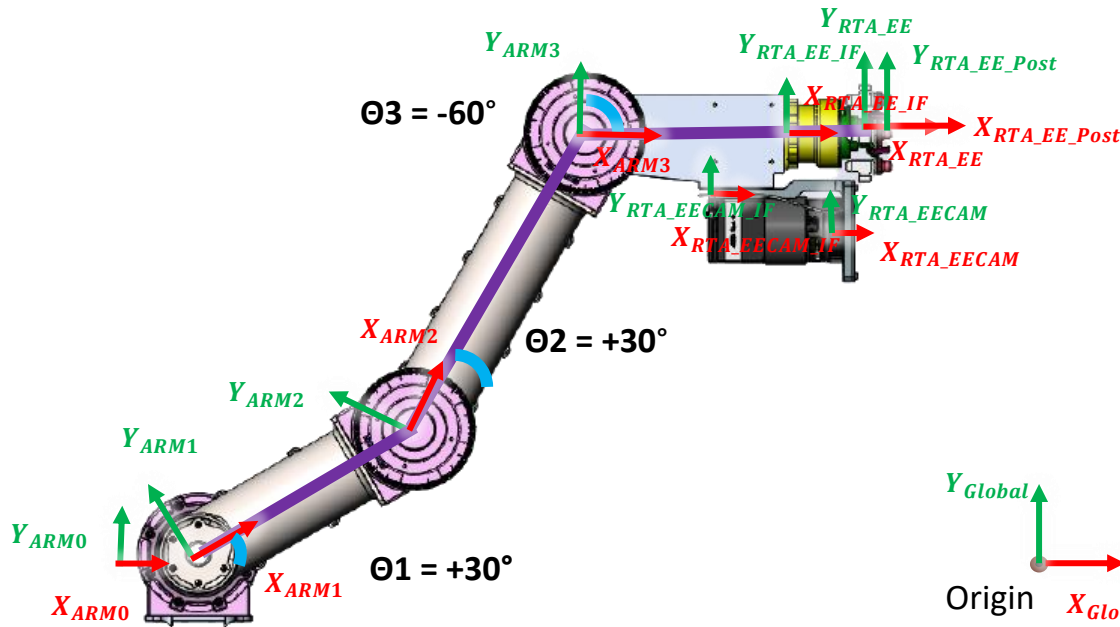


Arm Frames

ZERO POSE



RANDOM POSE



$$\psi = \theta_1 + \theta_2 + \theta_3 = 0^\circ = \text{EE rotation}$$

θ represents local rotation
 ψ represents global rotation

MATLAB Joint Optimization

- Created a cost function that seeks to minimize total link length, and ultimately find the lowest torque generated
- Brute force, optimization

INPUTS: Length of Link 1, Link 2, Link 3 as well as Joint 1 X,Y position

OUTPUTS: Configuration with lowest total torque

PSUEDO CODE

For Link1 Length Bounds:

 For Link2 Length Bounds:

 For Link3 Length Bounds:

 For J1 X position Bounds:

 For J1 Y Position Bounds:

 if: iterations L1, L2, L3, X1, Y1 can meet the main kinematic frames, store this combination and the sum of link lengths

 else: record the combination and move onto next iteration

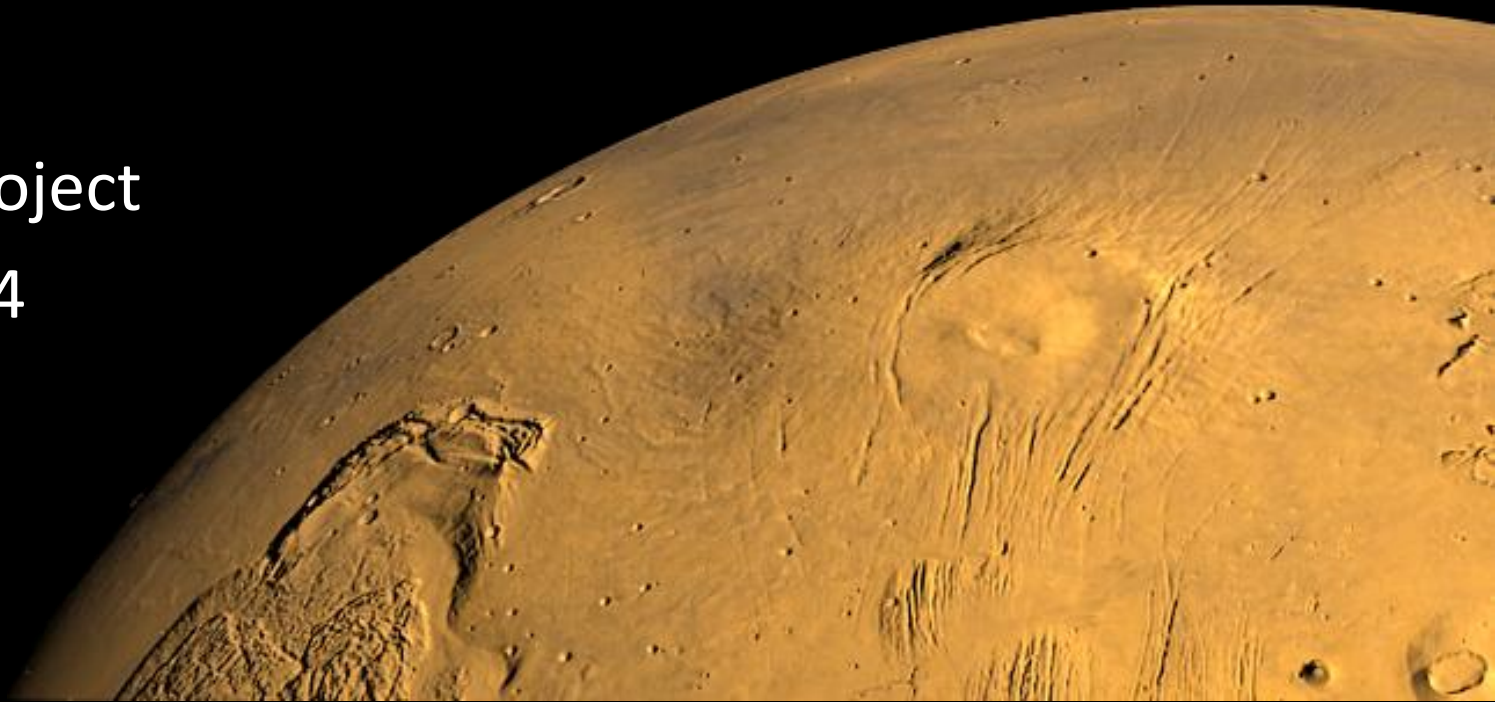
→ For solutions that close, choose lowest torque out of the available results

Results:

- Took a day to run (using multithreading) but ultimately worked!
- Optimized link lengths informed 3D printed RTA design

Chat Controlled Twitch Robot

Personal Project
Winter 2024



Objective

Background:

- In 2014, Twitch Plays Pokemon was a popular streaming channel where users completed the game through Twitch Chat commands
- My personal objective was to create a robot that streams itself and is remotely controllable through Twitch Chat

Requirements:

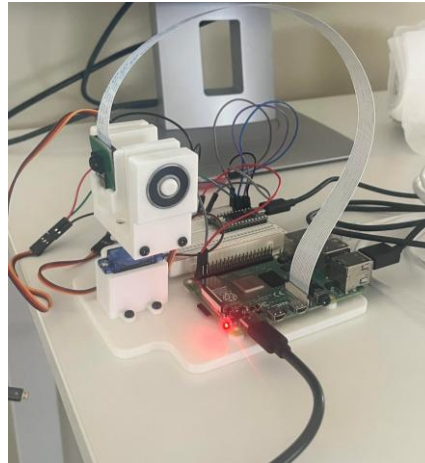
- Fully autonomous (stand-alone system)
- 2DoF camera control (pan/tilt)
- Chat integration
- Permanently streaming

Technologies Used:

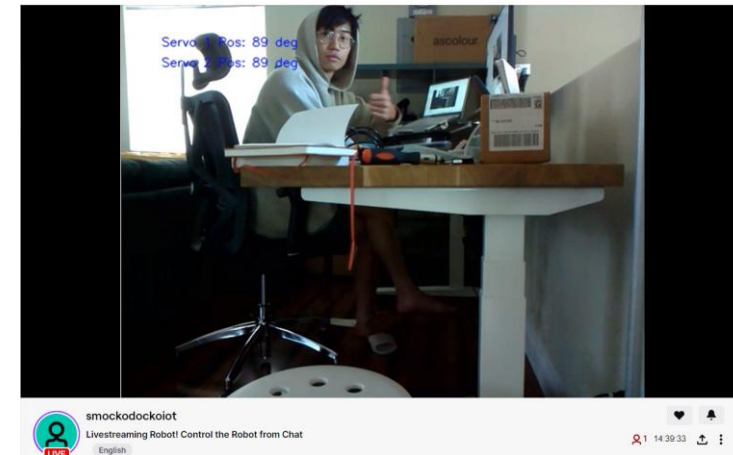
- ROS2
- MicroROS
- Teensy / Raspberry Pi / Servos
- Arduino C/C++
- Networking (UART, SSH)
- OpenCV, Video4Linux (V4L)
- Linux (Ubuntu)



Twitch Plays Pokemon



Twitch Robot Setup



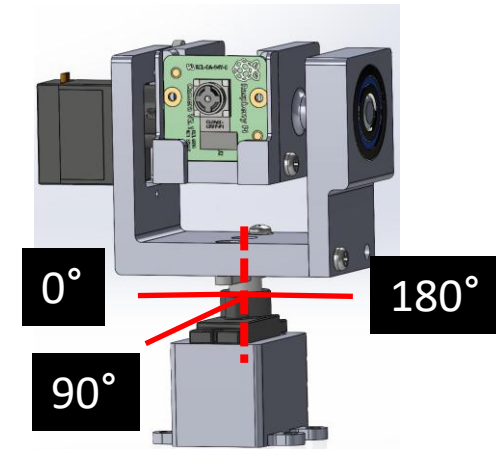
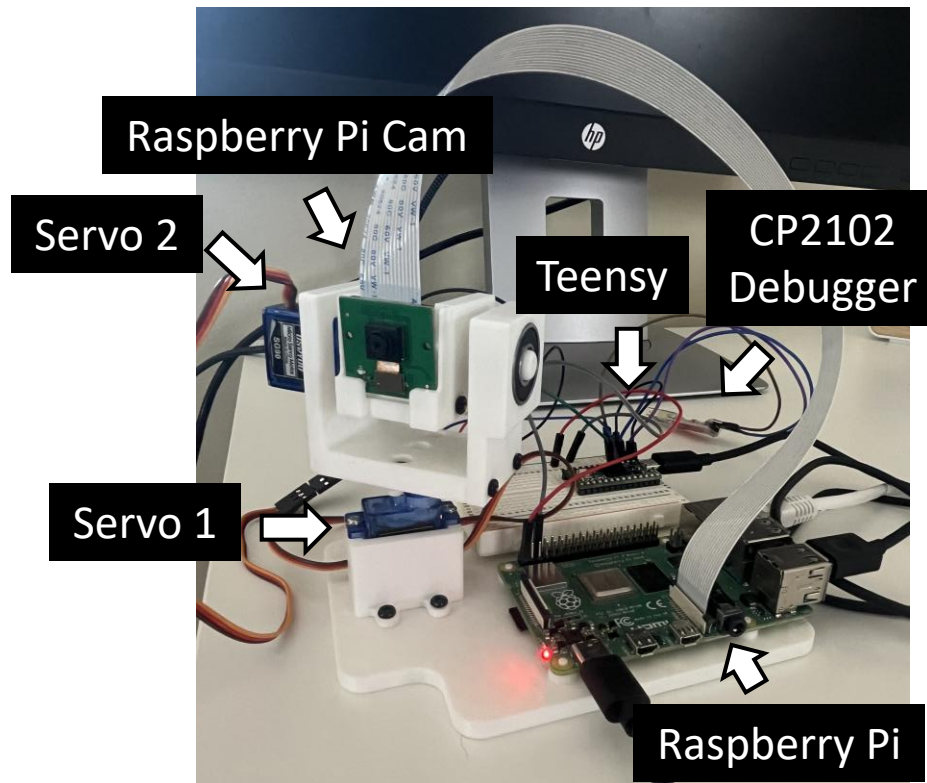
Live Twitch Stream

[Twitch Stream Link](#)

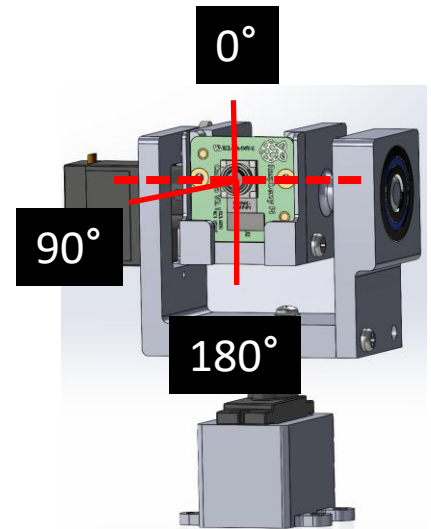
Twitch Robot Demonstration

Mechanical Design

- Simple Pan-Tilt Camera Design
 - SG90 Servos use 5V from Raspberry Pi (convenience)
- 2 Degrees of Freedom (Pan, Tilt) that go from 0-180deg
- Camera works with Raspberry Pi by using Video4Linux (V4L) drivers / ROS2 package sourced from online



Servo 1 Axis

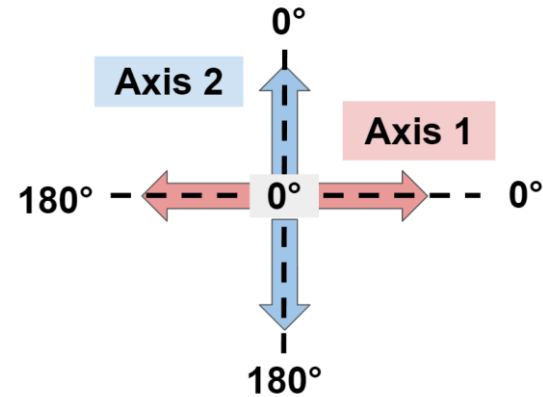


Servo 2 Axis

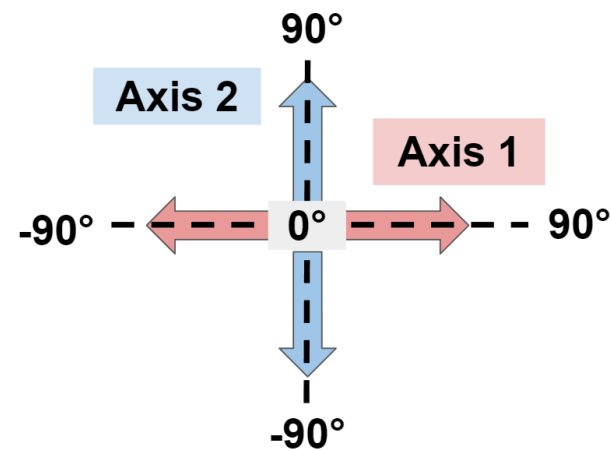
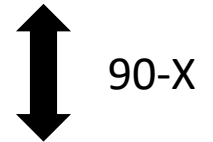
Axis Orientation



- Objective is to map the coordinates that the viewer sees, to the actual coordinates of the servo motors
- Makes for intuitive user experience as a centered position is [0,0]



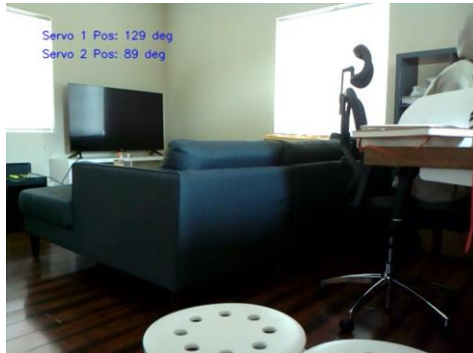
Servo-based Definition



Camera Frame Definition

High Level CONOPS

1. Live Stream is Started



2. User Inputs Chat Command

Command: !move_servo <servo_num> <servo_pos>

3. Message is parsed by Chat Bot for:

1. Servo Number (servo_num, [1 or 2])
2. Servo Position (servo_pos, [0 to 180°])

Welcome to the chat room!

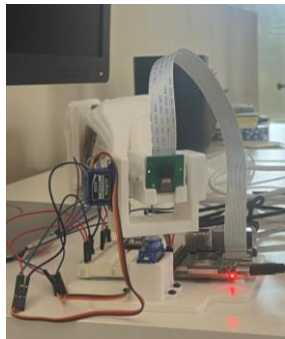
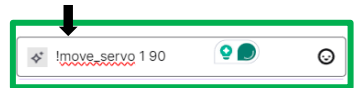
New

smockodocko: !move_servo 1 130

smockodockoiot: Robot is in motion! Moving Servo 1 to 130 degrees!

smockodockoiot: Robot Motion is complete.

Chat message



Chat message sent

smockodocko: !move_servo 1 90

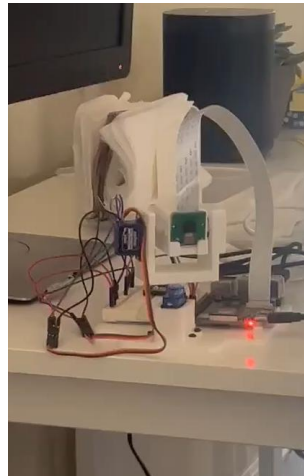
smockodockoiot: Robot is in motion! Moving Servo 1 to 90 degrees!

smockodockoiot: Robot Motion is complete.

Start: Servo 1 Pos = 130°

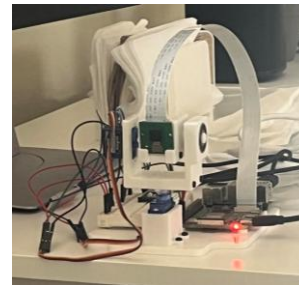
4. Command is sent to servo via. Teensy

5. Servo moves to new position



Movement from 130° to 90°

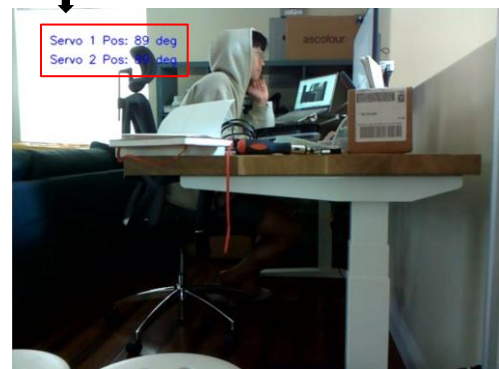
6. Teensy reports motion is complete



End: Servo 1 Pos = 90°

7. Chat bot is open to new commands

Position Updated



8. Camera image to stream is updated (delay exists)

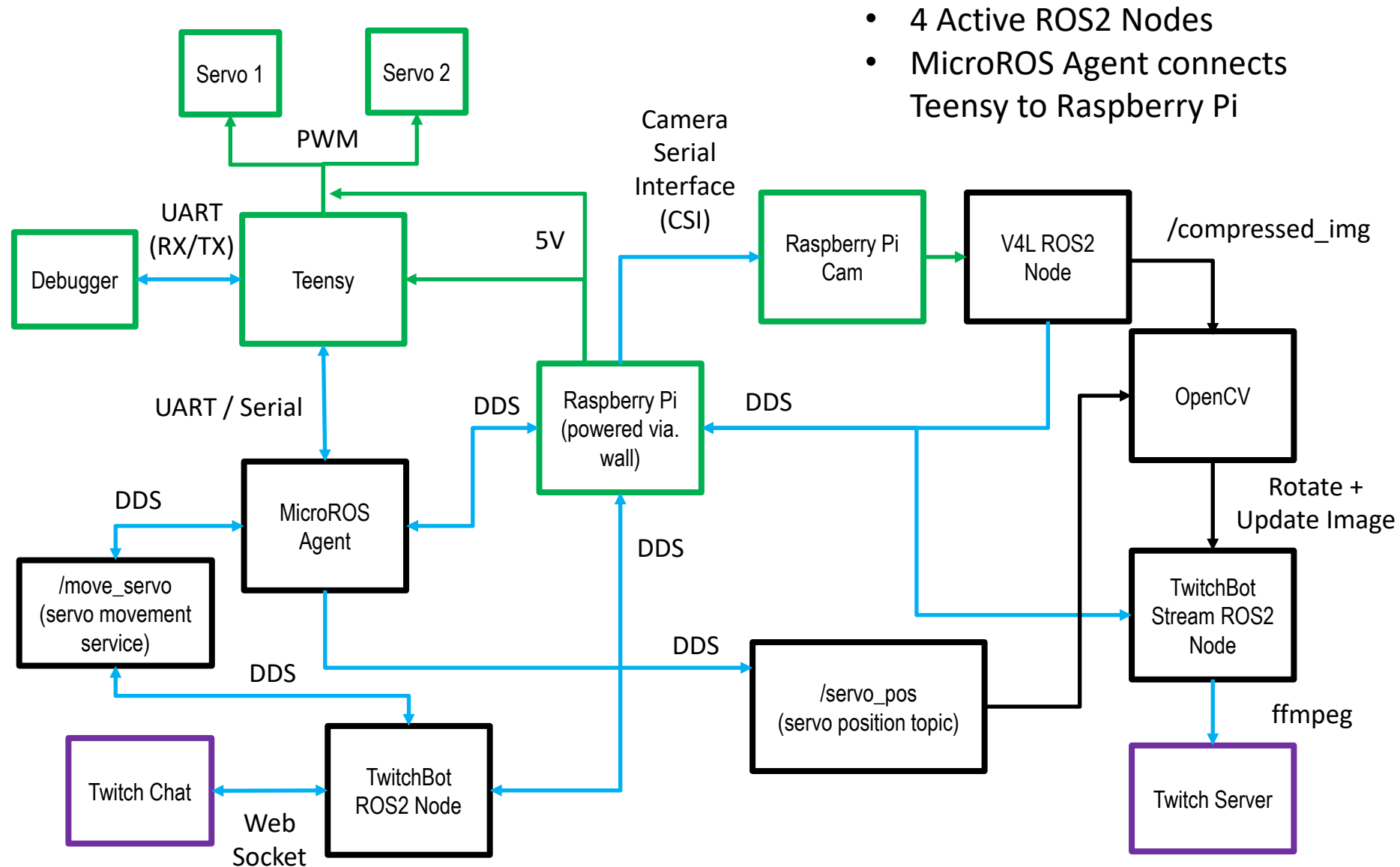
System Diagram

Hardware

Networking
/ Interface

ROS2

Twitch



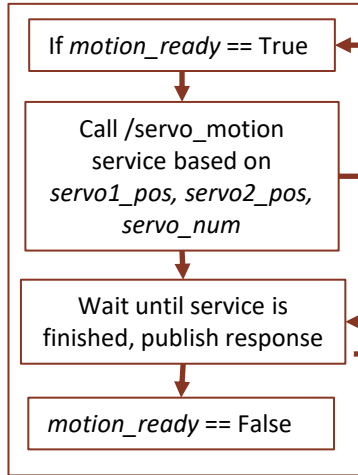
ROS Architecture

Shared variables accessed through mutex lock

TwitchBot Node

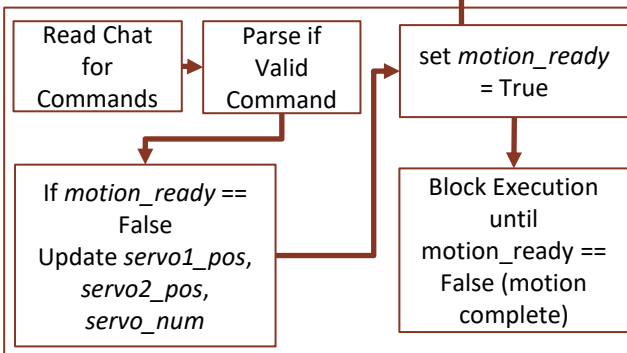
Thread 1

Control Loop



Thread 2

Control Loop



/servo_motion (service)

Request:
- servo_num
- servo_pos

Response:
- end_pos
- success

MicroROS

Connect agent (Rasp. Pi) to client (Teensy) via Serial

Process /servo_motion service call request

Move servo to requested position (Arduino servo library)

Send service response with servo end position, success (if within 2°)

/servo_pos (topic)

- servo1_pos
- servo2_pos

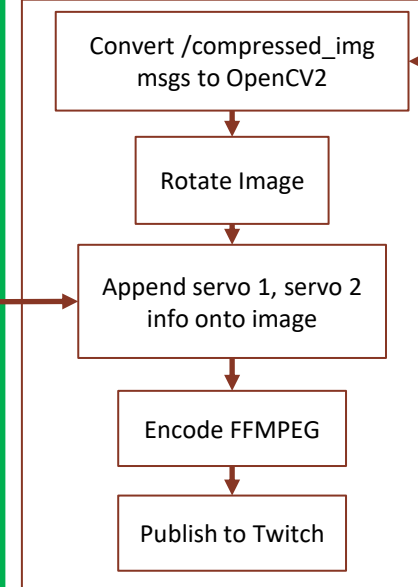
Note: Each ROS2 Node is run in its own **tmux** process so that they can be individually accessed through SSH from main computer

V4L ROS2 Node

Publish /compressed_img topic

TwitchBotStream Node

Control Loop



Project Summary

Summary

- Twitch Bot is currently working as expected and is accessible on [Twitch](#)!
- Has been tested to run for a week straight without any disruptions or network drops
- Latency mainly depends on user's internet speed (Twitch App works best)

Potential Improvements:

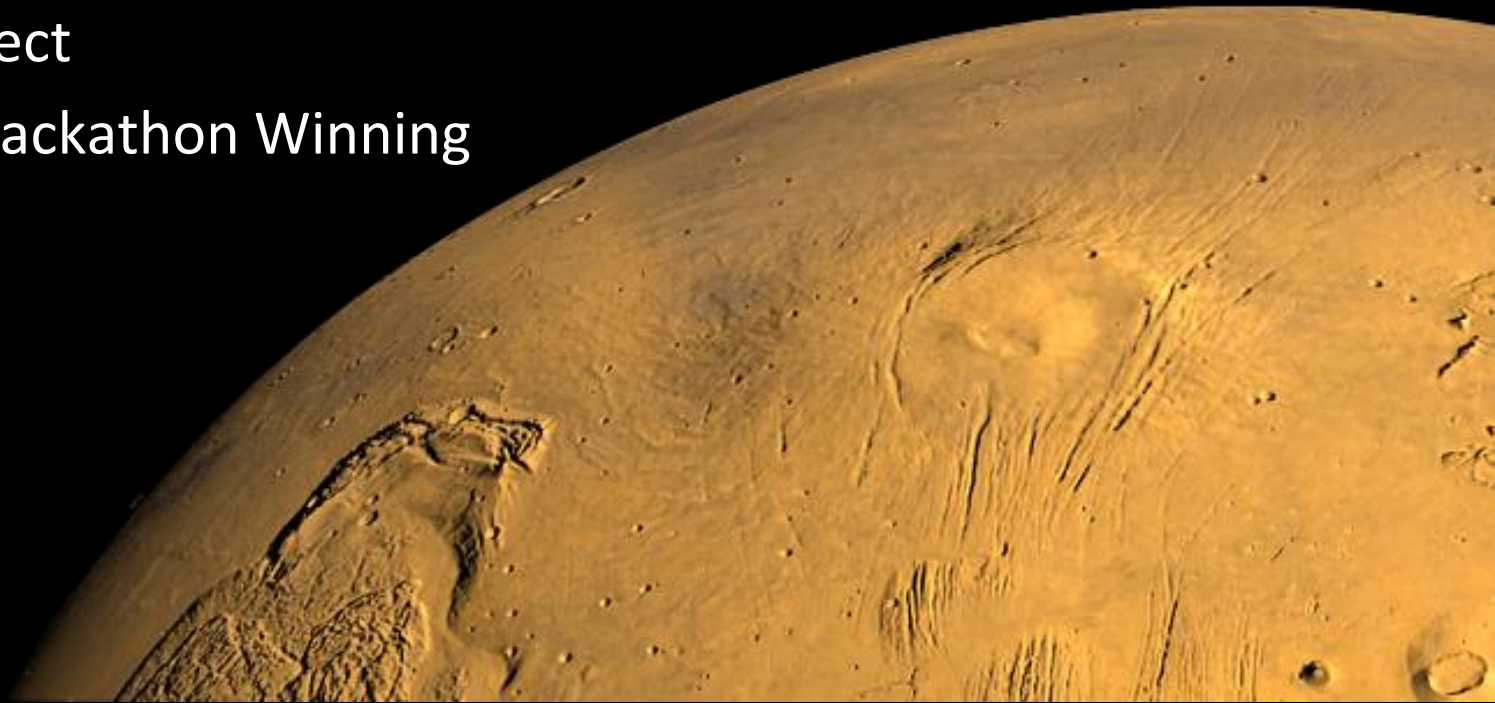
- Improve internet connection for higher quality upload speeds on Raspberry Pi
- Add additional commands to move to specific waypoints (i.e. !kitchen, !couch)
- Improve clarity of command arguments (add diagrams to the stream)
- Improve mechanical setup (higher quality servos)

MedMate

Personal Project

Flowers IoT Hackathon Winning
Submission

Fall 2020



MedMate Description

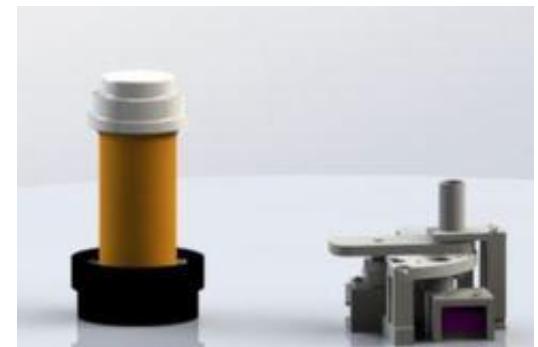
Flower Invention Studio IoT Hackathon Objective: Design a custom IoT Prototype within two weeks to solve a home automation task

Solution:

- MedMate, a device that helps patients and caretakers monitor medicine intake
Two Forms: pill bottle monitor and a pill dispenser
- MedMate tracks:
 1. when a user should take their prescription
 2. senses when a user has taken their medicine, and then
 3. logs this information in a database that is presented on a webpage
- Winning submission for Flowers Invention Studio IoT Hackathon
 - Worked with one other partner who focused primarily on web development
 - I designed the product, state machines, device code
 - Completed remotely!

References

- [Hackathon Submission Link](#) (with video)
- [GitHub Link](#)



**Pill Bottle
Monitor**

Pill Dispenser

MedMate demonstration Video

Hardware/Software Used

Tools Used:

- Ender3 Printer (personal printer)
- Solder

Software Used:

- Arduino C (C/C++)
- Eclipse Paho MQTT Python client (Python)
- Cloud Firestore (Google Firebase)
- React (JS)

Protocols:

- MQTT (Message Queuing Telemetry Transport)
- I2C (Inter-Integrated Circuit)

Hardware	Images
ESP32 IoT Microcontroller	
VCNL4010 Proximity Sensor	
DRV5053 Analog-Bipolar Hall Effect Sensor	
Tower Pro SG90	
5V Power Supply	
Breadboard, 220 Ohm Resistors, Multicolor LED	

Project Motivation

Motivation: Help my Dad and caregiver track medications by:

- reminding patients to take medicine
- allow caregiver to monitor intake history

Design Philosophy:

1. Low profile
2. Cheap
3. Simple hardware
4. Simple user interface
5. Interfaces with any standard pill bottle

ESP32 was our chosen controller because it is configurable with the Arduino client and has full IoT functionality. The chosen network protocol was MQTT, as it is designed for simple communication between a controller and host server.

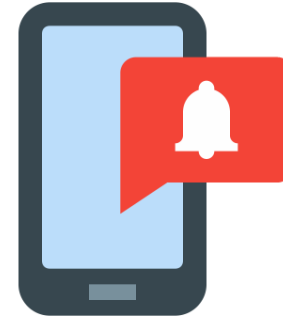
MedMate Pill Bottle Monitor Storyboard



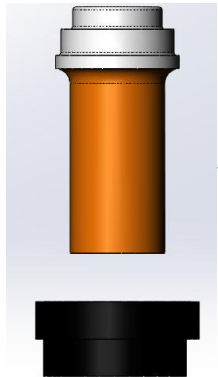
1. User enters their prescription information



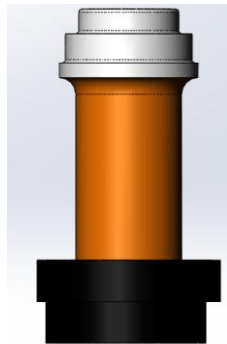
2. Server keeps track of when user should take medicine



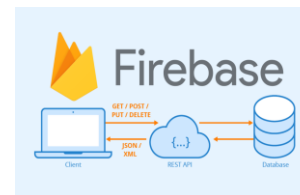
3. User is notified to take medicine



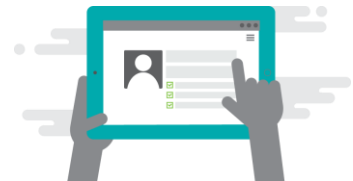
4. Pill bottle is taken off MedMate



5. Pills are consumed and bottle is put back on MedMate



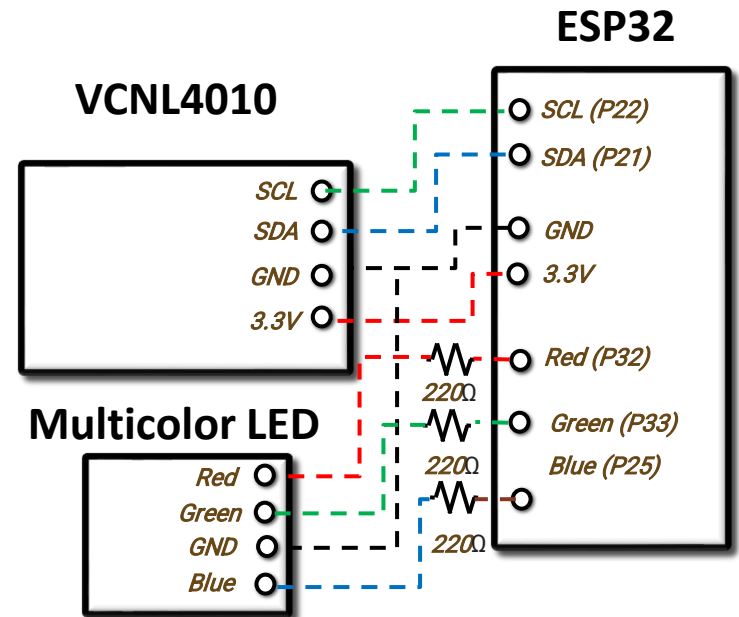
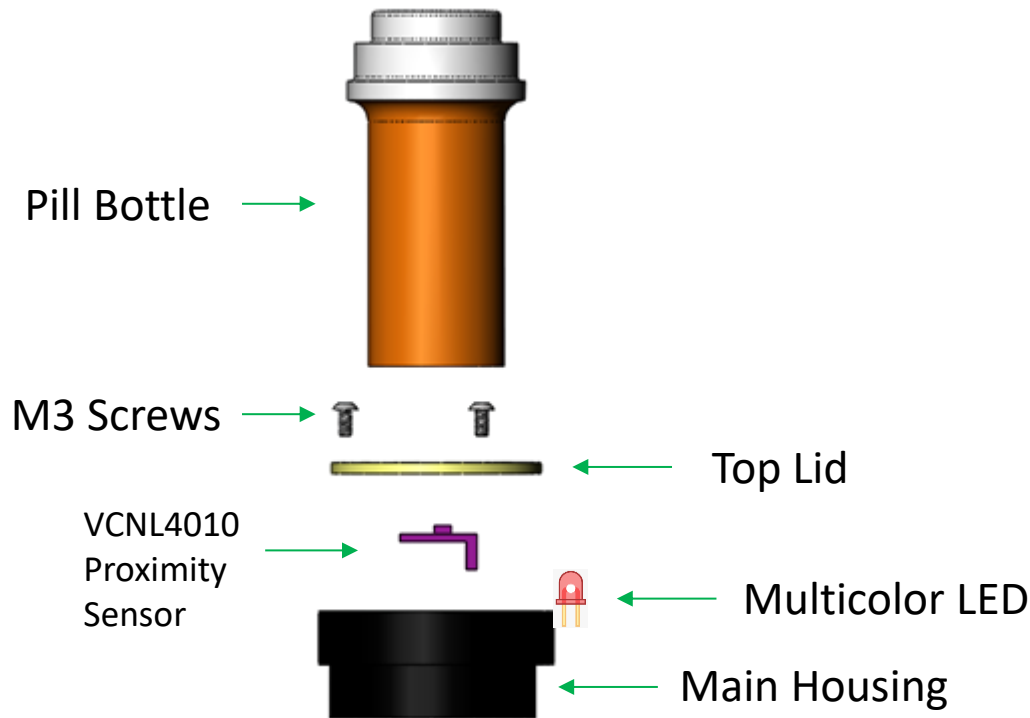
6. Time of Intake is uploaded to Database



7. Patient History shown on Webpage

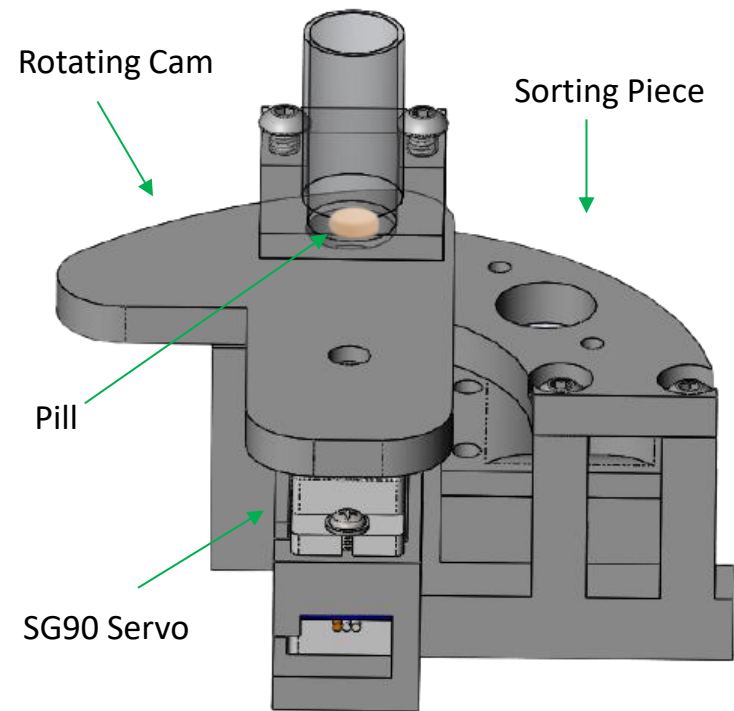
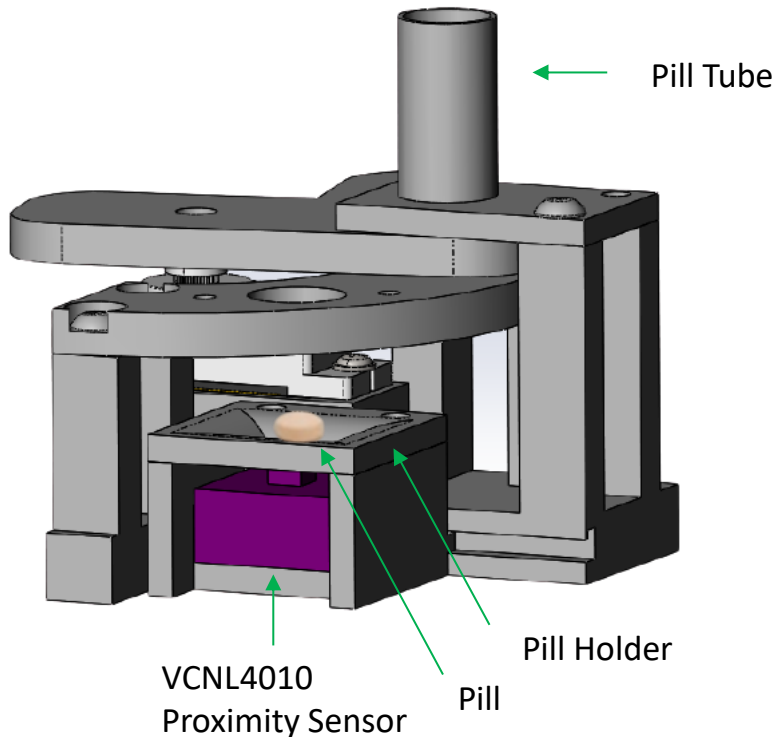
Final Prototype (Pill Bottle Monitor)

- Uses Proximity Sensor to sense pill bottle presence
- Added LED for debugging/clarity
- Fits common pill bottle diameters



Final Prototype (Pill Dispenser)

- Actuates using servo and rotating cam to release pills at medication time
 - Controls how much medicine the user can take.
- Still uses proximity sensor to detect if pill has been taken
- Can be part of a larger assembly – designed for demonstration purposes



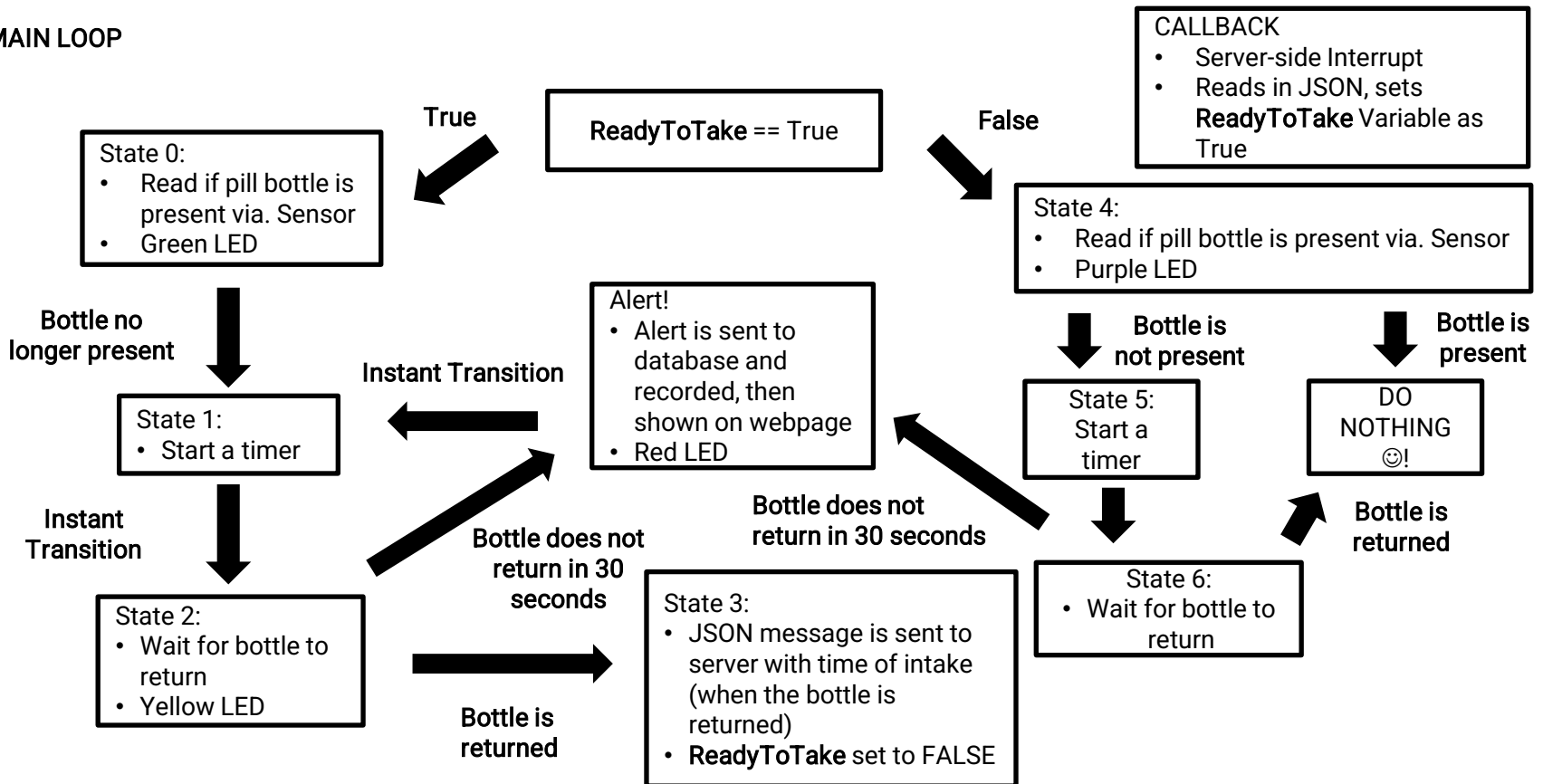
MedMate Pill Bottle Monitor State Machine

SETUP

- Connect to MQTT Broker
- Subscribe to Server Topic
- **ReadyToTake** Variable set to FALSE

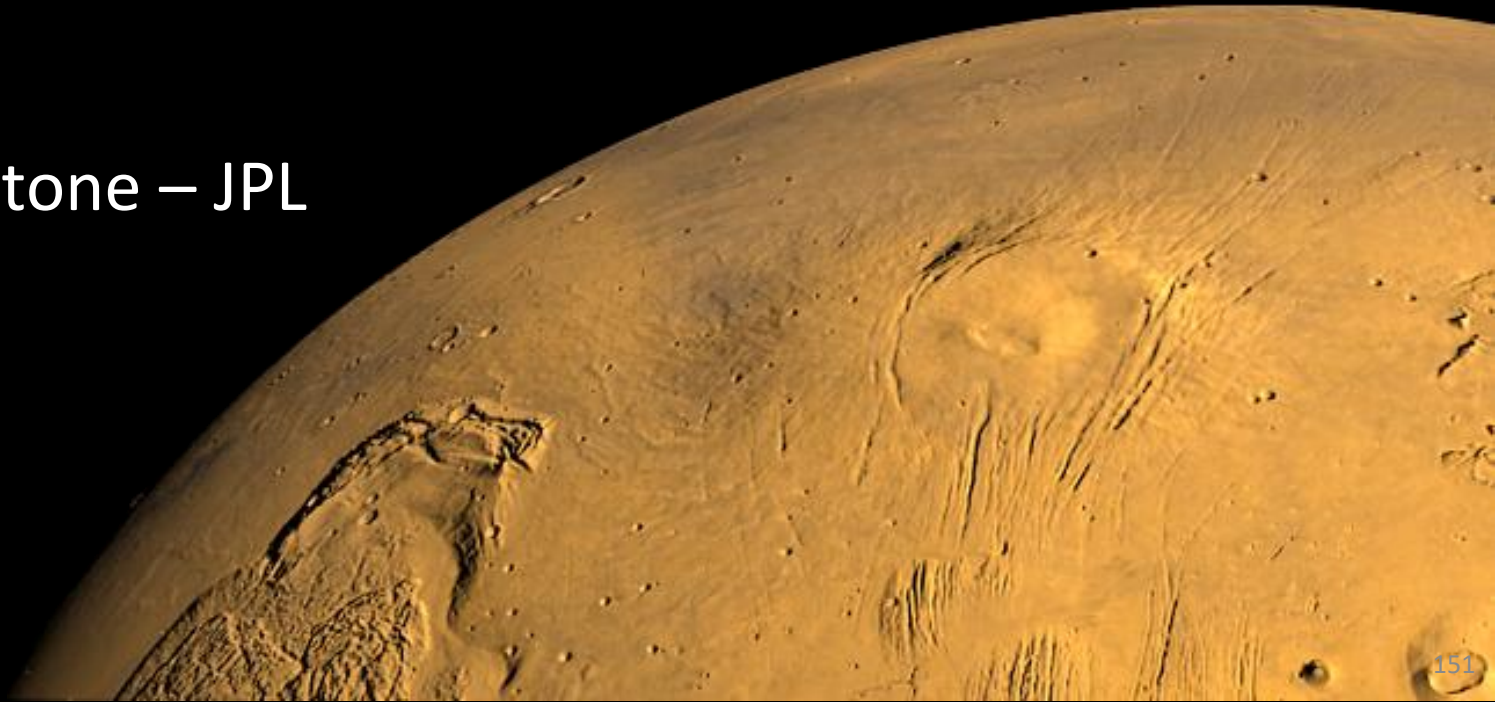
- Wait for Server-side ACK JSON with register info
- Device initialized as prescription/"free tracking"

MAIN LOOP



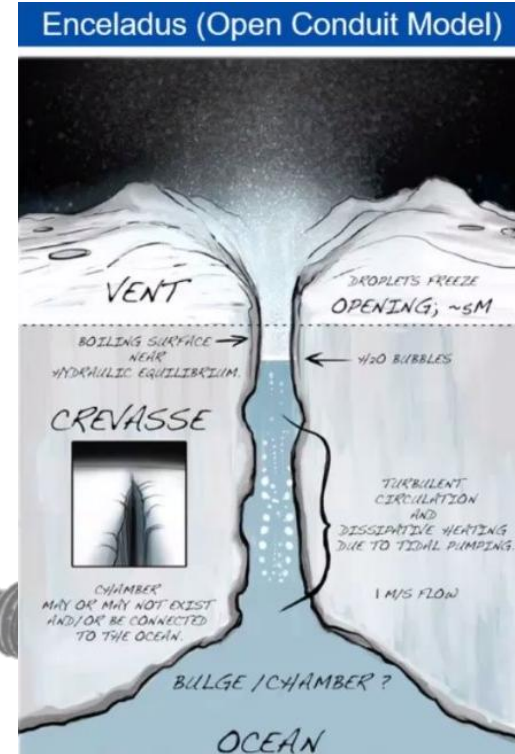
Exobiology Extant Life Surveyor Robot Sampling System

Senior Capstone – JPL
Fall 2021



Background & Problem Statement

- Exobiology Extant Life Surveyor (EELS)
 - Bio-inspired snake-like robot
 - Traverse Enceladus' icy ocean-world terrain to **search for life**
- Front nose segment must be designed to:
 - Collect **sub-glacial liquid samples**
 - Gather **environmental data**
 - Travel over icy terrain and underwater
- Impact
 - Understand factors contributing to **melting glacial icecaps**
 - Explore glacial moulin and crevices traditionally **inaccessible to humans**
 - Determine conditions required to **sustain life**



Personal Contributions: Project Management,
Mechatronics / Code Design, Literature Research

System Requirements



EELS System Integration

- Fits within Ø12cm X 50cm cylinder
- Withstands icy environmental conditions
 - -20 to 20°C
 - 0 to 150psi
 - 0 to 2m/s flow
- Withstands traversal through environment



Liquid Sampling System

- Acquires 2 separate 1L samples of liquid
- Sterilizable collection system
- Easily removable liquid samples
- Fill at rate of 0.5L/min

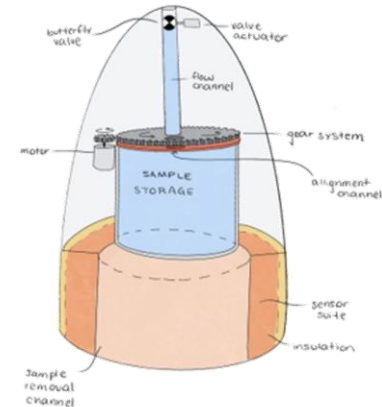
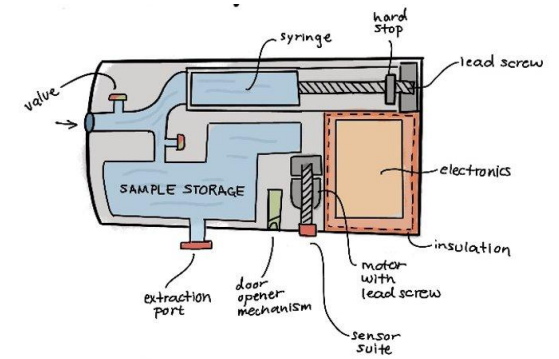
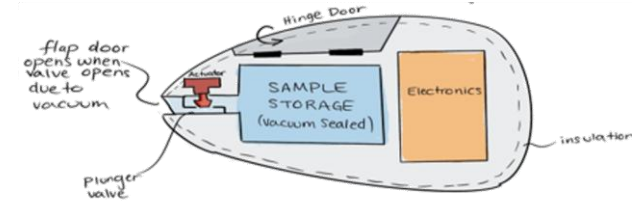
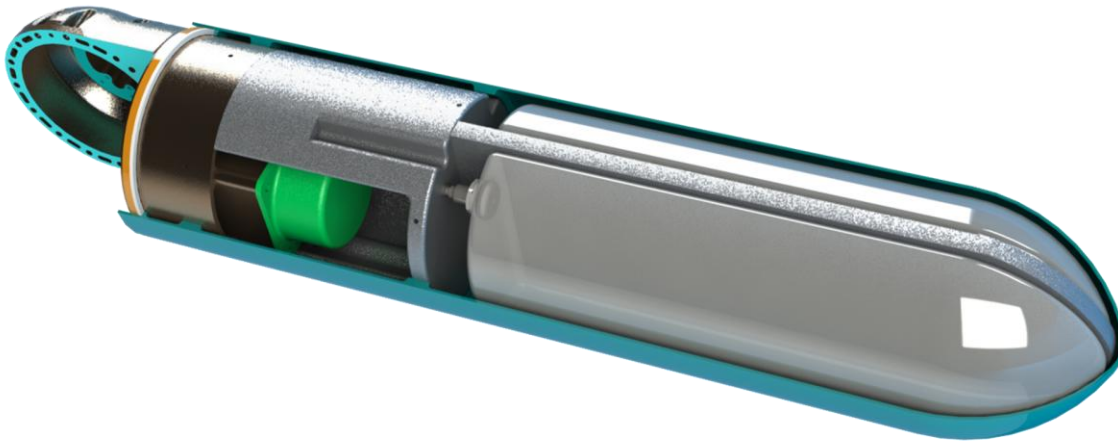


Sensor Data Collection

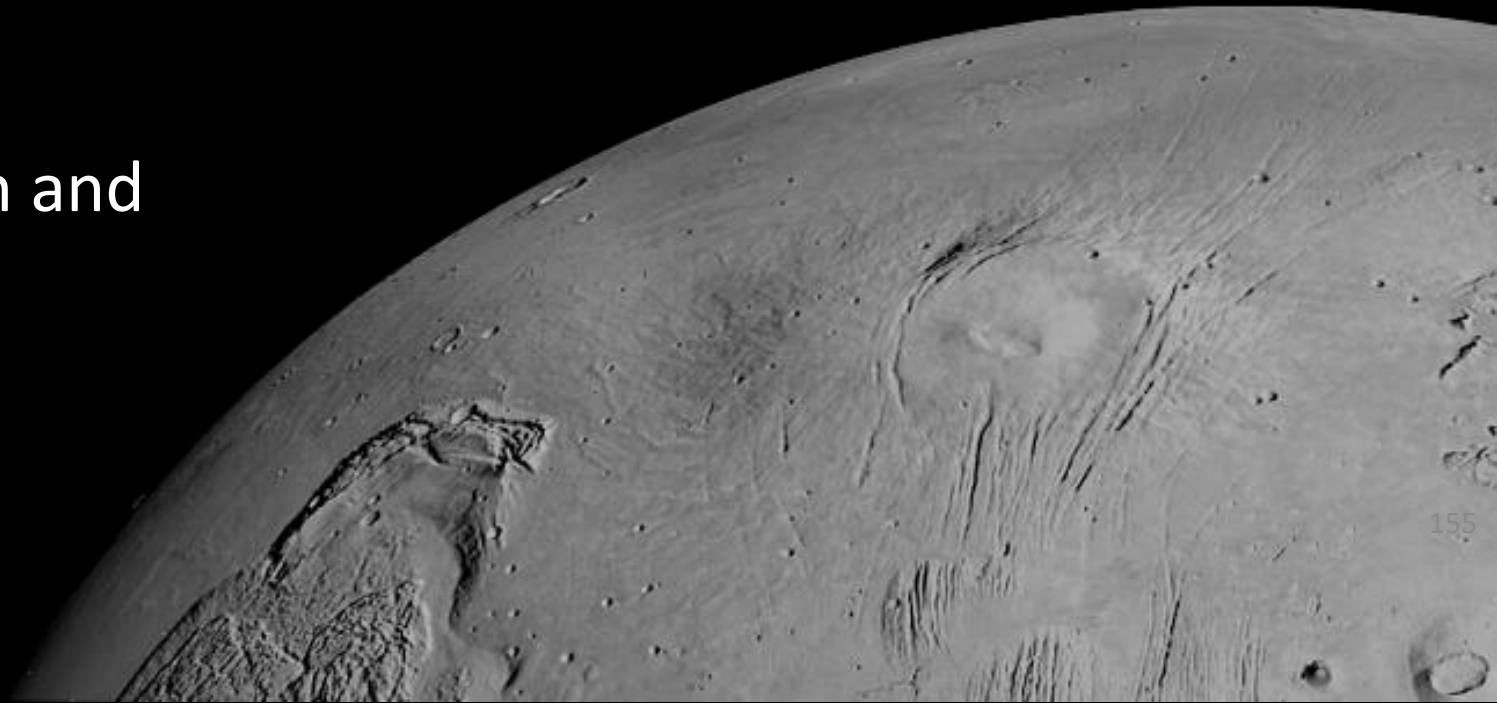
- Gather pressure, temperature, aquatic chemistry, and imagery data
- 0°C minimum sensor operating temperature
- -20°C minimum sensor storage temperature

Preliminary Sketches & CAD

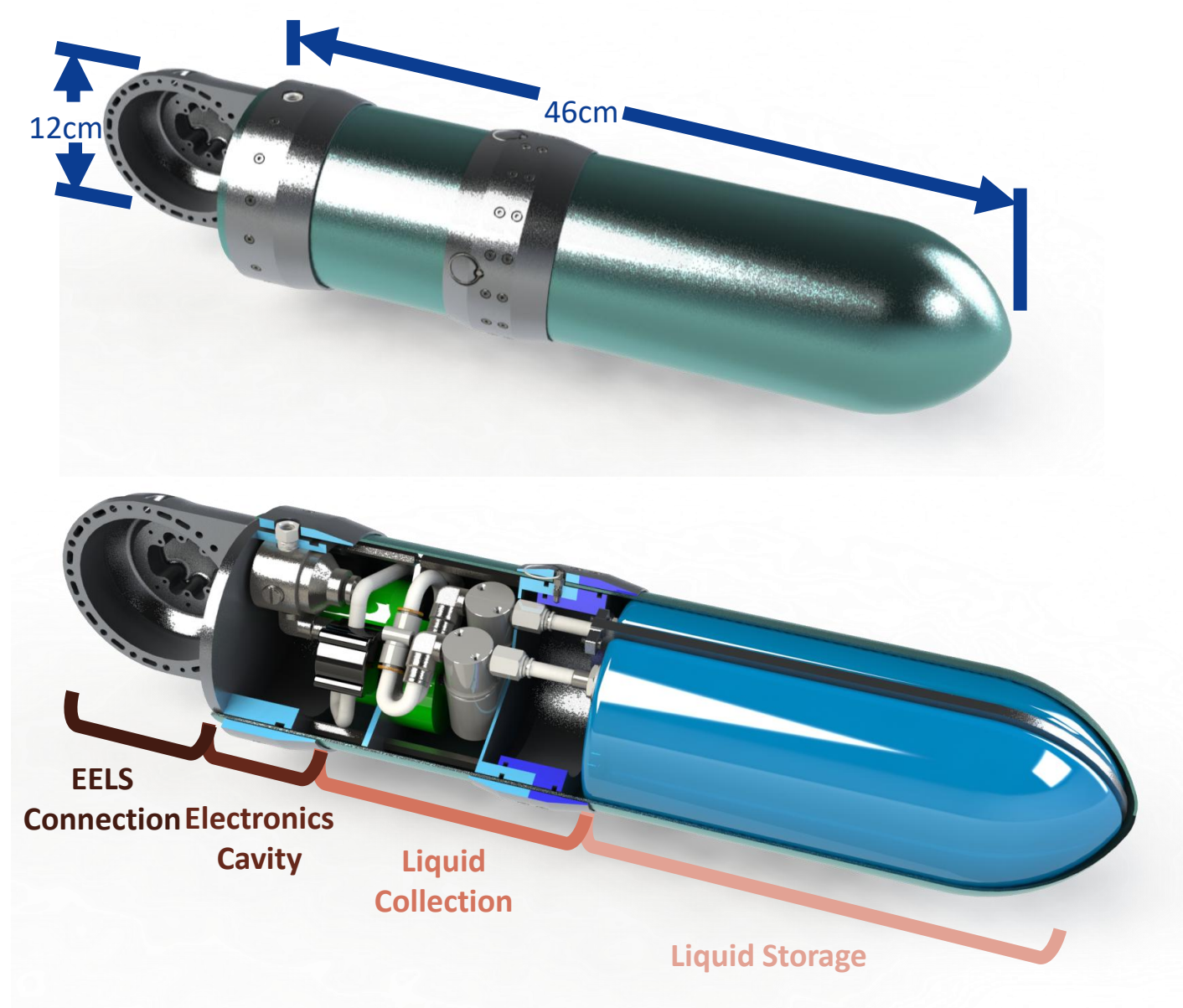
- Initial ideation created an outline of the system shape and major mechanical components
- Both **vacuum** and **pump-based** designs were considered



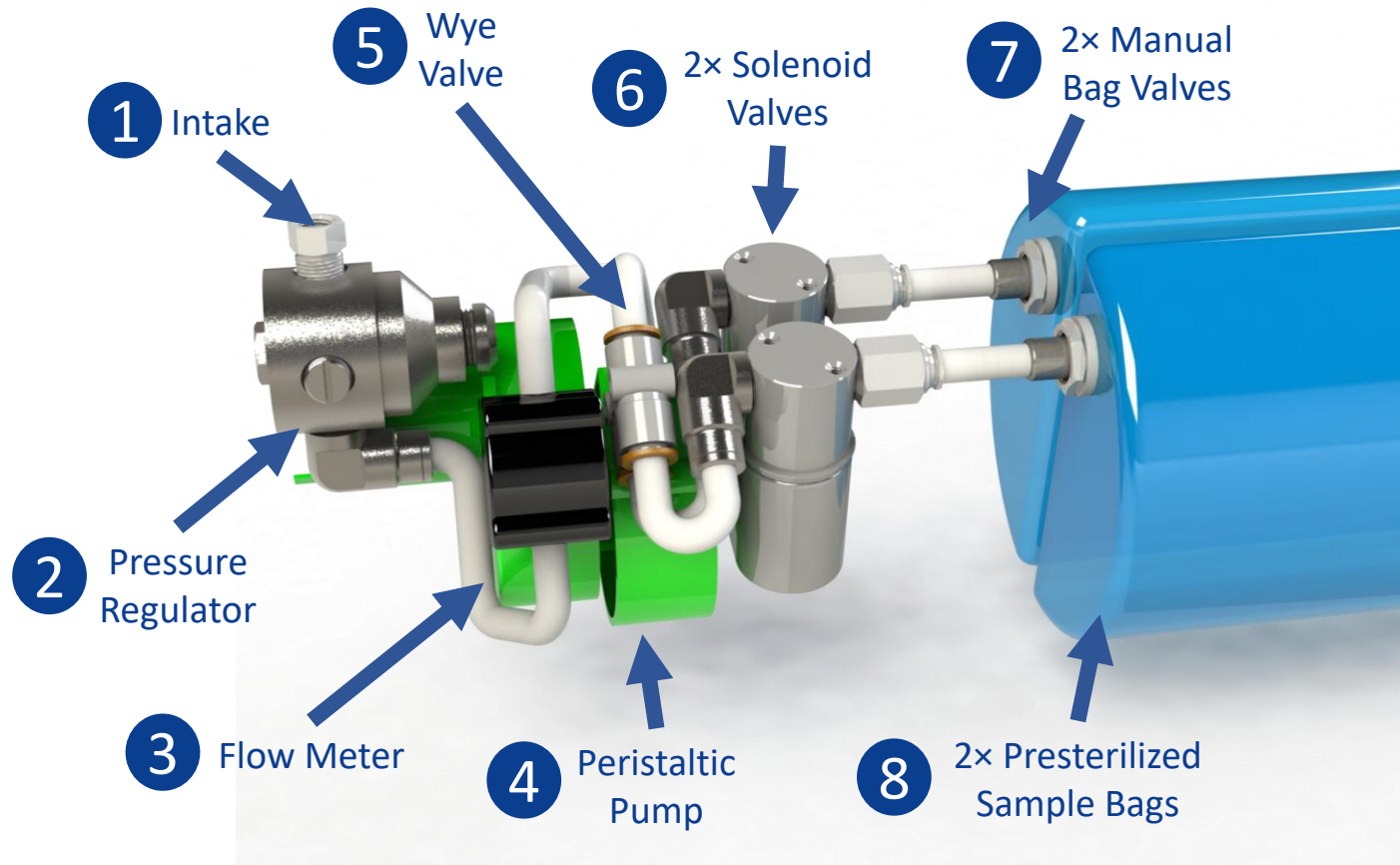
Final Design and Prototype

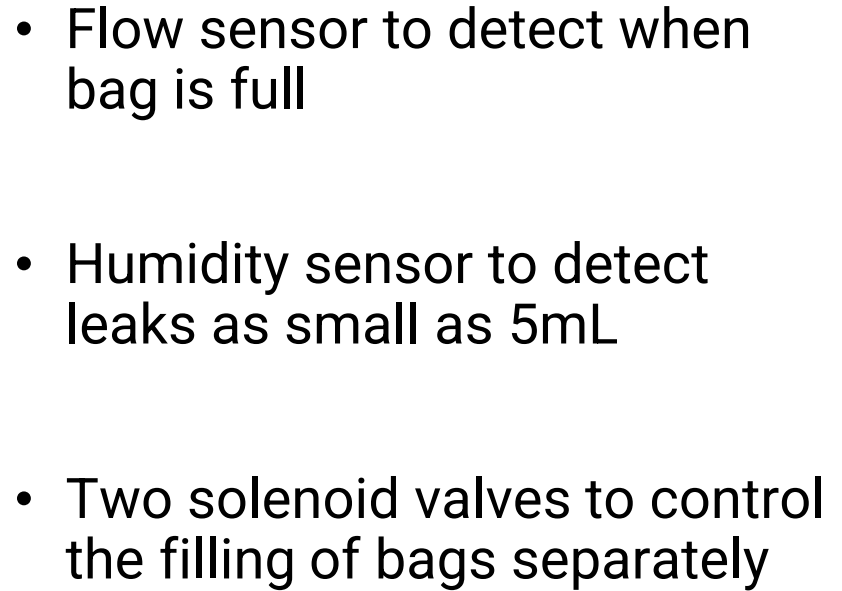


Mechanical: Overview

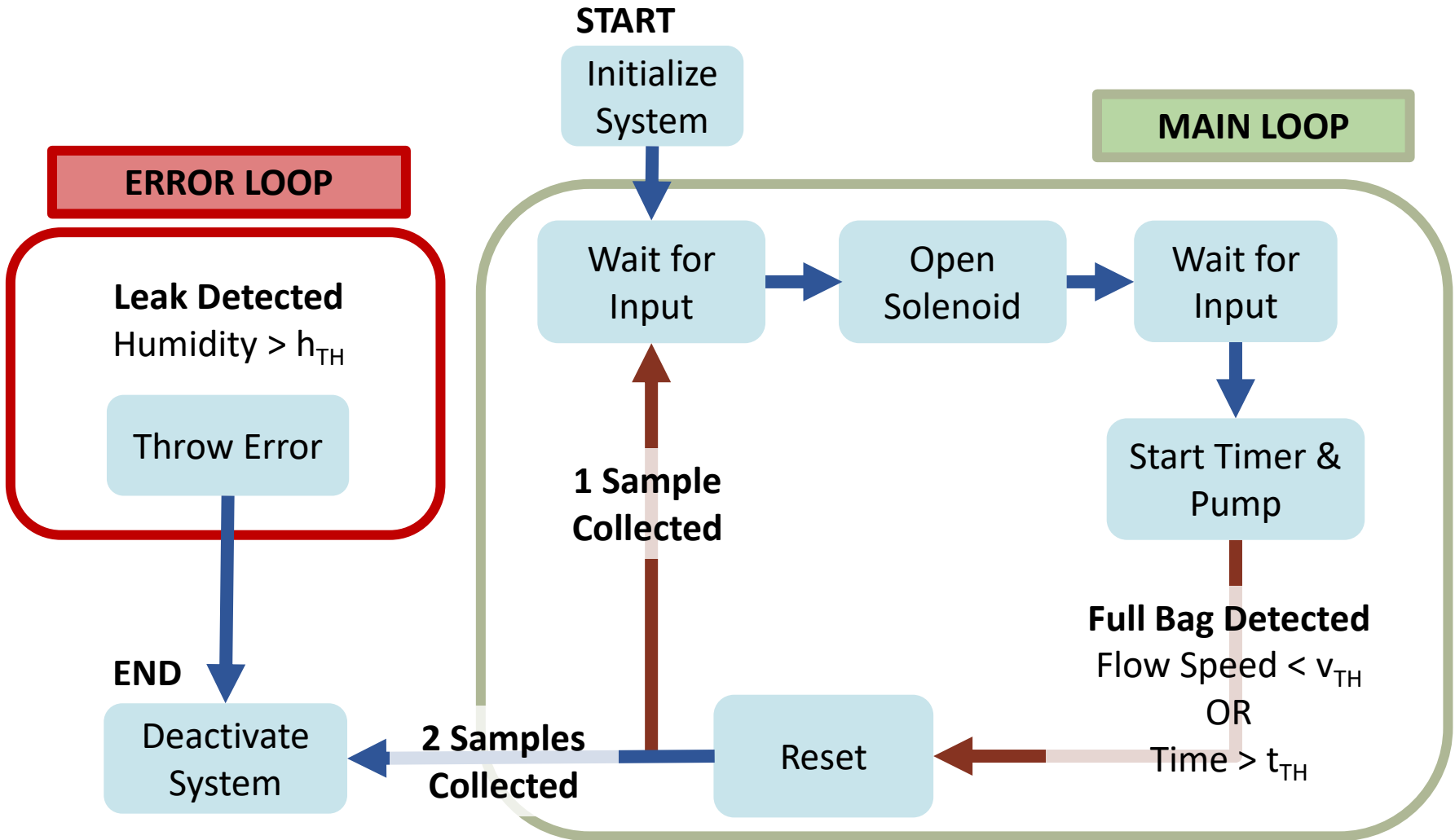


Mechanical: Liquid Collection

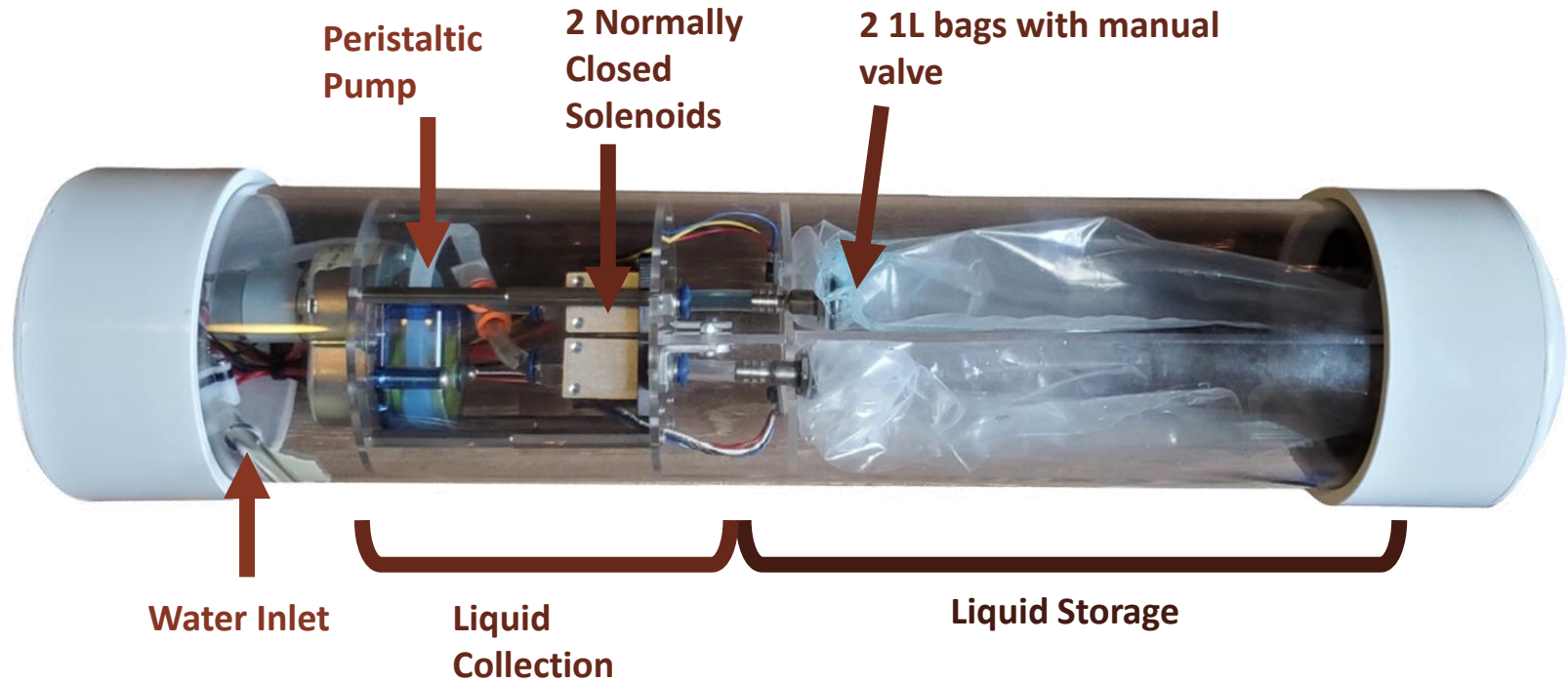




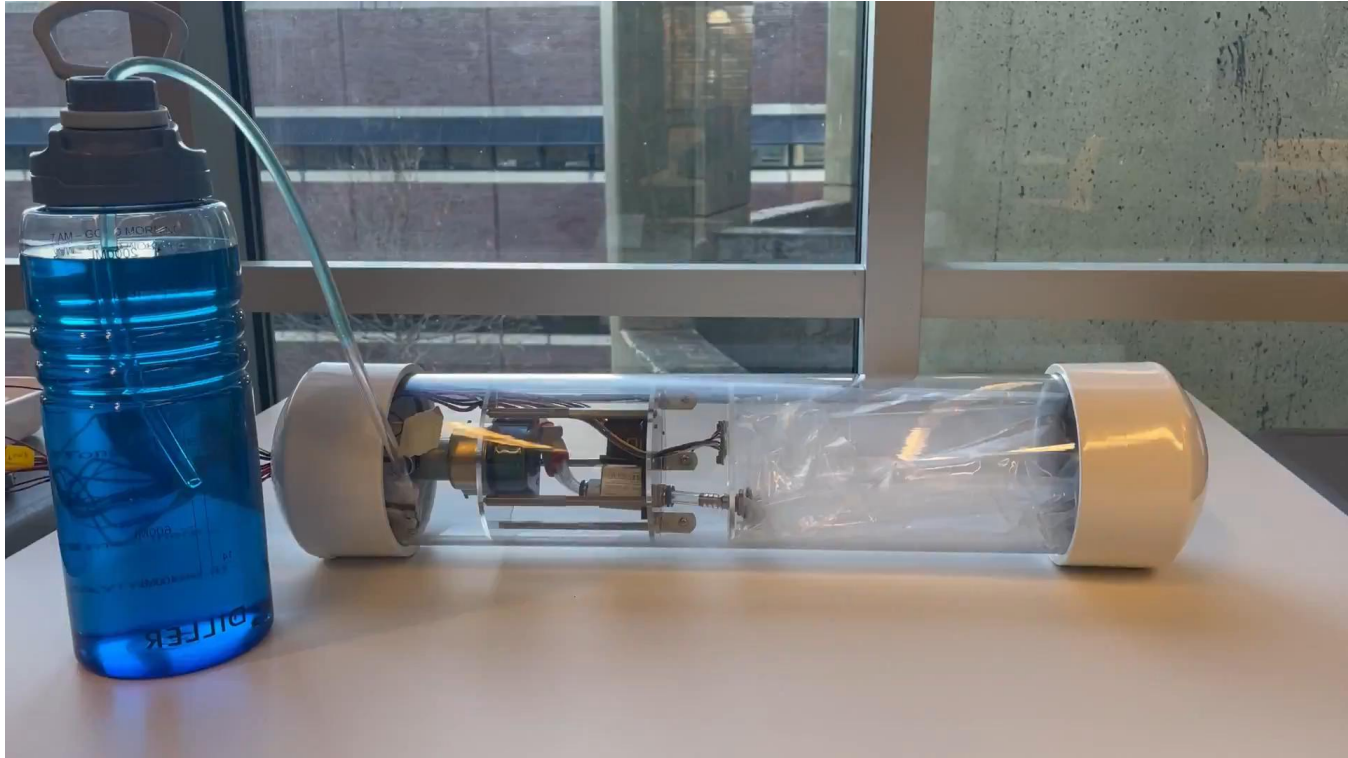
Software Overview



Final Prototype



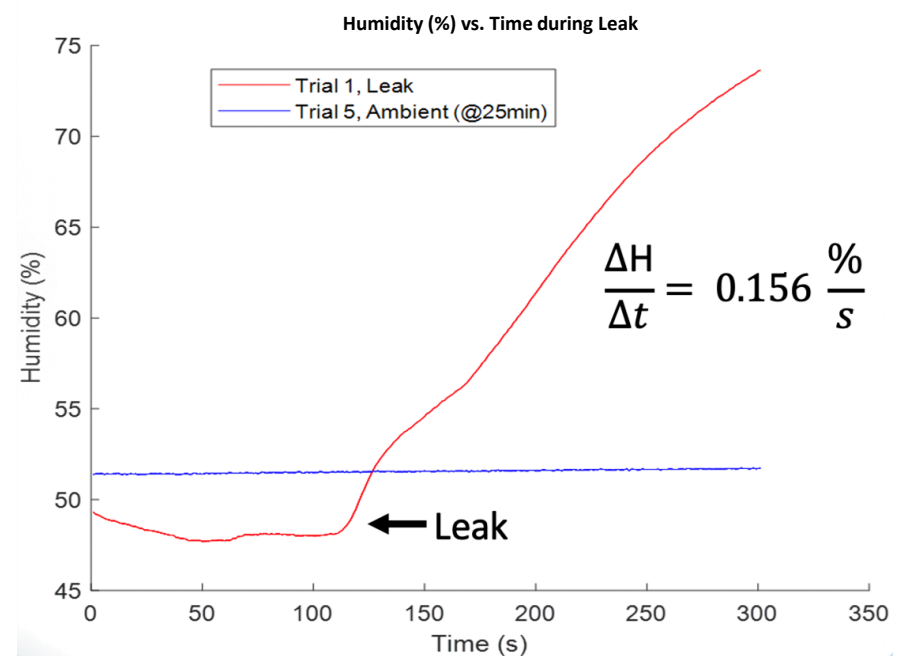
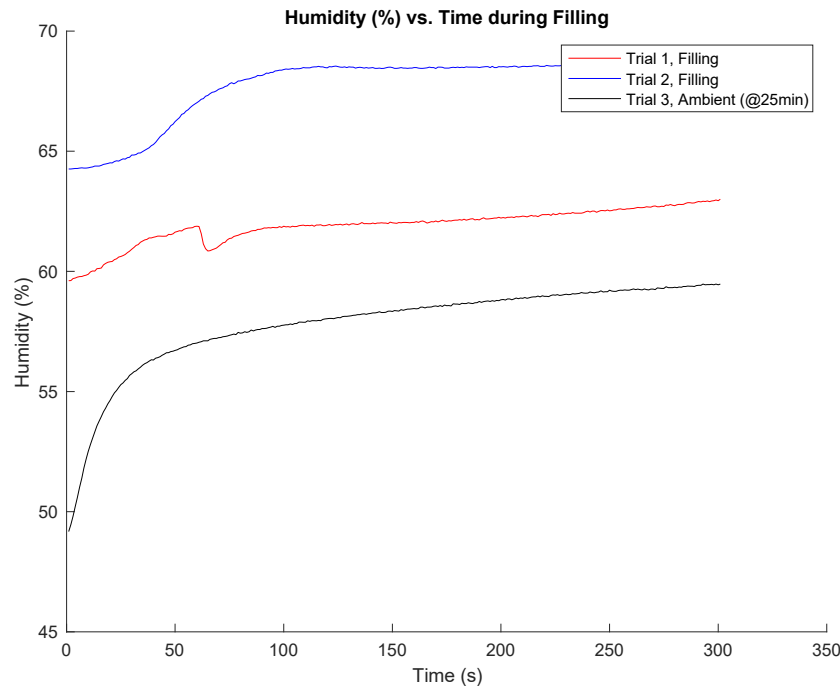
Final Prototype Video



Fill Time: 2min 15s (135s)

Humidity Sensor Testing

- Conducted test trials with previous prototype to determine humidity sensor effectiveness in determining leaks
- Performed ambient, filling, and leak tests
- Rate of change of humidity can be used to determine if leaks occur



Conclusion

Future Work

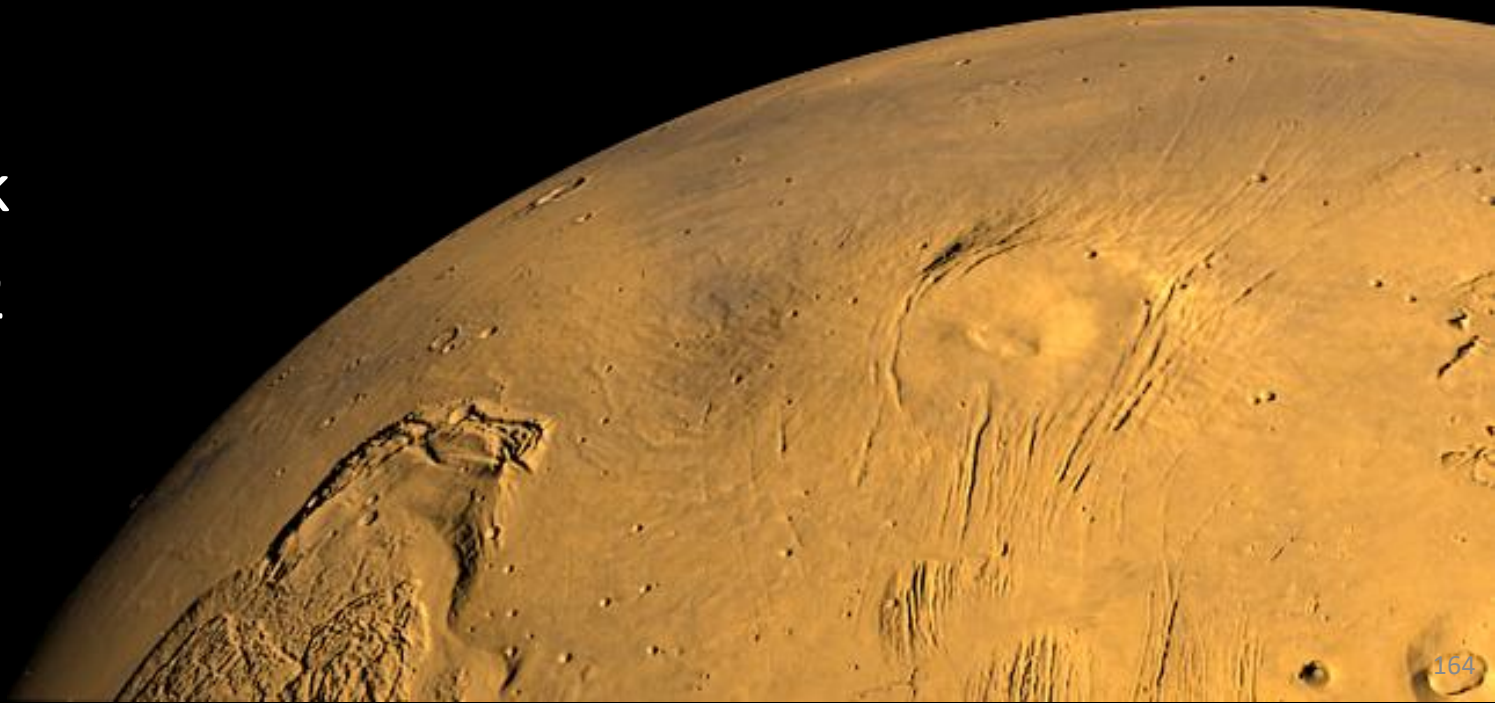
- More refined prototype rated for Antarctic conditions
- Test while submerged underwater
 - Fit electronics into sampling system
 - Create custom PCB and choose a lower profile microcontroller
- Implement full system control using flow meter and humidity sensors
- Internal air pressurization

Impact

- Aid in ongoing efforts to understand **melting glacial icecaps** and **inaccessible** glacier moulins
- Provide data of the subglacial environment to **determine conditions suitable to sustain life**

TurtleBot ROS Demonstrations

Coursework
Spring 2022



OpenCV Object Following with PID

- Robot to follow a specific object in space while maintaining object in center and at correct distance
 - Used LIDAR to determine distance to object, PID to maintain relative distance/angle
 - Used OpenCV to track object and maintain a specific orientation



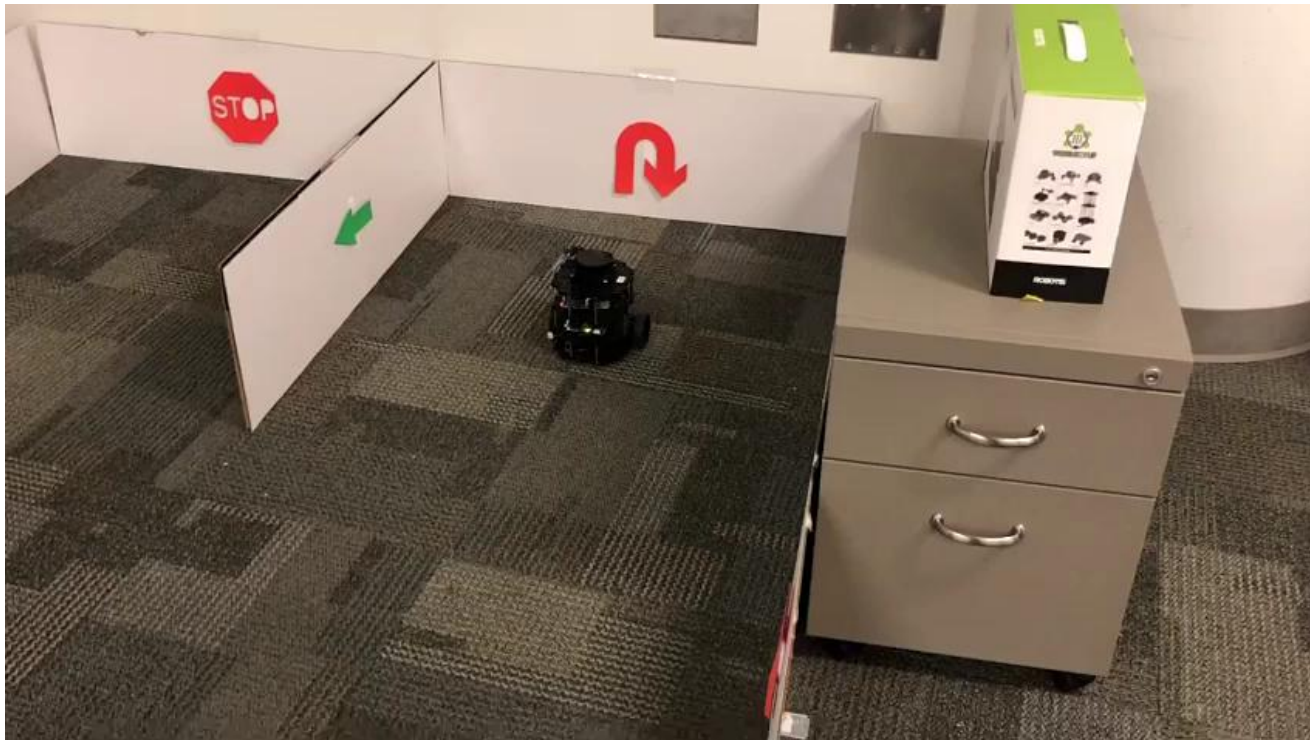
Robot Navigation with Odometry/Lidar

- Using robots onboard odometry and dead reckoning to navigate to various waypoints while avoiding random obstacles
 - Writing and subscribing to odometry nodes, robot kinematics
 - Filtering noisy lidar data
 - Obstacle detection with avoidance routine, while maintaining knowledge of position

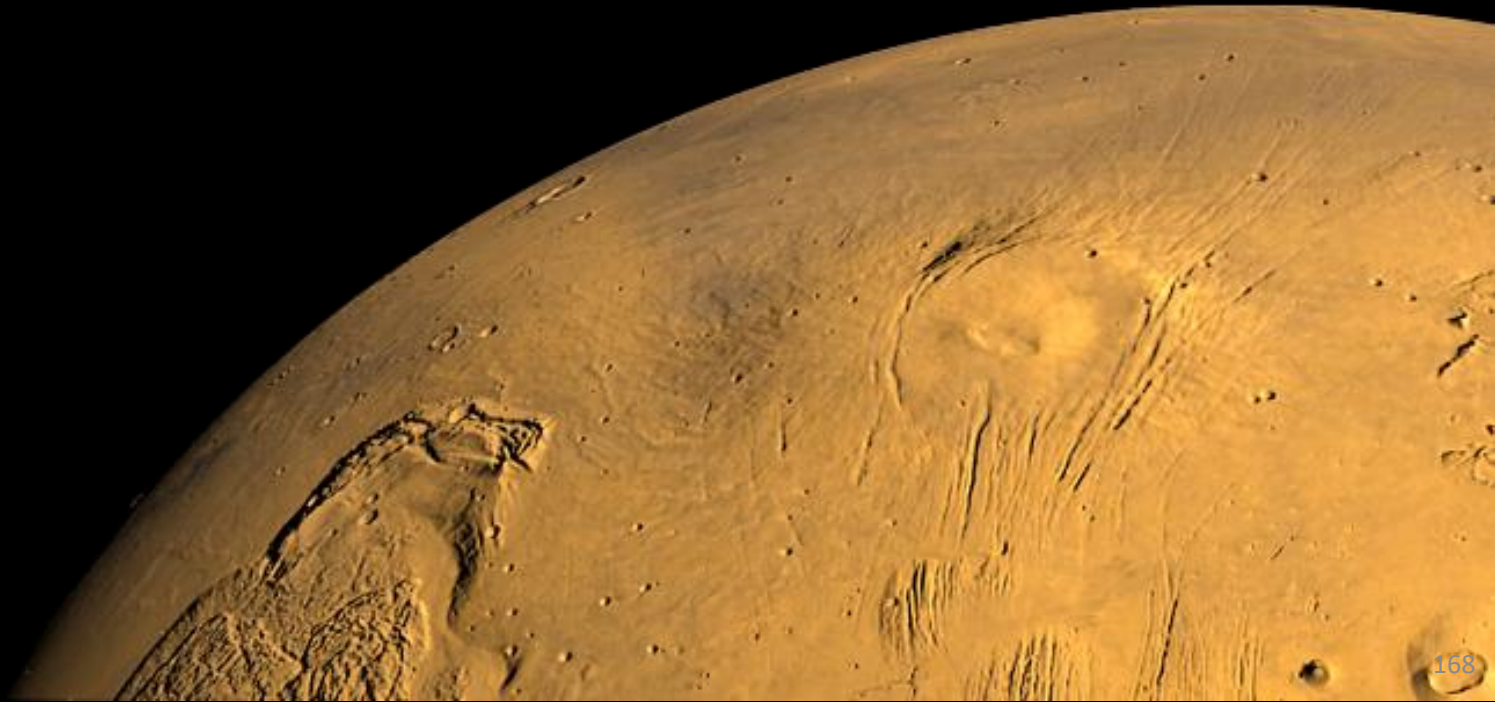


Final Project: Sign Classification and Navigation to Goal

- Robot classifies 6 different signs to navigate towards an end goal
 - Used state machine to control robot behavior
 - Implemented behaviors if sign is not correctly classified or if robot is stuck
 - Trained and used KNN ML model to classify signs with image processing
 - LiDAR, filtering, odometry, PID, ROS, image processing, classification



Additional 3D Printed Projects



3D Printed Gearbox

- 9:1 Gear Ratio with 3D Printed Gears and COTS Bearings
- Demonstration of gear feasibility and design with 3D Printed parts
 - Skeleton Modeling

